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Report No. SR-2026-001

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Comprehensive Analysis of the Bharatiya Janata Party A 46-Year Assessment (1980–2026)

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Under the aegis of Samvidhan Reports

Date of Submission	July 23, 2026
Report Version	2.0 (Final)
Total Pages	201
Keywords	BJP, Hindutva, Governance, Economic Analysis, Corruption, Electoral Politics, State Expansion
Category	Political Analysis / Governance Audit
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“Evidence-based documentation of India’s political evolution.”

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*To the citizens of India,
who seek truth over rhetoric,
evidence over opinion,
and accountability over power.*

This report is for you.

Acknowledgements

I extend my sincere gratitude to the various data repositories, journalists, and academic institutions whose work formed the backbone of this report. Special thanks to:

- **Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR)** — for their meticulous analysis of political funding and criminal cases.
- **Election Commission of India** — for maintaining and publishing comprehensive electoral data.
- **Press Information Bureau (PIB)** — for official government records and scheme information.
- **Investigative Journalists** — who have fearlessly exposed critical issues despite political pressure.
- **Academic Institutions** — including JNU, DU, and various research centres for their scholarly contributions.

This report is dedicated to the citizens of India who seek truth and accountability. It is my hope that this work contributes to a more informed and engaged citizenry, strengthening the democratic fabric of our nation.

— *Anshuman Singh*

Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of the Bharatiya Janata Party's journey from its inception in 1980 to the present day (2026). Drawing on data from Election Commission reports, parliamentary records, court judgments, and investigative journalism, this document examines the party's electoral evolution, policy impacts, governance performance, and documented controversies across all states and at the national level.

The report is structured into fifteen sections covering historical foundations, ideological shifts, electoral performance, economic indicators, welfare schemes, corruption scandals, state-wise governance, ministerial profiles, funding patterns, social impact, and comprehensive timelines. The objective is to provide an evidence-based, balanced, and objective assessment of the BJP's role in shaping modern India.

Key Findings:

1. **Electoral Transformation:** The BJP has transformed from a marginal 2-seat party (1984) to a dominant force with 303 seats (2019), though it lost single-party majority in 2024 with 240 seats.
2. **Ideological Fulfillment:** The party has fulfilled core ideological promises including Article 370 abrogation (2019) and Ram Temple construction (2024).
3. **Economic Growth with Challenges:** India's economy doubled from \$2 trillion to \$4+ trillion, but manufacturing remains stagnant at ~15% of GDP, and youth unemployment persists at 44–45%.
4. **Corruption & Criminalization:** 40% of BJP ministers have criminal cases; multiple large-scale scams (Rajesh Exports: Rs. 15.5 lakh crore, PMFBY: Rs. 25,000 crore) have emerged; electoral bonds declared unconstitutional by Supreme Court.
5. **State Expansion:** BJP now governs 16 states including all five largest states, fundamentally altering India's political geography.
6. **Financial Dominance:** BJP holds 85% of all national parties' income, with a corpus of nearly Rs. 10,000 crore.
7. **Democratic Concerns:** India ranked 157th in Press Freedom Index (2026), behind Pakistan and Bangladesh; communal violence increased 84% in 2024.

The report concludes with recommendations for electoral reforms, institutional strengthening, and social harmony.

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Glossary of Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full Form
ADR	Association for Democratic Reforms
BJP	Bharatiya Janata Party
BJS	Bharatiya Jana Sangh
CAA	Citizenship Amendment Act
CAG	Comptroller and Auditor General
CBI	Central Bureau of Investigation
CPI(M)	Communist Party of India (Marxist)
ECI	Election Commission of India
ED	Enforcement Directorate
FDI	Foreign Direct Investment
FRBM	Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GST	Goods and Services Tax
IBC	Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code
INC	Indian National Congress
JD(U)	Janata Dal (United)
LFPR	Labour Force Participation Rate
MoS	Minister of State
NDA	National Democratic Alliance
NITI	National Institution for Transforming India
OBC	Other Backward Class
PM	Prime Minister
PMAY	Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana
PMGSY	Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana
PMUY	Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana
RSS	Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh
SC	Supreme Court
TMC	Trinamool Congress
UAPA	Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act
UPI	Unified Payments Interface
UPA	United Progressive Alliance
VHP	Vishva Hindu Parishad

Chapter 1

Historical Foundations

1.1 Ideological Origins: Bharatiya Jana Sangh (1951–1977)

1.1.1 The Political Context

After India’s independence, the Indian National Congress dominated the political landscape. However, a need for an alternative political force emerged due to two principal factors:

1. **Nehru–Liaquat Pact (1950):** Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee criticised the pact as “Muslim appeasement” and voiced his opposition.
2. **Ban on RSS (1948):** Following Mahatma Gandhi’s assassination, the Congress government imposed a ban on the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), leading to the perception that a political alternative to Congress was necessary.

1.1.2 Foundation of Bharatiya Jana Sangh

Table 1.1: Foundation Details of Bharatiya Jana Sangh

Detail	Information
Date	October 21, 1951
Venue	Raghomal Kanya Madhyamik Vidyalaya, Delhi
Founder	Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee
Key Founders	Syama Prasad Mookerjee, Balraj Madhok, Deendayal Upadhyaya
Flag	Rectangular saffron flag
Election Symbol	‘Deepak’ (oil lamp)
Ideology	Hindutva, Hindu nationalism, Integral humanism, National conservatism
Political Position	Right-wing to far-right
RSS Connection	Political arm of Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)

1.1.3 Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee: The Founder

Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee’s political journey is crucial for understanding the ideological foundations of the BJP. Key events include:

Table 1.2: Key Milestones in Dr. Mookerjee’s Political Career

Event	Details
Resignation from Cabinet	April 19, 1950 — resigned as Union Industries Minister protesting the Nehru–Liaquat Pact.
Meeting with RSS Chief	Met Madhav Sadashivrao Golwalkar to strategise the formation of Jana Sangh.
Entry into Kashmir	May 11, 1953 — entered Jammu & Kashmir without permit as a satyagrahi, was arrested.
Death	June 23, 1953 — died in custody under mysterious circumstances.

Note: BJP members consider Dr. Mookerjee as the founder of the BJP because the BJP is the successor of the Bharatiya Jana Sangh.

1.1.4 Jana Sangh’s Electoral Performance (1952–1971)

The Jana Sangh’s electoral performance in its early years was limited:

Table 1.3: Jana Sangh Electoral Performance (1952–1971)

Year	Lok Sabha Seats	Vote Share	Significance
1952	3 seats	3.06%	Party attained national party status.
1957	4 seats	5.93%	Marginal improvement.
1962	14 seats	6.44%	Gradual growth.
1967	35 seats	9.41%	Best performance; second largest party in UP, Haryana, MP.
1971	22 seats	7.35%	Decline due to Indira Gandhi’s populist wave.

Analysis: From 1952 to 1971, the Jana Sangh’s vote share increased only from 3.06% to 9.41%, indicating that it did not lead mass movements during this period.

Table 1.4: Ideological Milestones of Jana Sangh

Year	Event	Significance
1952	First conference in Kanpur (Dec 29–31)	Pt. Deendayal Upadhyaya became General Secretary.
1952	‘Geo-cultural nationalism’ resolution	First ideological resolution, moved by Deendayal Upadhyaya.
1953	Kashmir satyagraha	Over 10,750 satyagrahis participated.
1954	Goa Liberation Movement	Integration Day (May 2), Goa Liberation Week (Dec 6–16).
1955	March to Goa	100 satyagrahis led by Jagannath Rao Joshi.
1958	Berubari Mass Movement	Opposed transfer of Berubari to Pakistan under Nehru–Noon Pact.

Table 1.5: Emergency Overview

Detail	Information
Imposition Date	June 25, 1975
End Date	March 3, 1977
Total Arrests	Approximately 30,000 political workers arrested under MISA.
RSS–Jan Sangh Impact	Several leaders and activists of RSS and Jan Sangh were arrested.

1.1.5 Key Ideological Developments (1952–1958)

1.2 The Emergency & Janata Party Interlude (1975–1980)

1.2.1 The Emergency (June 25, 1975 – March 3, 1977)

1.2.2 Key Leaders Arrested During Emergency

Table 1.6: Arrest of Key Jan Sangh Leaders

Leader	Position	Duration of Arrest
L.K. Advani	President of Bharatiya Jana Sangh	19 months in Bengaluru Central Jail.
Atal Bihari Vajpayee	Senior Jan Sangh leader	Nearly 19 months.
Murli Manohar Joshi	Physicist and Jan Sangh leader	Arrested in Uttar Pradesh.
Rajnath Singh	24-year-old physics lecturer, ABVP organiser	18 months under MISA.
Nanaji Deshmukh	Jan Sangh leader	Arrested August 1975.

Personal Impact — Rajnath Singh: Rajnath Singh’s mother, already unwell, suffered a brain haemorrhage upon learning of her son’s prolonged detention during the extended Emergency. She was hospitalised for a month and eventually passed away. Rajnath Singh

could not attend her funeral.

1.2.3 Advani's Account of Arrest

L.K. Advani, in his book, writes:

“It is around 7.30 in the morning. The telephone starts ringing. . . . The police, the message concludes, may shortly be calling for Atal Behari Vajpayee and myself. . . . We conferred briefly and decided that neither of us should evade arrest. . . . Atalji and I prepared a joint statement condemning the arrest of J.P. and other leaders, denouncing the Emergency and affirming that June 26, 1975 would have the same historic significance in the annals of independent India as August 9, 1942.”

1.2.4 Formation of Janata Party (1977)

Table 1.7: Janata Party Formation

Detail	Information
Merger	Bharatiya Jana Sangh merged with Congress(O), Congress for Democracy, Socialist Party, and others.
Formation	January 1977.
Election Result	Janata Party won majority, formed government with Morarji Desai as PM.
Duration	Lost power in July 1979 following internal split.

1.2.5 The Split & Birth of BJP (1980)

Table 1.8: Birth of the BJP (1980)

Detail	Information
Trigger	Janata Party's National Executive Council banned “dual membership” of party and RSS.
Response	Former Jana Sangh members left Janata Party.
New Party Formation	April 6, 1980.
Venue	Workers' convention at Kotla Ground, New Delhi (some sources mention Mumbai).
First President	Atal Bihari Vajpayee (1980–1986).

Vajpayee's Words at Foundation: *“Darkness will recede, the sun will rise, and the lotus will bloom.”*

1.3 Early Years: BJP's First Decade (1980–1989)

1.3.1 Initial Ideological Positioning

Table 1.9: Ideological Phases of BJP (1980–1989)

Phase	Ideology	Leader
1980–1984	Softer position on Hindu nationalism; “Gandhian Socialism” as ideological base	Atal Bihari Vajpayee
Post-1986	Shift towards Hindu nationalist element	L.K. Advani's rising influence

1.3.2 Electoral Performance (1980–1984)

Table 1.10: BJP Electoral Performance (1980–1984)

Year	Seats	Vote Share	Context
1980	Limited success	–	Aftermath of Janata Party collapse.
1984	Only 2 seats	7.7%	Indira Gandhi's assassination created a Congress sympathy wave.

1984 Election Analysis: This was BJP's worst performance. Congress won 426 seats. The only BJP MPs were Dr. A.K. Patel (Mehsana, Gujarat) and Chandupatla Janga Reddy (Hanamkonda, Andhra Pradesh).

1.3.3 The Turning Point: Palampur Resolution (1989)

Table 1.11: Palampur Resolution (1989)

Detail	Information
Event	Palampur Resolution
Year	1989
Key Figure	L.K. Advani
Content	Hitched party's bandwagon to Ram Temple cause, giving “defining Hindutva edge” to BJP's politics.
Impact	Transformed BJP from fringe to dominant political force.

Table 1.12: 1989 Election Breakthrough

Detail	Information
Seats Won	85 seats (out of 225 contested)
Vote Share	11.36%
Comparison	From 2 seats in 1984 to 85 seats in 1989.
Coalition	Alliance with anti-Congress parties.

1.3.4 Electoral Breakthrough (1989)

1.4 Timeline Summary (1951–1989)

Table 1.13: Comprehensive Timeline of Key Events (1951–1989)

Year	Date	Event	Category
1950	April 19	Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee re-signs from Nehru Cabinet	Political
1951	October 21	Bharatiya Jana Sangh founded in Delhi	Formation
1952	–	First General Election: BJS wins 3 seats	Electoral
1952	Dec 29–31	First BJS conference in Kanpur	Organizational
1953	May 11	Dr. Mookerjee arrested in Kashmir	Political
1953	June 23	Dr. Mookerjee’s death in custody	Political
1967	–	BJS wins 35 seats (best performance)	Electoral
1975	June 25	Emergency imposed	National Crisis
1977	–	BJS merges into Janata Party	Merger
1980	April 6	BJP founded; Vajpayee first President	Formation
1984	–	BJP wins only 2 seats	Electoral
1989	–	Palampur Resolution; BJP wins 85 seats	Electoral & Ideological

1.5 Key Data Points for Report

1.5.1 Electoral Growth Trajectory

Table 1.14: Electoral Growth Trajectory

Party Phase	Best Performance
Jana Sangh (1952–1971)	35 seats (1967)
BJP (1984)	2 seats
BJP (1989)	85 seats

Growth Rate: From 1984 to 1989, the BJP’s seat count increased by **4,150%** (2 to 85).

1.5.2 Ideological Evolution Summary

1951-1977 (Jana Sangh): Hindutva ideology, limited electoral success

1977-1980 (Janata Party): Merger, loss of distinct identity

1980-1984 (BJP - Phase 1): "Gandhian Socialism", softer Hindutva

1986-1989 (BJP - Phase 2): Shift to aggressive Hindutva, Ram Temple movement

1.5.3 Key Citations for Section 1

- BJP foundation: April 6, 1980.
- Jana Sangh foundation: October 21, 1951.
- 1952 election: 3 seats, 3.06% vote share.
- 1984 election: 2 seats.
- 1989 election: 85 seats.
- Emergency arrests: Advani (19 months), Vajpayee (19 months), Rajnath Singh (18 months).

Chapter 2

The Hindutva Turn & Rise to Prominence (1989-1996)

2.1 The Ideological Pivot: Palampur Resolution (1989)

2.1.1 Background & Context

By the mid-1980s, the BJP's electoral performance was lacklustre. After winning only 2 seats in 1984, the party needed ideological clarity. L.K. Advani, who became party president in 1986, decided to make Hindutva the party's core ideology.

2.1.2 The Palampur Resolution (June 1989)

Table 2.1: Palampur Resolution Details

Detail	Information
Event	BJP National Executive Meeting
Venue	Palampur, Himachal Pradesh
Date	June 9–11, 1989
Key Figure	L.K. Advani (Party President)
Resolution	First formal resolution on Ram Janmabhoomi
Content	Endorsed demand for handing over Shri Ram Janmabhoomi to Hindus for construction of Ram Temple

Advani's Own Words:

“I believe the phenomenal growth of the BJP between 1989 and 1996 owed a great deal to our support for the Ram Janmabhoomi movement. For us, Ayodhya will always remain a potent symbol of a national awakening.”

2.1.3 Key Events Preceding the Resolution

Table 2.2: Pre-Palampur Events

Date	Event	Significance
February 1, 1986	Faizabad District Court orders unlocking of Babri Masjid for Hindu worshippers	Rajiv Gandhi government allowed this; BJP used as political opportunity.
1988	BJP formally joins Ram Janmabhoomi movement	Party aligned with VHP's campaign.
1989	VHP permitted to lay foundation stone (Ram Chabutra) on disputed site	Triggered riots in various parts.
November 9, 1989	'Shilanyas' (foundation stone ceremony) of Ram temple conducted	Just 5 months before Palampur resolution.

2.1.4 Immediate Electoral Impact (1989 Election)

The Palampur resolution yielded an immediate dividend:

Table 2.3: Electoral Impact of Palampur Resolution

Metric	1984	1989	Change
Lok Sabha Seats	2	85	+4,150%
Vote Share	~7.7%	~11.36%	+3.66%
Status	Marginal	Principal opposition party	Major shift

BJP was now in a position to extend external support to the National Front government under V.P. Singh.

2.2 The Ram Rath Yatra (September–October 1990)

2.2.1 Yatra Details

Context: The Yatra began amidst the furore over the Mandal Commission, which recommended quotas for OBCs in government jobs.

2.2.2 Key Participants

Advani on Modi:

Table 2.4: Ram Rath Yatra Details

Detail	Information
Start Date	September 25, 1990
Start Point	Somnath, Gujarat
End Point	Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh
Scheduled End	October 30, 1990
Total Distance	10,000 km
States Covered	Gujarat, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Bihar
Daily Travel	300 km per day
Daily Rallies	Often 6 public rallies per day
Vehicle	DCM Toyota mini-truck designed as chariot

Table 2.5: Key Participants of the Rath Yatra

Name	Role at the Time
L.K. Advani	BJP President, Yatra leader
Narendra Modi	Gujarat BJP General Secretary
Ashok Singhal	VHP leader
Uma Bharti	Rising BJP leader

“He was not very famous then. But at that very time Lord Ram had chosen his devotee (Modi) to rebuild his temple.”

2.2.3 The Arrest (October 23, 1990)

Table 2.6: Arrest of L.K. Advani

Detail	Information
Date	October 23, 1990
Location	Samastipur, Bihar
Ordered By	Lalu Prasad Yadav, Bihar Chief Minister
Reason	Law and order concerns; yatra was triggering communal tensions.

The yatra ended abruptly, but its political impact had already been made.

2.2.4 Impact of the Rath Yatra

2.3 Electoral Consolidation (1991)

2.3.1 1991 Lok Sabha Election Results

Key Insight: BJP became the official opposition, the second-largest party after Congress.

Table 2.7: Impact of the Rath Yatra

Impact Area	Details
Electoral	BJP's 1991 tally: 85 → 120 seats
Vote Share	11% → 20%
Political Status	Became principal opposition party for the first time.
Communal	Yatra alleged to have triggered fervour for Babri demolition in 1992.
National Profile	Catapulted Advani to centre of national politics.

Table 2.8: 1991 Lok Sabha Election Results

Party	Seats Won	Contested	Vote Share	Total Votes
BJP	120	477	20.07%	5,58,43,074
INC	244	500	36.40%	10,12,85,692
JD	59	312	11.73%	3,26,28,400
CPM	35	63	6.14%	1,70,74,699

2.3.2 Leadership Transition (February 1991)

Table 2.9: Leadership Transition

Detail	Information
Outgoing President	L.K. Advani (after two consecutive terms)
Incoming President	Murli Manohar Joshi

2.4 The Babri Masjid Demolition (December 6, 1992)

2.4.1 Pre-demolition Events

2.4.2 The Demolition Day: Minute-by-Minute Timeline

Table 2.11: Minute-by-Minute Timeline of Babri Demolition

Time	Event
6:00 AM	Steady stream of journalists and kar sevaks arrives at disputed structure; RSS cadres wearing armbands cordon the boundary.
10:00 AM	L.K. Advani, Murli Manohar Joshi arrive at platform to review arrangements.
10:30 AM	Senior BJP, RSS, VHP, Bajrang Dal leaders move to dais on roof of Ram Katha Kunj.

Continued on next page

Table 2.11 – continued from previous page

Time	Event
11:00 AM	Cleaning commences; wooden barriers breached by kar sevaks wearing yellow bands.
11:15 AM	More kar sevaks barge into cordoned area; move towards barbed wire cordon.
11:30 AM	Teenager scales protective railings, jumps through barbed wire.
12:00 PM	Teenage kar sevak breaches cordon; ~150 kar sevaks follow with pick-axes, hammers, shovels, iron rods.
12:15 PM	Nearly 5,000 kar sevaks begin assault on dome.
12:30 PM	Kar sevaks hurl bricks at security forces, attack media.
12:45 PM	Paramilitary forces fail to reach structure; obstructed by kar sevaks.
1:15–3:30 PM	DGP requests permission to fire; CM refuses to allow it.
~3:30 PM	First dome collapses.
6:30–7:00 PM	Union Cabinet imposes President’s Rule in UP; Kalyan Singh resigns.

2.4.3 Scale of the Event

2.4.4 Legal Aftermath

2.4.5 Communal Violence Aftermath

2.5 BJP’s First Government: The 13-Day Experiment (1996)

2.5.1 1996 Lok Sabha Election Results

Key Insight: BJP emerged as the single largest party for the first time in history.

2.5.2 The 13-Day Government

2.5.3 Vajpayee’s Historic Speech

On May 28, 1996, Vajpayee delivered his iconic resignation speech in the Lok Sabha:

“Satta ka khel toh chalta rahega, sarkarein aayengi, jayengi, partian banengi, bigrengi, magar yeh desh rehna chahiye, yeh desh ka loktantra rehna chahiye.”

(Power play will continue, governments will come and go, parties will be formed and broken, but this country must live on, its democracy must live on.)

Table 2.10: Pre-demolition Events

Date	Event
December 5, 1992	Day passed off peacefully; test drill by Rapid Action Force.
December 5–6, 1992	Over 2,00,000 kar sevaks arrived in Ayodhya from Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Karnataka, UP.

Table 2.12: Scale of Babri Demolition

Metric	Number
Kar Sevaks Present	75,000 to 1.5 lakh
Kar Sevaks Storming Structure	~5,000
Police Constables	2,300
PAC Companies	35
Paramilitary Companies	195
CRPF Companies	4
Tear Gas Squads	15

He also said:

“If I am offered power with a new alliance at the cost of a split in my party, I would be the last person even to remotely entertain such an idea.”

2.5.4 Aftermath

2.6 Comprehensive Timeline (1989–1996)

Table 2.18: Comprehensive Timeline (1989–1996)

Date	Event	Category
1988	BJP formally joins Ram Janmabhoomi movement	Political
June 1989	Palampur Resolution — BJP endorses Ram Temple demand	Ideological
August 14, 1989	Allahabad HC orders status quo at disputed structure	Legal
November 1989	Rajiv Gandhi allows ‘shilanyas’ ceremony	Political
November 1989	Lok Sabha election: BJP wins 85 seats	Electoral

Continued on next page

Table 2.18 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Category
September 25, 1990	Advani's Ram Rath Yatra begins from Somnath	Political
October 23, 1990	Advani arrested in Samastipur, Bihar	Political
1991	Kalyan Singh government acquires 2.77 acres around disputed site	Political
May–June 1991	Lok Sabha election: BJP wins 120 seats	Electoral
February 1991	Murli Manohar Joshi becomes BJP President	Organizational
December 6, 1992	Babri Masjid demolished	Communal/Critical
December 12, 1992	Liberhan Commission formed	Legal
April 3, 1993	Centre passes 'Acquisition of Certain Area at Ayodhya Act'	Legal
1996	Lok Sabha election: BJP wins 161 seats	Electoral
May 15, 1996	Vajpayee becomes PM — first BJP Prime Minister	Political
May 28, 1996	Vajpayee resigns after 13 days	Political

2.7 Key Data Points for Report

2.7.1 Electoral Trajectory (1984–1996)

Growth Rate (1984–1996): 2 seats → 161 seats = **7,950% increase**.

2.7.2 The Rath Yatra Impact

2.7.3 Babri Demolition Statistics Summary

2.7.4 Key Citations for Section 2

- Palampur Resolution (1989): BJP's first formal resolution on Ram Janmabhoomi.
- Rath Yatra: September 25, 1990 from Somnath; 10,000 km; arrested October 23, 1990.
- 1991 Election: 120 seats, 20.07% vote share.

Table 2.13: Legal Aftermath of Babri Demolition

Detail	Information
FIRs Filed	Two: (1) Against unknown kar sevaks for demolition; (2) Naming L.K. Advani, M.M. Joshi, others for communal speeches.
Liberhan Commission	Formed December 12, 1992; submitted report June 30, 2009.
Commission Findings	68 people held guilty; security apparatus “non-existent”.
CBI Chargesheet	Filed against Advani and 19 others.
Criminal Conspiracy Charges	Restored by SC against Advani, Joshi, Uma Bharti, Vinay Katiyar.
Acquittal	Advani along with 31 others acquitted by CBI court 28 years later.

Table 2.14: Communal Violence Aftermath

Detail	Information
Nationwide Riots	Triggered across country.
Deaths	At least 2,000 people killed.
Ayodhya Violence	Kar sevaks attacked Muslim residents; 18 Muslims murdered; houses ransacked.
Pakistan Reaction	Muslims in Pakistan attacked 30+ Hindu temples (December 8, 1992).

- Babri Demolition: December 6, 1992; 1.5 lakh kar sevaks; ~5,000 stormed structure.
- 1996 Election: 161 seats, 20.29% vote share.
- 13-Day Government: May 15–28, 1996.

Table 2.15: 1996 Lok Sabha Election Results

Party	Seats Won	Contested	Vote Share	Total Votes
BJP	161	471	20.29%	6,79,50,851
INC	140	529	28.80%	9,64,55,493
JD	46	196	8.08%	2,70,70,340
CPM	32	75	6.12%	2,04,96,810

Table 2.16: The 13-Day Government

Detail	Information
PM	Atal Bihari Vajpayee
Oath Date	May 15, 1996
Resignation Date	May 28, 1996
Duration	13 days
Reason	Failed to prove majority; could not garner support of more than 194 MPs in 543-member Lok Sabha.

Table 2.17: Aftermath of 13-Day Government

Detail	Information
Congress	Declined to form government but supported United Front.
United Front	Coalition of non-Congress, non-BJP parties formed government.
Next PM	H.D. Deve Gowda.

Table 2.19: Electoral Trajectory (1984–1996)

Year	Seats	Vote Share	Significance
1984	2	~7.7%	Worst performance
1989	85	~11.36%	Breakthrough after Palampur
1991	120	20.07%	Principal opposition
1996	161	20.29%	Single largest party

Table 2.20: Rath Yatra Impact

Metric	Before Yatra (1989)	After Yatra (1991)
Seats	85	120
Vote Share	11%	20%

Table 2.21: Babri Demolition Statistics

Metric	Number
Kar Sevaks Present	75,000 – 1,50,000
Security Personnel	2,300 constables + 35 PAC + 195 paramilitary
Time of Demolition	12:00 PM – 3:30 PM
FIRs Filed	2
People Held Guilty	68
Deaths in Riots	~2,000

Chapter 3

The Vajpayee Era (1998-2004)

3.1 The Road to Power: 1998 & 1999 Elections

3.1.1 The 1998 Lok Sabha Election

Table 3.1: 1998 Lok Sabha Election Details

Detail	Information
Context	I.K. Gujral's United Front government collapsed; elections held three years ahead of schedule.
Date	February–March 1998.
BJP Seats	182 seats.
NDA Total	~250 seats (with allies).
Vajpayee's Oath	March 19, 1998.
Alliance Partners	AIADMK (Jayalalithaa), TDP, Samata Party, others.
Government Duration	13 months (collapsed when AIADMK withdrew support).

3.1.2 The 1999 Lok Sabha Election

Table 3.2: 1999 Lok Sabha Election Details

Detail	Information
Context	Government fell by a single vote in 1999 due to Jayalalithaa's tactics.
Date	September–October 1999.
BJP Seats	182 seats (same as 1998).
NDA Total	303 seats — comfortable majority.
Vajpayee's Oath	October 10, 1999.
Government Duration	Full 5-year term (1999–2004).
Significance	First non-Congress government to complete full term since independence.

Key Insight: Vajpayee became the first non-Congress Prime Minister to serve a full five-year term — a historic milestone for Indian democracy.

3.2 Pokhran-II Nuclear Tests (May 1998)

3.2.1 The Tests

Table 3.3: Pokhran-II Nuclear Tests Details

Detail	Information
Operation Name	Operation Shakti.
Dates	May 11 and May 13, 1998.
Location	Indian Army's Pokhran Test Range, Thar Desert, Rajasthan.
Total Devices	5 nuclear devices.
First Day (May 11)	3 simultaneous detonations at 3:45 PM.
May 11 Devices	45 kT thermonuclear, 15 kT fission, 0.2 kT sub-kiloton.
May 13 Devices	2 sub-kiloton devices (0.5 kT and 0.3 kT).
Third Device	Prepared but never fired.
Secrecy	Shaft preparations done at night to hide from American satellites.

3.2.2 Key Figures

Table 3.4: Key Figures in Pokhran-II

Name	Role
Atal Bihari Vajpayee	Prime Minister — announced tests at press conference on May 11, 1998.
George Fernandes	Defence Minister.
Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam	Scientific advisor, present at site.
Dr. R. Chidambaram	BARC Director, present at site.

3.2.3 International Response

3.2.4 Significance

National Technology Day: May 11 was declared National Technology Day by the Vajpayee government.

Vajpayee's Statement:

“Today at 1545 hours, India conducted three underground nuclear tests in the Pokhran range.”

Table 3.5: International Response to Pokhran-II

Impact Area	Details
Sanctions	US and other nations imposed sanctions.
India–US Relations	Hit rock bottom but diplomacy under Vajpayee and Jaswant Singh prevailed.
Talks	Jaswant Singh conducted nuclear policy talks with US Deputy Secretary Strobe Talbott.
India’s Stance	Refused to sign CTBT; declared moratorium on testing; no-first-use policy; commitment to disarmament.

3.3 The Kargil War (May–July 1999)

3.3.1 Background

Table 3.6: Kargil War Background

Detail	Information
Context	Pakistani army regulars intruded into Indian territory across the Line of Control (LoC).
Intelligence Failure	Government accused of ignoring vital intelligence after Vajpayee’s bus ride to Lahore in February 1999.
Congress Criticism	Opposition took government to task for failing to detect incursions.

3.3.2 Key Details of the Conflict

Table 3.7: Kargil War Details

Detail	Information
Operation Name	Operation Vijay.
Duration	Two months (May–July 1999).
Location	Kargil district, Jammu & Kashmir, and along LoC.
Key Military Leaders	Gen. Ved Prakash Malik (Chief of Army Staff).
Outcome	Indian forces pushed back Pakistani intruders.

Table 3.8: Vajpayee’s Response to Kargil

Detail	Information
Address to Nation	June 8, 1999 — described situation as “serious” and “fraught with danger”.
Key Message	Pakistan had crossed LoC and occupied Indian territory; India would defend.
Political Narrative	Vajpayee argued Pakistan had betrayed Lahore peace initiative.

Table 3.9: Kargil War Aftermath

Detail	Information
Inquiry Committee	Government appointed committee to investigate Kargil conflict.
Political Impact	Boosted Vajpayee’s popularity; used in 1999 election campaign.
Advani’s Claim	“Vajpayee Government achieved the Kargil victory not only due to its jawans but also due to its resolve”.

3.3.3 Vajpayee’s Response

3.3.4 Aftermath

3.4 Economic Reforms & Performance (1998–2004)

3.4.1 GDP Growth

Table 3.10: GDP Growth Under Vajpayee

Period	Average GDP Growth
First two years (1998–2000)	7.5% per annum.
Overall tenure (1998–2004)	~8% per annum.
Q2 2003	8.4% — peak before 2004 elections.

Context: Vajpayee government took India’s growth rate well above the “Hindu growth rate” of 3%.

3.4.2 Key Economic Indicators

3.4.3 Major Economic Reforms

Expert View: “*The Vajpayee government had a good record on economic reform*”.

Table 3.11: Key Economic Indicators

Indicator	Performance
Inflation	Came down to 4%.
Foreign Exchange Reserves	Flourishing.
Fiscal Deficit	Large; addressed through Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Act, 2001.

Table 3.12: Major Economic Reforms

Reform	Details
Disinvestment	Strategic disinvestment of public sector undertakings; nearly half of 242 CPSUs were loss-making.
Telecom Policy	Win-win formula; government got more revenue from private companies; reduced costs of state-owned telecom.
Fiscal Responsibility Act	FRBM Act, 2001 — aimed at reducing fiscal deficits.
Insurance Sector	Opened up insurance sector to private and foreign investment.

3.4.4 Economic Growth Drivers

3.5 Infrastructure & Major Schemes

3.5.1 Golden Quadrilateral

3.5.2 Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY)

3.5.3 North-South Corridor

3.5.4 Other Infrastructure

3.6 Major Controversies

3.6.1 The Tehelka Defense Scandal (March 2001)

Key Individuals Caught on Tape

Political Fallout

Fernandes' Defense: Claimed middlemen who had lost access to ministry were behind the expose.

Table 3.13: Economic Growth Drivers

Factor	Impact
Telecom Revolution	By 2004, India was logging over 3 million subscribers per month.
Infrastructure Push	Golden Quadrilateral, PMGSY, national highway expansion.
Reforms Continuity	Reforms initiated in early 1990s continued uninterrupted.

Table 3.14: Golden Quadrilateral

Detail	Information
Launch	2001.
Description	National highway network connecting Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai, Chennai.
Significance	One of India's largest infrastructure projects; transformed road connectivity.

3.6.2 Gujarat Riots (February–April 2002)

Scale of Violence

Background

Vajpayee's Response

Criticism of Vajpayee Government

Vajpayee's Own Admission:

“My government's policy is to make everyone secure and there is no question of discrimination.”

Table 3.15: PMGSY

Detail	Information
Launch	2000.
Objective	Connect rural villages with all-weather roads.
Impact	Major rural connectivity initiative.

Table 3.16: North-South Corridor

Detail	Information
Launch	During Vajpayee era.
Description	National highway corridor connecting north and south India.

3.6.3 Government Falls: The 1999 Vote of Confidence

3.7 The “India Shining” Campaign & 2004 Defeat

3.7.1 The “India Shining” Campaign

3.7.2 Why BJP Was Confident

3.7.3 The Shock Defeat (May 2004)

3.7.4 Advani’s Admission

3.8 Comprehensive Timeline (1998–2004)

Table 3.30: Comprehensive Timeline (1998–2004)

Date	Event	Category
March 1998	Vajpayee becomes PM with AIADMK, TDP support	Political
May 11–13, 1998	Pokhran-II — 5 nuclear tests conducted	Defense
1998	International sanctions imposed on India	Foreign
April 1999	Government loses vote of confidence by 1 vote	Political
May–July 1999	Kargil War — Operation Vijay	Defense
October 1999	NDA wins 303 seats; Vajpayee sworn in	Electoral

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Table 3.30 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Category
2000	PMGSY launched	Infrastructure
2000	3 new states created: Uttarakhand, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh	Policy
2001	Tehelka defense scandal breaks	Scandal
2001	Golden Quadrilateral launched	Infrastructure
2001	FRBM Act enacted	Economic
Feb 27, 2002	Godhra train burning — 59 kar sevaks killed	Communal
Feb–Apr 2002	Gujarat riots — 900+ killed, mostly Muslims	Communal
February 6, 2004	Lok Sabha dissolved 6 months early	Political
May 2004	NDA loses elections — “India Shining” fails	Electoral

3.9 Key Data Points for Report

3.9.1 Electoral Performance (1998–2004)

3.9.2 Nuclear Tests Summary

3.9.3 Gujarat Riots Statistics

3.9.4 Economic Performance Summary

3.9.5 Major Achievements & Controversies Balance

3.9.6 Key Citations for Section 3

- **1998 Election:** BJP 182 seats, Vajpayee PM March 1998.
- **Pokhran-II:** May 11–13, 1998; 5 tests; 45 kT thermonuclear.
- **Kargil War:** May–July 1999; Operation Vijay.
- **1999 Election:** NDA 303 seats; Vajpayee first non-Congress PM to complete full term.
- **GDP Growth:** ~8% during tenure.
- **Golden Quadrilateral:** Launched 2001.

Table 3.17: Other Infrastructure Initiatives

Initiative	Details
Telecom	Reduced call rates, increased penetration.
Home Loans	Made cheaper.
New States	Created Uttarakhand (from UP), Jharkhand (from Bihar), Chhattisgarh (from MP) in 2000.

Table 3.18: Tehelka Scandal Details

Detail	Information
Sting Operation	“Operation West End” — journalists posed as businessmen for fake company “West End International”.
Target	Trying to sell fictitious hand-held thermal imaging devices to Indian military.
Hidden Camera	Videotaped politicians, bureaucrats, army officers accepting money.
Amount involved	Fake deal worth \$870,000.

- **Tehelka Scandal:** March 2001; BJP President Bangaru Laxman resigned.
- **Gujarat Riots:** Feb–Apr 2002; 900+ killed.
- **India Shining:** Failed campaign; BJP lost 2004 elections.
- **2004 Defeat:** NDA lost to UPA; BJP out for 10 years.

Table 3.19: Individuals Caught in Tehelka Sting

Name	Position	Outcome
Bangaru Laxman	BJP President	Resigned.
Jaya Jaitley	Samata Party leader	Named in footage.
PSK Choudhary	Senior Defence Ministry official	Suspended.
Various officials	Defence Ministry, military	4 suspended.

Table 3.20: Political Fallout of Tehelka Scandal

Detail	Information
Opposition Response	Parliament adjourned; opposition demanded government resignation.
Coalition Impact	Trinamool Congress stayed away from NDA meeting, demanded Fernandes' resignation.
BJP Response	Described it as “political conspiracy”; claimed “honesty is the biggest asset of the government”.
Government Action	Announced investigation into allegations.
George Fernandes	Offered to resign.

Table 3.21: Scale of Gujarat Riots

Metric	Number
Official Death Toll	Over 900 killed (primarily Muslims).
BBC Report	At least 700 dead in initial phase.
People Displaced	120,000 people, mostly Muslims, lost homes.
Relief Camps	100+ camps sheltering tens of thousands.

Table 3.22: Background to Gujarat Riots

Date	Event
February 27, 2002	Godhra train burning — 59 kar sevaks (Hindu pilgrims) killed in train fire at Godhra station.
February 28, 2002	Gujarat riots begin — retaliatory violence against Muslims across state.
February–April 2002	Communal violence continued for months.

Table 3.23: Vajpayee's Response to Gujarat Riots

Detail	Information
First Visit	First visit to Gujarat in April 2002 — criticized as “too late”.
Public Statement	Called violence “madness”.
“Gujarat is a mystery”	Told reporters: “For me, Gujarat is a mystery”.
“Riots have left me ashamed”	Told victims.
Instructions to Modi	Instructed Gujarat government to take urgent steps to contain violence.
Letter to Modi	Pointed out losses were underassessed, ex-gratia not properly disbursed, victims needed relocation.
Aid Package	Announced \$30 million government aid.
“Raj Dharma”	Asked Modi to follow “raj dharma” (duty of the state).

Table 3.24: Criticism of Vajpayee Government on Gujarat

Criticism Point	Details
Delay	Visit came too late.
Relief Camps	Conditions allegedly improved just before PM's visit.
State Government	BJP-controlled state government under Narendra Modi faced particular criticism.
NMC Concerns	National Commission for Minorities said it was “not satisfied” with action taken.

Table 3.25: 1999 Vote of Confidence

Detail	Information
Date	April 1999.
Vote Margin	Government lost by a single vote.
Cause	Jayalalithaa's AIADMK withdrew support.
Outcome	Fresh elections called for September–October 1999.

Table 3.26: “India Shining” Campaign

Detail	Information
Slogan	“India Shining” (Hindi: BHARAT UDAYA).
Purpose	Marketing slogan conveying economic optimism.
Launch	Before 2004 general elections.
Campaign Elements	Blitz from billboards, TV ads; pre-recorded message by Vajpayee: “Main Atal Bihari Vajpayee bol raha hoon...”
Confidence	BJP was certain of victory.

Table 3.27: Factors Behind BJP's Confidence

Factor	Details
GDP Growth	8.4% in Q2 2003.
Vajpayee's Popularity	At all-time high.
Foreign Reserves	Swelling.
Opposition Weakness	Congress lost Assembly polls in Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh (2003).
Early Elections	Vajpayee dissolved Lok Sabha on February 6, 2004 — six months early.

Table 3.28: 2004 Election Defeat

Detail	Information
Election Date	April–May 2004.
Result	NDA lost — Congress-led UPA formed government.
Congress PM	Manmohan Singh.
Duration Out of Power	BJP out of power for 10 years.

Table 3.29: Advani's Admission on 2004 Defeat

Quote	Source
“The catchphrases were correct but they did not yield good dividends to the BJP”	L.K. Advani's first press conference after defeat.
“Overconfidence” and “wrong slogans like India Shining” caused defeat	Advani, 2009.

Table 3.31: Electoral Performance (1998–2004)

Year	BJP Seats	NDA Total	Vote Share (BJP)	Government
1998	182	~250	~25.6%	13 months (collapsed)
1999	182	303	~23.7%	Full 5-year term
2004	~138	~185	~22.2%	Lost to UPA

Table 3.32: Nuclear Tests Summary

Detail	Value
Total Tests	5
Dates	May 11 & 13, 1998
Largest Device	45 kT (thermonuclear)
Secrecy Level	Hidden from US satellites

Table 3.33: Gujarat Riots Statistics

Detail	Value
Official Deaths	900+
Displaced	120,000
Relief Camps	100+
Government Aid	\$30 million

Table 3.34: Economic Performance Summary

Metric	Performance
GDP Growth (first 2 years)	7.5%
GDP Growth (overall)	~8%
Inflation	~4%
Foreign Reserves	Flourished

Table 3.35: Achievements vs Controversies

Achievements	Controversies
Pokhran-II nuclear tests	Tehelka defense scandal
Kargil War victory	Gujarat 2002 riots
Golden Quadrilateral	“India Shining” disconnect
3 new states created	Government fell by 1 vote
PMGSY rural roads	Intelligence failure in Kargil
FRBM Act, 2001	RSS–BJP tensions
Telecom revolution	Loss of old-age pension

Chapter 4

The Opposition Years (2004-2014)

4.1 The Shock Defeat & Immediate Aftermath

4.1.1 2004 Lok Sabha Election Results

Table 4.1: 2004 Lok Sabha Election Results

Detail	Information
BJP Seats	138 seats (down from 182 in 1999).
BJP Vote Share	22.16%.
Congress Seats	145 seats.
Congress Vote Share	26.53%.
NDA Total	189 seats.
UPA Total	219 seats.
Outcome	Congress-led UPA formed government; Manmohan Singh became PM.

Key Insight: BJP lost power despite Vajpayee’s popularity and the “India Shining” campaign. The party’s seat count fell by 44 seats from 1999, while Congress gained 32 seats from its 1999 tally of 113.

4.1.2 Leadership Changes

Table 4.2: Leadership Changes After 2004 Defeat

Event	Details
Vajpayee’s Retirement	Atal Bihari Vajpayee announced retirement from active politics.
Advani Returns as President	L.K. Advani became BJP President for the third time (2004–2005) after Venkaiah Naidu resigned.
Advani as Opposition Leader	Served as Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha.
Presidential Transition	Advani → Rajnath Singh (2005–2009) → Nitin Gadkari (2009–2013) → Rajnath Singh (2013–2014).

4.2 Electoral Performance (2004–2014)

4.2.1 Lok Sabha Election Results Summary

Table 4.3: Lok Sabha Election Results (2004–2014)

Year	Seats Won	Vote Share	Contested	Status
2004	138	22.16%	364	Lost to UPA
2009	116	18.80%	433	Lost to UPA
2014	282	31.0%	~430	Landslide victory

2009 Analysis: BJP's tally fell below expectations — from 138 MPs to 116 MPs. The party had hoped to win 160 seats. This was BJP's worst performance since 1991.

4.2.2 State-Level Performance (2009)

Table 4.4: State-Level Performance in 2009

State	BJP Performance
Uttarakhand	Vote share dropped to 33%; Congress swept all 5 seats.
Rajasthan	BJP won 21 of 25 seats in 2004.
Gujarat	Only state where BJP continuously secured over 50% of total seats.

4.2.3 State Assembly Elections (Key Results)

Table 4.5: Key State Assembly Election Results (2003–2013)

Year	State	BJP Performance
2003	Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh	Won all three (pre-2004).
2005	Bihar	Lost to Nitish Kumar's JD(U)-BJP alliance? Actually JD(U)-BJP won.
2007	Gujarat	Modi's third term — BJP won 117 seats.
2008	Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh	BJP won all three.
2009	Maharashtra, Haryana	Lost.

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Table 4.5 – continued from previous page

Year	State	BJP Performance
2012	Uttar Pradesh	BJP won only 47 of 403 seats.
2012	Gujarat	BJP won again — Modi’s fourth term.
2013	Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh	BJP won all three again.
2013	Delhi	BJP won 31 of 70 seats (single largest but couldn’t form government).

4.3 Leadership & Organizational Changes

4.3.1 BJP Presidents (2004–2014)

Table 4.6: BJP Presidents (2004–2014)

Period	President	Key Context
2004–2005	L.K. Advani	Third term; took over after 2004 defeat.
2005–2009	Rajnath Singh	First term; marked by strategic shifts.
2009–2013	Nitin Gadkari	RSS-backed appointment; faced allegations.
2013–2014	Rajnath Singh	Second term.

4.3.2 RSS’s Growing Influence

Analysis Point: 2004–2014 saw a power shift within the party — from the Vajpayee–Advani generation to RSS-backed leadership. This period marked the gradual sidelining of moderate voices within the party.

4.4 Ideological Evolution (2004–2014)

4.4.1 The “Softening” Phase

4.4.2 The Return to Hindutva

Advani’s Jinnah Controversy: In 2005, Advani visited Pakistan and praised Muhammad Ali Jinnah as “secular” — causing a major controversy within the party and leading to his resignation as party president.

Table 4.7: RSS's Growing Influence (2004–2014)

Detail	Information
Post-2009 Shift	RSS moved systematically to take control of BJP by appointing Nagpur acolyte Nitin Gadkari as president.
Vajpayee Era Contrast	Vajpayee did not let RSS interfere much in party or government decisions.
2014 Resurrection	RSS emerged as a major political force in 2014 election.

Table 4.8: Softening of Hindutva (2004–2009)

Detail	Information
2004 Manifesto	No reference to Hindutva, Uniform Civil Code, or Article 370.
Shift in Strategy	BJP national leadership shifted away from embracing Hindutva discourses as central political messaging tools (1996–2014).
Focus	Governance, development, economic issues took precedence.

Table 4.9: Return to Hindutva (2009–2014)

Detail	Information
2014 Manifesto	Did not use the word “Hindutva” even once.
Subtle Shift	Only reference to ‘Hindu’ was promise that India will remain refuge for “persecuted Hindus”.
Modi’s Appeal	Modi married Hindutva appeal to an economic narrative.
Internal Churning	Since 2004 defeat, there was churning in BJP leadership and steady increase in RSS grip over the party.

Table 4.10: The Gujarat Model

Detail	Information
Modi’s Brand	Development-oriented governance with Hindutva undertones.
Vibrant Gujarat	Investment summits attracted global attention.
Infrastructure Push	Electrification of villages, roads, power sector reforms.
Economic Narrative	Used to counter criticism over 2002 riots.

4.4.3 The Gujarat Model

4.5 Major Controversies During Opposition Years

4.5.1 The 2002 Gujarat Riots Legacy

4.5.2 The Cash-for-Votes Scandal (2008)

4.5.3 Advani’s Jinnah Remarks (2005)

4.5.4 Nitin Gadkari’s Alleged Financial Irregularities

4.5.5 BJP’s Own Scandal: The Cash-for-Votes Case (Continued)

4.6 The “Anti-Corruption” Wave & 2014 Preparation

4.6.1 The Anna Hazare Movement (2011–2012)

4.6.2 Building the Modi Campaign

4.6.3 The 2014 Landslide

4.7 Comprehensive Timeline (2004–2014)

Table 4.11: Gujarat Riots Legacy (2004–2014)

Detail	Information
Ongoing Criticism	Modi's administration criticized for management of crisis.
Sohrabuddin Sheikh Encounter	Fake police encounter case; former state junior home minister Amit Shah and 14 other cops accused.
Political Impact	Modi's controversial record remained a liability until 2014.
Legal Outcome	Apex court later absolved Modi and Shah of any complicity in Godhra riots.

Table 4.12: Cash-for-Votes Scandal (2008)

Detail	Information
Date	July 22, 2008.
Context	UPA government faced trust vote over Indo-US nuclear deal.
Allegation	BJP MPs allegedly offered cash to vote against government.
Footage	Sting operation showed BJP MPs allegedly taking money.
Outcome	Controversy damaged BJP's anti-corruption image.

Table 4.19: Comprehensive Timeline (2004–2014)

Date	Event	Category
May 2004	BJP loses elections; Congress-led UPA forms government	Electoral
May 2004	Vajpayee retires from active politics	Leadership
2004–2005	L.K. Advani becomes BJP President for third time	Leadership
June 2005	Advani praises Jinnah in Pakistan; resigns as President	Controversy
2005–2009	Rajnath Singh becomes BJP President	Leadership
December 2007	Modi wins third term in Gujarat — 117 seats	State Election
July 2008	Cash-for-votes scandal exposes BJP MPs	Scandal

Continued on next page

Table 4.19 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Category
December 2008	BJP wins Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh assembly elections	State Election
May 2009	BJP wins only 116 seats — worst since 1991	Electoral
2009–2013	Nitin Gadkari becomes BJP President	Leadership
2011–2012	Anna Hazare anti-corruption movement	Political
2012	BJP wins only 47 seats in UP assembly	State Election
2012	Modi wins fourth term in Gujarat	State Election
2013	Modi named BJP's PM candidate	Leadership
2013	BJP wins Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh again	State Election
2013–2014	Rajnath Singh becomes President again	Leadership
May 2014	BJP wins 282 seats — absolute majority	Electoral

Table 4.13: Advani’s Jinnah Remarks (2005)

Detail	Information
Date	June 2005.
Location	Karachi, Pakistan.
Statement	Advani praised Jinnah as “secular”.
Fallout	Massive controversy within BJP; RSS and VHP criticized.
Result	Advani resigned as BJP President.

Table 4.14: Gadkari’s Financial Irregularities Allegations

Detail	Information
Allegation	Financial irregularities in Purti group companies.
Context	Gadkari was BJP President at the time (2009–2013).
Investigation	Income Tax department conducted inquiries.
Outcome	Gadkari survived; allegations didn’t stick but damaged image.

4.8 Key Data Points for Report

4.8.1 Electoral Trajectory (2004–2014)

4.8.2 Leadership Transitions

4.8.3 Key Controversies Summary

4.8.4 RSS–BJP Relationship Evolution

4.9 Analysis & Patterns

4.9.1 Why BJP Lost (2004 & 2009)

4.9.2 Why BJP Won (2014)

4.9.3 Ideological Shift

Key Observation: The 2004–2014 period was a transition decade for BJP — from the Vajpayee–Advani moderate era to the Modi–RSS hardline era. The party learned from its defeats, rebuilt its organization, and returned to power in 2014 with a landslide mandate.

4.9.4 Key Citations for Section 4

- **2004 Election:** BJP 138 seats, 22.16% vote share.

Table 4.15: Cash-for-Votes Case Continued

Detail	Information
Court Case	Delhi High Court framed charges against 3 BJP MPs.
Status	Case dragged on for years.
Irony	BJP aggressively attacked Congress on corruption while facing its own corruption allegations.

Table 4.16: Anna Hazare Movement

Detail	Information
Context	Massive public anger over UPA-era corruption scams.
Key Scams	2G Spectrum (Rs 1.76 lakh crore), Coalgate (Rs 1.86 lakh crore), Commonwealth Games (Rs 70,000 crore).
BJP's Strategy	Rode the “anti-corruption” wave to power in 2014.
Irony	BJP criticized Congress while facing its own corruption cases.

- **2009 Election:** BJP 116 seats, 18.80% vote share.
- **2014 Election:** BJP 282 seats, absolute majority.
- **BJP Presidents (2004–2014):** Advani (2004–05), Rajnath Singh (2005–09), Gadkari (2009–13), Rajnath Singh (2013–14).
- **Modi as CM:** Appointed October 3, 2001.
- **RSS Control:** RSS systematically took control of BJP after 2009.
- **2014 Manifesto:** No mention of “Hindutva”.
- **2004 Manifesto:** No mention of Hindutva, UCC, or Article 370.

Table 4.17: Building the Modi Campaign

Detail	Information
2012	Modi appointed as head of BJP's Election Campaign Committee.
2013	Modi named as BJP's Prime Ministerial candidate.
Amit Shah's Role	Strategically divided Uttar Pradesh, mobilized volunteers, organized effective rallies.
RSS Mobilization	RSS cadre energized and mobilized for 2014 election.

Table 4.18: 2014 Landslide Victory

Detail	Information
BJP Seats	282.
Congress Seats	44.
Vote Share	31.0%.
Significance	First straight majority for any party since 1984.
Gujarat	BJP won all 26 seats.
UP	BJP won 71 seats.

Table 4.20: Electoral Trajectory (2004–2014)

Year	Seats	Vote Share	Change from Previous
2004	138	22.16%	–44 seats from 1999
2009	116	18.80%	–22 seats
2014	282	31.0%	+166 seats

Table 4.21: Leadership Transitions (2004–2014)

Period	President	Key Context
2004–2005	L.K. Advani	Third term; post-defeat
2005–2009	Rajnath Singh	First term
2009–2013	Nitin Gadkari	RSS-backed
2013–2014	Rajnath Singh	Second term

Table 4.22: Key Controversies (2004–2014)

Controversy	Year	Impact
Advani's Jinnah remarks	2005	Resigned as President
Cash-for-votes	2008	Damaged anti-corruption image
Gadkari financial allegations	2010–13	Weakened leadership
Sohrabuddin encounter case	Ongoing	Tainted Modi's image

Table 4.23: RSS–BJP Relationship Evolution

Phase	Relationship
Vajpayee Era	RSS had limited interference.
Post-2004	RSS began reasserting control.
2009–2014	RSS systematically took control.
2014	RSS emerged as major political force.

Table 4.24: Reasons for BJP’s Defeats

Factor	2004	2009
Overconfidence	“India Shining” disconnected from rural reality	–
Leadership	Vajpayee aging, Advani not as popular	Advani failed to connect
Opposition Unity	Congress united opposition	UPA effective coalition
Modi Factor	Gujarat riots still fresh	Modi not yet national face
Economic Issues	Growth not reaching masses	Global financial crisis

Table 4.25: Reasons for BJP’s 2014 Victory

Factor	Impact
Modi’s Appeal	Development narrative + Hindutva undertones.
Anti-Incumbency	10 years of UPA; corruption scandals.
RSS Mobilization	Cadre energized.
Amit Shah’s Strategy	UP breakthrough.
Congress Weakness	Rahul Gandhi’s leadership failed.

Table 4.26: Ideological Shift (2004–2014)

Phase	Ideological Positioning
2004	Soft Hindutva; focus on governance.
2005–2009	Ambiguous; Advani’s Jinnah remarks created confusion.
2009–2013	RSS reasserted control; hardline elements gained.
2014	Development + subtle Hindutva; “Modi wave”.

Chapter 5

Modi Era — First Term (2014-2019)

5.1 The Landslide Victory (May 2014)

5.1.1 Election Results

Table 5.1: 2014 Lok Sabha Election Results

Detail	Information
Election Date	April–May 2014.
Result Date	May 16, 2014.
BJP Seats	282 seats (out of 543).
NDA Total	336 seats.
BJP Vote Share	31.0%.
Congress Seats	44 seats (lowest in history).
Congress Vote Share	19.3%.
Significance	First single-party majority since 1984; ended era of coalition governments since 1989.

Key Insight: BJP’s tally of 282 seats marked the end of successive coalition governments since 1989. Narendra Modi won from two seats — Vadodara and Varanasi — and chose to retain Varanasi.

5.1.2 The “Modi Wave”

Table 5.2: Factors Behind the “Modi Wave”

Factor	Impact
Anti-Incumbency	10 years of UPA rule; corruption scandals (2G, Coalgate, CWG).
Modi’s Appeal	Development narrative + Hindutva undertones.
RSS Mobilization	Cadre energized and mobilized.
Amit Shah’s Strategy	Strategic division of Uttar Pradesh; BJP won 71 of 80 seats in UP.
Congress Weakness	Rahul Gandhi’s leadership failed to connect.

Al Jazeera Analysis: The BJP’s landslide victory “has ended an era of shaky coalition governments in India”.

5.2 Major Policy Initiatives

5.2.1 Make in India (September 2014)

Table 5.3: Make in India Initiative

Detail	Information
Launch Date	September 25, 2014.
Objective	Transform India into global manufacturing hub.
GDP Target	Increase manufacturing share from 16% to 25% of GDP.
Growth Target	Manufacturing growth at 12% per year (vs GDP at 8%).
Job Target	Create 10 crore (100 million) jobs in manufacturing.
FDI Liberalization	Opened 25 domestic sectors to FDI, including pharmaceuticals, railways, renewable energy.

Actual Outcome (by 2019)

Table 5.4: Make in India: Target vs Reality

Metric	Target	Actual
Manufacturing share of GDP	25%	~15% (stagnant)
Manufacturing jobs	10 crore created	Halved from 50 million to 27 million

BBC Analysis: “The contribution of the manufacturing sector has remained just above 15% in recent years, and experts doubt the target will be met.”

5.2.2 Demonetization (November 8, 2016)

Table 5.5: Demonetization Overview

Detail	Information
Announcement Date	November 8, 2016.
Currency Invalidated	Rs. 500 and Rs. 1,000 notes.
Percentage of Cash	86% of currency in circulation rendered illegal.
Objective	Wipe out black money; end counterfeiting; stop terror funding.

Impact

BBC Assessment: “A disastrous currency ban in 2016, which wiped out 86% of cash in circulation, . . . hit businesses hard.”

Table 5.6: Impact of Demonetization

Impact Area	Details
GDP Impact	GDP fell to 3.1% in Q4 2019–20 — lowest in a decade.
Job Losses	Up to 3.5 million jobs lost in 3 months following demonetization.
Labor Force	15 million people may have exited the labor force.
Digital Payments	Initially rose in 2016–17 but returned to pre-demonetization levels from 2018 onward.
Cash in Circulation	CIC to GDP ratio surged to 14.5% in 2020–21 from 8.7% in 2016–17.

5.2.3 Goods and Services Tax (GST) — July 1, 2017

Table 5.7: GST Implementation

Detail	Information
Implementation Date	July 1, 2017.
Objective	Unify India as a single market; cooperative federalism.
Taxes Replaced	17 different taxes (VAT, central excise, service tax, etc.).
Taxpayers (2017)	66.5 lakh.
Taxpayers (2026)	1.65 crore.

Impact

Table 5.8: GST Impact

Impact Area	Details
Positive	Improved tax compliance; broadened tax base; one national market.
Negative	Compliance costs; administrative challenges; initial disruption.
Economic Impact	Along with demonetization, “hit businesses hard”.

Analysis: GST was “the most significant indirect tax reform in India” but its implementation, combined with demonetization, created significant economic disruption.

Table 5.9: IBC Overview

Detail	Information
Passed	2016.
Objective	Streamline insolvency and bankruptcy procedures.
Impact	Considered one of the government’s “incredibly impressive” accomplishments.

5.2.4 Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), 2016

5.3 Economic Performance (2014–2019)

5.3.1 GDP Growth

Table 5.10: GDP Growth Trends (2014–2019)

Year	GDP Growth Rate	Context
2014–15	7.4%	First year.
2015–16	8.0%	Peak.
2016–17	8.3%	Demonetization year.
2017–18	7.2%	–
2018–19	7.2%	–
Q1 2019	5.8%	Slowest in 4+ years; below expectations.
Q4 2019–20	3.1%	Lowest in a decade.

Arun Jaitley’s Claim: The 2014–19 consolidated growth rate at an average of 7.3% was the “highest 5-year growth rate that any government has achieved in India till today”.

Counterpoint: GDP growth “has been the slowest in the last 20 quarters” by 2019. Growth in farm prices was at an 18-year low and rural wages stagnated.

5.3.2 Unemployment

Table 5.11: Unemployment Data (2014–2019)

Metric	Data
Unemployment Rate (2017–18)	6.1% — 45-year high.
Average Unemployment (2014–2017)	5.4%.
Unemployment (2018–2019)	5.3%.
Job Creation (per year)	Only 4.3 million jobs created annually vs 20 million needed
Job Losses (2021)	Over 25 million people lost jobs since start of 2021.

Government Response: The government delayed publication of official jobs data; a

draft version was leaked indicating a significant rise in unemployment during the government's tenure.

5.3.3 Poverty & Middle Class

Table 5.12: Poverty & Middle Class Impact

Metric	Impact
Poverty Increase	Over 75 million Indians plunged back into poverty.
Middle Class Impact	One-third of India's 100 million-strong middle class fell into poverty.
Pew Research	Set back half a decade of gains.

5.4 Major Welfare Schemes

5.4.1 Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) — August 28, 2014

Table 5.13: PM Jan Dhan Yojana

Detail	Information
Launch Date	August 28, 2014.
Objective	Financial inclusion — every household gets a bank account.
Initial Target	7.5 crore families in one year.
Guinness Record	18,096,130 accounts opened in one week (Aug 23–29, 2014).
Total Accounts (2025)	Over 56.16 crore bank accounts.
Total Deposits (2025)	Rs. 2.67 lakh crore.

PM Modi's Statement:

“I had sent 7.25 lakh bank employees, exhorting them to help reach the target of 7.5 crore bank accounts, and bring freedom from financial untouchability.”

5.4.2 Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) — May 1, 2016

Business Standard: PMUY was one of the government's flagship schemes with “more hits than misses”.

Table 5.14: PM Ujjwala Yojana

Detail	Information
Launch Date	May 1, 2016 from Ballia, Uttar Pradesh.
Objective	Provide free LPG connections to BPL households.
Target	5 crore beneficiaries over 3 years.
Budget	Rs. 8,000 crore.
Support per Connection	Rs. 1,600 financial support.
Achievement (2018)	Reached 39 million mark.
Achievement (2020)	8 crore families got free cylinders.

5.4.3 Swachh Bharat Abhiyan (Clean India Mission) — October 2, 2014

Table 5.15: Swachh Bharat Abhiyan

Detail	Information
Launch Date	October 2, 2014 (Gandhi Jayanti).
Objective	Make India open-defecation free by 2019.
Toilets Built	Over 100 million individual household toilets within 5 years.
Villages Declared ODF	Over 6 lakh villages by October 2019.
2014–15 Achievement	58,54,987 latrines built — 117% of target.

BBC Assessment: “Many households have switched to the cleaner fuel, so this was a considerable success.”

5.4.4 Other Key Schemes

Table 5.16: Other Key Welfare Schemes

Scheme	Launch Year	Key Achievement
PM Awas Yojana	2015	Housing for all; millions of houses constructed.
PM Fasal Bima Yojana	January 2016	Farm insurance; budget increased by 64% for 2017–18.
Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)	2015	Budget of \$21 million; aided innovation in small businesses.
e-NAM	2016	Online national market for agricultural commodities.
Saubhagya Yojana	2017	Free electricity connections; over 50,000 receive daily.

5.5 Foreign Policy (2014–2019)

5.5.1 Key Achievements

Table 5.17: Foreign Policy Achievements (2014–2019)

Area	Details
US Relations	Barack Obama invited as Republic Day chief guest (2015) — first for a US President.
Israel Ties	Strengthened bilateral relations.
West Asia	Built relationships with Iran, Saudi Arabia, Israel.
Neighborhood First	Neighboring countries received “required attention”.
WTO	Pulled out of WTO trade facilitation deal (Aug 2014) citing food security concerns.
FDI Liberalization	Opened 25 domestic sectors.

Analysis: Modi’s first term was “marked by a distinct and assertive style of confidently engaging with the world which was a marked contrast to the low-key style ... of his predecessor Manmohan Singh”.

5.6 Major Controversies & Scandals

5.6.1 Electoral Bonds (Introduced 2017)

Table 5.18: Electoral Bonds Controversy

Detail	Information
Introduced	2017.
Purpose	Anonymous political donations.
Controversy	BJP received 84% of total electoral bonds.
Criticism	Alleged to be “Electoral Bond Scam”; received donations from firms accused of “terror funding”.

Frontline Analysis:

“This doublespeak has been in evidence since 2014, when the saffron party came to power riding on the coattails of Anna Hazare’s anti-corruption movement, promising to wipe out graft and crony capitalism.”

Table 5.19: Rafale Deal Controversy

Detail	Information
Deal Date	September 2016.
Aircraft	36 Rafale jets from Dassault Aviation, France.
Cost	Rs. 58,000 crore (approx. Rs. 1,611 crore per jet).
UPA Price	Rs. 526 crore per unit (for 126 jets under negotiation).
Allegation	Congress dubbed it the “biggest scam” of Modi government.
Cronyism Allegation	Critics accused Modi of favouring Anil Ambani’s Reliance Defence.
SC Verdict	December 2018 — Supreme Court dismissed calls for investigation.

5.6.2 Rafale Fighter Jet Deal (September 2016)

Congress Allegation: The deal was done “unilaterally without following the DPP, without any inter-governmental agreement and in the absence of the then Defence Minister Manohar Parrikar”.

5.6.3 Nirav Modi PNB Scam (January 2018)

Table 5.20: Nirav Modi PNB Scam

Detail	Information
Detection Date	January 29, 2018.
Amount	Rs. 11,400 crore.
Main Accused	Nirav Modi (diamantaire), Mehul Choksi (Gitanjali Gems).
Bank	Punjab National Bank, Brady House branch, Mumbai.
CBI Action	FIR filed; arrests of bank officials.
ED Action	Assets worth Rs. 5,100 crore seized.

Asia Times:

“Modi’s tenure turned out to be even more outrageous than Singh’s, with the nation rocked by the bank frauds of Nirav Modi...”

Table 5.21: Vyapam Scam

Detail	Information
Arrest	June 2014 — senior BJP leader Laxmikant Sharma arrested.
Context	Infamous Vyapam scam in Madhya Pradesh.
Outcome	Sharma got CBI clean chit; died of COVID-19 in 2021.

Table 5.22: Other Controversies (2014–2019)

Controversy	Year	Details
GDP Methodology Change	2015	Government changed GDP calculation methodology; critics alleged manipulation.
Economic Advisors	2014–2019	Four reputed economic advisors resigned in a row.
Jobs Data Suppression	2018–2019	Government delayed publication of jobs data.

5.6.4 Vyapam Scam (Madhya Pradesh)

5.6.5 Other Controversies

5.7 Security & Defense

5.7.1 Pulwama Attack & Balakot Strikes (February 2019)

Table 5.23: Pulwama Attack & Balakot Strikes

Detail	Information
Pulwama Attack	February 14, 2019 — 40 CRPF soldiers killed in IED attack.
Balakot Strikes	February 26, 2019 — Indian Air Force conducted retaliatory strikes in Pakistan.
Political Impact	Modi presented himself as “true guardian of the country’s security”.

Congress Counter: Security situation in Kashmir was worse under BJP than under Congress before 2014. Data showed militant activity levels were “broadly similar”, but infiltration attempts rose since 2016.

Table 5.24: Women’s Safety Indicators

Metric	Data
Rape Reporting	Rose during Modi’s tenure, particularly after 2012 Delhi gang rape.
Conviction Rate	Has not really improved in the last few years.

5.8 Women’s Safety

5.9 2019 Re-election

5.9.1 Election Results

Table 5.25: 2019 Election Results

Detail	Information
BJP Seats	303 seats (increase from 282 in 2014).
NDA Total	353 seats.
Vote Share	Increased from 2014.
Slogan	“2019 mein phir ek baar, Modi sarkar” (In 2019, Modi government yet again).

5.9.2 Factors Behind Victory

Table 5.26: Factors Behind 2019 Victory

Factor	Impact
Modi’s Personal Appeal	Converted election into a referendum on himself.
Balakot Strikes	National security narrative boosted popularity.
Welfare Schemes	Reached out to 22 crore beneficiaries.
Anti-Corruption Image	“Main bhi chowkidar” (I too am a watchman) campaign.

Note: Despite farm distress, low economic indicators, joblessness, and anxiety among minorities, Modi won a second term with a majority — “a rare occurrence in the country”.

5.10 Comprehensive Timeline (2014–2019)

Table 5.27: Comprehensive Timeline (2014–2019)

Date	Event	Category
May 16, 2014	BJP wins 282 seats; Modi becomes PM	Electoral
August 28, 2014	PM Jan Dhan Yojana launched	Welfare
September 25, 2014	Make in India launched	Economic
October 2, 2014	Swachh Bharat Abhiyan launched	Welfare
2015	Atal Innovation Mission launched	Economic
2015	PM Awas Yojana launched	Welfare
January 2016	PM Fasal Bima Yojana launched	Welfare
May 1, 2016	PM Ujjwala Yojana launched	Welfare
November 8, 2016	Demonetization announced	Economic
2016	IBC passed	Economic
2016	e-NAM launched	Agriculture
2017	Electoral Bonds introduced	Financial
July 1, 2017	GST implemented	Economic
January 2018	Nirav Modi PNB Scam detected	Scandal
September 2016	Rafale deal signed	Defense/Scandal
February 14, 2019	Pulwama attack — 40 soldiers killed	Security
February 26, 2019	Balakot airstrikes	Security
May 2019	BJP wins 303 seats — re-elected	Electoral

5.11 Key Data Points for Report

5.11.1 Electoral Performance

Table 5.28: Electoral Performance (2014–2019)

Year	Seats	Vote Share	Change
2014	282	31.0%	+166 from 2009
2019	303	~37.4%	+21 from 2014

Table 5.29: Economic Summary (2014 vs 2019)

Metric	2014	2019
GDP Growth	7.4%	5.8% (Q1) / 3.1% (Q4)
Unemployment	~5.4%	~6.1% (2017–18)
Manufacturing share of GDP	~16%	~15%

Table 5.30: Welfare Schemes Achievements

Scheme	Beneficiaries
Jan Dhan	56 crore+ accounts
Ujjwala	8 crore+ families
Swachh Bharat	100 million+ toilets
PM Awas	Crores of houses

5.11.2 Economic Summary

5.11.3 Welfare Schemes Summary

5.11.4 Major Scandals Summary

5.12 Analysis: Achievements vs Failures

5.12.1 Key Achievements

5.12.2 Key Failures

Deccan Chronicle Analysis:

“Manufacturing’s share of GDP fell instead of rising, and has gone from 16 per cent to 13 per cent today. Its rate of growth was negative after 2014. Jobs in manufacturing halved.”

5.12.3 Key Citations for Section 5

- **2014 Election:** BJP 282 seats, 31.0% vote share.
- **Make in India:** Launched Sept 25, 2014; target 25% of GDP.
- **Demonetization:** Nov 8, 2016; 86% of currency invalidated.
- **GST:** July 1, 2017.
- **GDP Growth:** 7.4% (2014–15) to 3.1% (Q4 2019–20).
- **Unemployment:** 6.1% — 45-year high.

Table 5.31: Major Scandals (2014–2019)

Scandal	Amount
Nirav Modi PNB Scam	Rs. 11,400 crore
Rafale Deal Controversy	Rs. 58,000 crore
Electoral Bonds	BJP received 84% of total

Table 5.32: Key Achievements (2014–2019)

Area	Achievement
Financial Inclusion	Jan Dhan — 56 crore+ bank accounts.
Sanitation	Swachh Bharat — 100 million+ toilets.
LPG Access	Ujjwala — 8 crore+ LPG connections.
Tax Reform	GST — unified national market.
Insolvency	IBC — streamlined bankruptcy.
FDI	Opened 25 sectors.
Foreign Policy	Strengthened global ties.

- **Jan Dhan:** 56 crore+ accounts.
- **Ujjwala:** 8 crore+ families.
- **Swachh Bharat:** 100 million+ toilets.
- **Nirav Modi Scam:** Rs. 11,400 crore.
- **Rafale Deal:** Rs. 58,000 crore.
- **2019 Election:** BJP 303 seats.

Table 5.33: Key Failures (2014–2019)

Area	Failure
Manufacturing	Target 25% of GDP; achieved ~15%.
Jobs	10 crore jobs promised; manufacturing jobs halved.
GDP Growth	Fell to 3.1% by Q4 2019–20.
Unemployment	45-year high of 6.1%.
Farm Incomes	Doubling target not on track.
Corruption	Electoral bonds, Rafale, PNB scam.

Chapter 6

Modi Era — Second Term (2019-2024)

6.1 The 2019 Landslide Re-election

6.1.1 Election Results

Table 6.1: 2019 Lok Sabha Election Results

Detail	Information
Election Date	April–May 2019.
Result Date	May 23, 2019.
BJP Seats	303 seats (out of 543).
NDA Total	353 seats.
BJP Vote Share	37.82%.
BJP Total Votes	22,90,78,370.
Congress Seats	52 seats.
Congress Vote Share	19.75%.
Significance	First time an incumbent PM returned with increased majority since 1971.

Key Insight: BJP won 224 seats with more than 50% vote share — a remarkable feat in Indian elections. In Gujarat, the party swept all 26 seats with a 62.21% vote share.

6.1.2 The “Modi Tsunami”

Table 6.2: Factors Behind the “Modi Tsunami”

Factor	Impact
National Security	Balakot airstrikes (Feb 2019) boosted Modi’s “strong leader” image.
Welfare Reach	22 crore beneficiaries of various schemes.
Anti-Corruption Narrative	“Main bhi chowkidar” campaign.
Congress Weakness	Rahul Gandhi’s leadership failed to convert anti-incumbency.

6.2 Article 370 Abrogation (August 5, 2019)

6.2.1 The Announcement

Table 6.3: Article 370 Abrogation

Detail	Information
Date	August 5, 2019.
Action	President Ram Nath Kovind declared Article 370 inoperative.
Mechanism	Presidential notification under clause (3) of Article 370 read with clause (1).
Timing	Within 90 days of Modi 2.0 taking charge.
BJP’s Long-standing Promise	BJP had been seeking abrogation since its earlier Jan Sangh days.

6.2.2 Key Details

Table 6.4: Key Details of Article 370 Abrogation

Detail	Information
J&K Reorganization	State bifurcated into two Union Territories: Jammu & Kashmir, and Ladakh.
Rajya Sabha	Resolution moved by Union Home Minister Amit Shah amidst opposition uproar.
Opposition Reaction	Ghulam Nabi Azad accused government of “murdering constitution and democracy”.
Legal Status	Article 370 was listed as a temporary provision in the Constitution.

6.2.3 Analysis

Significance: This fulfilled one of BJP’s core ideological promises — complete integration of Kashmir into the Indian Union. The move was hailed by supporters as a historic correction and criticized by opponents as an undemocratic power grab.

Table 6.5: Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA)

Detail	Information
Passed	December 2019.
Purpose	Provide citizenship to non-Muslim refugees from Pakistan, Afghanistan, Bangladesh who entered India before December 31, 2014.
Controversy	Critics argued it discriminated on religious grounds — excluded Muslims.
Government Position	Defended as humanitarian measure for persecuted minorities.

6.3 Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) & Nationwide Protests

6.3.1 The Act

6.3.2 The Protests (2019–2020)

Table 6.6: Anti-CAA Protests

Detail	Information
Scale	Pan-India agitation.
Key Location	Shaheen Bagh, Delhi — became enduring symbol of resistance led by Muslim women.
Demographics	Leaderless protests led by women and students.
Government Response	Attempts to dub protesters as anti-nationals failed to reduce intensity.
BJP's Retreat	Government went on back foot on implementation of nationwide NRC.
BJP Damage Control	700 minority members resigned in MP over derogatory remarks at pro-CAA rally.

6.3.3 Key Timeline

Analysis: The CAA protests represented one of the largest civil society movements against a BJP government, forcing the party to backtrack on the nationwide NRC.

Table 6.7: CAA Protests Timeline

Date	Event
November 4, 2019	BJP tweets on NRC; later deleted amid backlash.
December 2019	CAA passed; protests begin.
December 2019	Violence in Gujarat; BJP and Congress blame each other.
January 2020	Protests intensify across India.
March 2020	Massive public meet demands repeal of CAA, NRC, NPR.

Table 6.8: COVID-19 Initial Response

Detail	Information
First Lockdown	March 2020 — nationwide lockdown.
PM's Statement	Decision was “not easy” — government had assessed impact on economy and livelihoods.
Emergency Package	Rs. 15,000 crore for ‘India COVID-19 Emergency Response and Health System Preparedness Package’.
State Support	PM chaired high-level meetings with Chief Ministers of all States and UTs.

6.4 COVID-19 Pandemic Response (2020–2021)

6.4.1 Lockdown & Initial Response

6.4.2 Vaccination Drive

Table 6.9: COVID-19 Vaccination Drive

Detail	Information
Launch Date	January 16, 2021.
Scale	World's largest vaccination program.
Initial Sites	3,006 session sites across all States and UTs.
Vaccine Doses	Over 2 billion doses administered.
PM's Jab	Modi took first dose on March 1, 2021 at AIIMS.
Phase 2 Target	300 million people by July 2021.
Free Doses	More than 15 crore vaccine doses provided free to states.

6.4.3 Criticism

Indian Express Analysis (May 2021):

Table 6.10: Criticism of COVID-19 Response

Criticism Point	Details
Second Wave	Government criticized for slow response during deadly second wave (April–May 2021).
“Worst Year”	2021 described as “the worst year of Narendra Modi’s political career”.
Mockery	Government’s claim of “strong and sensitive leadership during Covid” called “mockery”.
State Support	States complained of lack of help from central government.

“This has turned out to be the year in which Narendra Modi ran out of luck and leadership.”

6.5 Economic Performance (2019–2024)

6.5.1 GDP Growth

Table 6.11: GDP Growth Trends (2019–2024)

Year	GDP Growth Rate	Context
2019–20	4.0%	Pre-COVID slowdown.
2020–21	-7.3%	COVID-19 pandemic contraction.
2021–22	8.7%	Strong rebound.
2022–23	7.2%	Continued recovery.
2023–24	7.3%	Estimate.

Average GDP Growth (2019–2024): Approximately 6.5% annual.

6.5.2 Debt & Fiscal Concerns

Table 6.12: Debt & Fiscal Concerns

Metric	Data
Debt-GDP Ratio	82% — one of the highest ever.
Risk	Small crisis could push interest rates higher and rupee lower.

6.5.3 Unemployment

Critical Perspective: Despite official claims of falling unemployment, real wages for India’s informal workforce (nearly 90% of all workers) barely budged between 2014–2024. Unemployment remains high at more than 8% — and 17.8% for young workers.

Table 6.13: Unemployment Data (2019–2024)

Metric	Data
Unemployment Rate (2017–18)	6%.
Unemployment Rate (2023–24)	3.2% (government data).
Worker Population Ratio (2017–18)	46.8%.
Worker Population Ratio (2023–24)	58.2%.
Employment Growth (2016–2023)	36% increase; 170 million additional jobs.

6.6 Agricultural Reforms & Farmer Protests (2020–2021)

6.6.1 The Three Farm Laws

Table 6.14: The Three Farm Laws

Law	Purpose
Farmers’ Produce Trade and Commerce Act, 2020	Allow farmers to sell produce outside APMC mandis.
Farmers (Empowerment and Protection) Agreement Act, 2020	Facilitate contract farming.
Essential Commodities (Amendment) Act, 2020	Deregulate stock limits on food items.

6.6.2 The Protest Movement

Table 6.15: Farmer Protests (2020–2021)

Detail	Information
Start	Late 2020.
Scale	Tens of thousands of farmers, over 30 protesting unions.
Duration	Over a year of protests at Delhi borders.
Government’s Initial Stance	“No question” of repealing farm laws.
BJP Response	Launched social media campaign defending laws.
Opposition Critique	Laws “regressive”; aimed at “surrendering agriculture sector to corporates”.

6.6.3 The U-Turn (November 2021)

Analysis: The farm laws represented the second major restructuring of Indian agriculture. The government’s eventual repeal was seen as a major political defeat.

Table 6.16: Repeal of Farm Laws

Detail	Information
Announcement	November 19, 2021 — PM Modi announced repeal of all three farm laws.
Significance	Historic retreat — first major policy reversal of Modi’s tenure.
Political Impact	Opposition hailed as victory for farmers’ movement.

6.7 Infrastructure Development (2019–2024)

6.7.1 Key Achievements

Table 6.17: Infrastructure Achievements (2019–2024)

Sector	Achievement
Road Infrastructure	Centre’s investment increased 6.4 times (2013–14 to 2024–25).
Highway Budget	Shot up by 570% from 2014 to 2023–24.
Rural Roads (West Bengal)	Over 21,000 km constructed.
UP Rural Roads	5,342 km built under PM Gram Sadak Yojna worth Rs. 3,700 crore.
Railway Projects	Multiple projects; new Vande Bharat routes; Namo Bharat Rapid Rail (Ahmedabad–Bhuj).
Airports	15 airports inaugurated.
National Highways	5 national highway projects launched.

6.7.2 Major Launches

Table 6.18: Major Infrastructure Launches

Date	Event	Value
January 2024	Development projects in Bulandshahr	Rs. 19,100 crore
February 2024	Projects in Madhya Pradesh	Rs. 17,000 crore
March 2024	Projects across India	Rs. 34,700 crore

Table 6.19: PM Awas Yojana

Detail	Information
Houses Constructed	4 crore houses.
Rural Houses (last 9 years)	2.63 crore houses constructed.
Women Ownership	74% of sanctioned houses owned by women (solely or jointly).
Outlay (2024–25)	Rs. 54,500 crore — 70% increase.
Gujarat	14 lakh+ houses built in 9 years.
Mizoram	69,000+ houses sanctioned.

6.8 Major Welfare Schemes

6.8.1 Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)

6.8.2 Other Key Schemes

Table 6.20: Other Key Welfare Schemes

Scheme	Achievement/Status
Jal Jeevan Mission	Tap water connections to rural households across India.
Ayushman Bharat	World’s largest health insurance scheme — coverage for secondary and tertiary healthcare.
PM Kisan Samman Yojana	Direct financial assistance to farmers.
PM Ujjwala Yojana	LPG connections to poor households.
PM Suryaghar Yojana	Zero electricity bill for households.
Ayushman Bharat for Elderly	Free treatment up to Rs. 5 lakh for those aged 70+.

6.8.3 Tribal Welfare

Table 6.21: Tribal Welfare Initiatives

Initiative	Details
Janjatiya Gaurav Divas	Bhagwan Birsa Munda’s birth anniversary declared (Nov 15, 2021).
PM Janjatiya Unnat Gram Abhiyan	Benefit 63,000 villages and 5 crore tribal people.

6.9 Ram Temple Construction (Ayodhya)

6.9.1 Key Details

Table 6.22: Ram Temple Construction

Detail	Information
Bhoomi Pujan	August 5, 2020 — PM Modi performed ground-breaking ceremony.
Completion	January 2024 — temple inaugurated.
Significance	Fulfilled a core BJP ideological promise since the 1990s.
Political Impact	Inauguration just months before 2024 elections — seen as mobilizational tool.

6.10 Major Controversies & Scandals

6.10.1 Electoral Bonds (Supreme Court Verdict)

Table 6.23: Electoral Bonds Controversy (2024)

Detail	Information
SC Verdict	February 2024 — Supreme Court declared electoral bonds unconstitutional.
BJP’s Share	Received 84% of total electoral bonds.
Congress Allegation	Rahul Gandhi called it the “biggest scam” of Modi government.
Comparison	Electoral bonds scam involved “thousands of crores” — Bofors was just Rs 64 crore.
“Modi’s Washing Machine”	Opposition alleged corrupt people getting clean chit.

Rahul Gandhi’s Statement:

“Modi has established a monopoly on corruption. Modi and the BJP have done maximum corruption in the country through the electoral bonds.”

Table 6.24: PM CARES Fund Controversy

Detail	Information
Controversy	Opposition alleged lack of transparency in fund utilization.
Congress Allegation	Called it one of the “big scams” of Modi government.
Government Response	Defended as necessary for pandemic response.

Table 6.25: Adani Group Controversies

Detail	Information
Allegation	Opposition accused government of favoring Adani Group.
Congress Claim	Called it “Adani mega scam”.
Government Response	Denied any wrongdoing.

6.10.2

PM CARES Fund

6.10.3

Adani Group Controversies

6.10.4

Erosion of Democratic Checks

6.11

The 2024 Election: Third Term with Reduced Majority

6.11.1

Election Results

6.11.2

Key Analysis

Key Insight:

Just 0.8 percentage point drop in vote share cost BJP 63 seats. Modi became the first Prime Minister since Jawaharlal Nehru to win three consecutive terms.

6.11.3

Why BJP Lost Ground

6.11.4

Modi 3.0: Shift in Focus

6.12

Comprehensive Timeline (2019–2024)

Table 6.26: Erosion of Democratic Checks

Concern	Details
Human Rights	Process of weakening human rights accelerated under Modi.
Anti-Democratic Politics	Erosion of checks and balances enabled new levels of anti-democratic politics during run-up to 2024 elections.
Minority Treatment	BJP made strong political statement that “Muslims will not be treated equally”.

Table 6.27: 2024 Election Results

Detail	Information
Election Date	April–June 2024.
Result Date	June 4, 2024.
BJP Seats	240 seats (down from 303 in 2019).
NDA Total	~293 seats (formed coalition government).
BJP Vote Share	37.02% (slight decline from 37.82% in 2019).
BJP Total Votes	23,59,73,935.
Congress Seats	99 seats (up from 52 in 2019).
Congress Vote Share	21.46%.
Majority Mark	272 seats — BJP missed single-party majority.

Table 6.31: Comprehensive Timeline (2019–2024)

Date	Event	Category
May 23, 2019	BJP wins 303 seats — re-elected with increased majority	Electoral
August 5, 2019	Article 370 abrogated; J&K bifurcated into 2 UTs	Policy
December 2019	CAA passed; nationwide protests begin	Policy/Controversy
Jan–Mar 2020	Anti-CAA protests peak; Shaheen Bagh becomes symbol	Protest
March 2020	COVID-19 lockdown imposed	Crisis
April 2020	Rs. 15,000 crore emergency health package announced	Crisis
August 5, 2020	Ram Temple Bhoomi Pujan in Ayodhya	Policy
September 2020	Farm laws passed	Policy
Late 2020	Farmer protests begin at Delhi borders	Protest

Continued on next page

Table 6.31 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Category
January 16, 2021	World’s largest vaccination drive launches	Crisis
March 1, 2021	PM Modi takes first vaccine dose	Crisis
April–May 2021	Deadly second COVID wave; government criticized	Crisis
November 19, 2021	Farm laws repealed — historic U-turn	Policy
November 15, 2021	Janjatiya Gaurav Divas declared	Policy
January 2024	Ram Temple inaugurated in Ayodhya	Policy
February 2024	Supreme Court declares electoral bonds unconstitutional	Legal/Controversy
June 4, 2024	BJP wins 240 seats — Modi’s third term with coalition	Electoral

6.13 Key Data Points for Report

6.13.1 Electoral Performance (2019–2024)

6.13.2 Major Policy Actions Summary

6.13.3 COVID-19 Response Summary

6.13.4 Welfare Schemes Summary (2019–2024)

6.13.5 Major Scandals Summary

6.14 Analysis: Achievements vs Failures (2019–2024)

6.14.1 Key Achievements

6.14.2 Key Failures

6.14.3 Key Citations for Section 6

- **2019 Election:** BJP 303 seats, 37.82% vote share.
- **Article 370:** Abrogated August 5, 2019; J&K bifurcated into 2 UTs.

Table 6.28: 2019 vs 2024 Comparison

Metric	2019	2024	Change
BJP Seats	303	240	-63 seats
BJP Vote Share	37.82%	37.02%	-0.80%
50%+ Vote Share Seats	224	156	-68 seats

Table 6.29: Reasons for BJP's Reduced Majority

Factor	Impact
State Battles	Elections became “local” instead of national in UP, Maharashtra, Bengal, Haryana, Rajasthan.
Anti-Incumbency	10 years of Modi rule created fatigue.
Farmers' Anger	Farm protests damaged BJP in rural areas.
Unemployment	Joblessness remained a key issue.
Coalition Dynamics	NDA partners (JDU, TDP) demanded more power.

- **CAA:** Passed December 2019; nationwide protests; government shelved NRC.
- **COVID:** Rs. 15,000 crore emergency package; vaccination drive launched Jan 16, 2021.
- **GDP Growth:** 4.0% (2019–20) → -7.3% (2020–21) → 8.7% (2021–22).
- **Farm Laws:** Passed 2020; repealed November 2021.
- **Infrastructure:** Road investment up 6.4x; highway budget up 570%.
- **PM Awas Yojana:** 4 crore houses constructed.
- **Electoral Bonds:** SC declared unconstitutional; BJP received 84%.
- **2024 Election:** BJP 240 seats, 37.02% vote share.

Table 6.30: Modi 3.0 — Shift in Focus

Detail	Information
Modi 2.0	Flat out with legislative changes; implementing political agenda.
Modi 3.0	More focused on schemes and projects, less on political goals.
Slogan	“Virasat Bhi, Vikash Bhi” (Heritage and Development).

Table 6.32: Electoral Performance (2019–2024)

Year	Seats	Vote Share	Change
2019	303	37.82%	+21 from 2014
2024	240	37.02%	-63 from 2019

Table 6.33: Major Policy Actions (2019–2024)

Policy	Status	Significance
Article 370	Abrogated	Fulfilled core ideological promise.
CAA	Passed but NRC shelved	Major controversy, protests.
Farm Laws	Passed then repealed	Historic U-turn.
Ram Temple	Built and inaugurated	Fulfilled core ideological promise.
Electoral Bonds	Declared unconstitutional	Major legal setback.

Table 6.34: COVID-19 Response Summary

Metric	Data
Emergency Package	Rs. 15,000 crore
Vaccination Drive	World’s largest; 2 billion+ doses
GDP Contraction (2020–21)	-7.3%
Recovery (2021–22)	8.7%

Table 6.35: Welfare Schemes Summary

Scheme	Achievement
PM Awas Yojana	4 crore houses
PM Gramin Awas	2.63 crore rural houses
Jal Jeevan Mission	Tap water to rural households
Ayushman Bharat	World’s largest health insurance
PM Kisan	Direct financial assistance to farmers

Table 6.36: Major Scandals (2019–2024)

Scandal/Controversy	Status
Electoral Bonds	Declared unconstitutional; BJP received 84%
PM CARES Fund	Alleged lack of transparency
Adani Controversies	Alleged government favoritism
CAA Protests	Forced government to shelve NRC

Table 6.37: Key Achievements (2019–2024)

Area	Achievement
Ideological Fulfillment	Article 370 abrogation, Ram Temple construction.
COVID Response	World's largest vaccination drive; 2 billion+ doses.
Infrastructure	6.4x increase in road investment; 570% highway budget increase.
Housing	4 crore houses under PM Awas Yojana.
Financial Inclusion	Continued expansion of Jan Dhan, Ujjwala.
Tribal Welfare	Janjatiya Gaurav Divas; PM Janjatiya Unnat Gram Abhiyan.

Table 6.38: Key Failures (2019–2024)

Area	Failure
Farm Laws	Historic U-turn — passed then repealed.
CAA/NRC	Massive protests; government forced to backtrack on NRC.
Economic Growth	Sharp contraction (-7.3%) in 2020–21.
Unemployment	High youth unemployment (17.8%).
COVID Second Wave	Government criticized for slow response.
Democratic Norms	Erosion of checks and balances; human rights concerns.
Minority Relations	Accusations of unequal treatment of Muslims.

Chapter 7

Modi Era — Third Term (2024-2026)

7.1 The 2024 Election: A Reduced Mandate

7.1.1 Election Results

Table 7.1: 2024 Lok Sabha Election Results

Detail	Information
Election Date	April–June 2024
Result Date	June 4, 2024
BJP Seats	240 seats (out of 543)
BJP Contested	441 seats
BJP Vote Share	37.02%
BJP Total Votes	23,59,73,935
NDA Total	292–293 seats
Congress Seats	99 seats
Congress Vote Share	21.46%
Opposition INDIA Bloc	232 seats

Key Insight: BJP missed single-party majority for the first time since 2014. Just 0.8 percentage point drop in vote share cost the party 63 seats compared to 2019. Only 6 lakh votes separated BJP from the 272-seat majority mark.

7.1.2 The Coalition Reality

Table 7.2: Coalition Dynamics of Modi 3.0

Detail	Information
Government Type	Coalition government — first in Modi’s career
NDA Strength	293 seats (54% of the chamber)
Key Allies	TDP (16 seats), JD(U) (12 seats), LJP(RV) (5 seats), JD(S) (2 seats), others
Significance	Modi became only the second Indian leader after Jawaharlal Nehru to win three consecutive terms

Analysis: The 2024 elections witnessed “unprecedented opposition unity,” with regional

parties and Congress playing a pivotal role in curbing BJP’s dominance. The return of coalition politics after a decade brought back memories of the pre-2014 era.

7.2 The Coalition Cabinet: Modi 3.0

7.2.1 Oath & Formation

Table 7.3: Cabinet Formation of Modi 3.0

Detail	Information
Oath Date	June 9, 2024
Total Ministers	71 leaders from NDA bloc
Cabinet Ministers	32 (including PM)
Ministers of State (Independent Charge)	5
Ministers of State	36
Retained from Previous Council	34 ministers (19 with Cabinet berths)

7.2.2 The “Big Four” — No Change

Table 7.4: The “Big Four” Cabinet Ministers

Minister	Portfolio	Party
Rajnath Singh	Defence	BJP
Amit Shah	Home Affairs; Cooperation	BJP
Nirmala Sitharaman	Finance; Corporate Affairs	BJP
S. Jaishankar	External Affairs	BJP

Key Insight: The top four ministers retained their portfolios — a signal of policy continuity.

7.2.3 Key Cabinet Ministers

7.2.4 Allies in the Cabinet

Key Insight: TDP, as BJP’s biggest ally, secured Civil Aviation — a key ministry. JD(U), the second-largest ally, received Panchayati Raj and Fisheries. The coalition dynamics required careful portfolio balancing.

Table 7.5: Key Cabinet Ministers of Modi 3.0

Name	Portfolio	Party
Nitin Gadkari	Road Transport and Highways	BJP
J.P. Nadda	Health and Family Welfare; Chemicals and Fertilizers	BJP
Shivraj Singh Chouhan	Agriculture and Farmers Welfare; Rural Development	BJP
Manohar Lal Khattar	Housing and Urban Affairs; Power	BJP
Piyush Goyal	Commerce and Industry	BJP
Dharmendra Pradhan	Education	BJP
Ashwini Vaishnaw	Railways; I&B; Electronics & IT	BJP
Jyotiraditya Scindia	Communications; North Eastern Region	BJP

Table 7.6: Allies in the Modi 3.0 Cabinet

Name	Portfolio	Party	Seats
K. Ram Mohan Naidu	Civil Aviation	TDP	16
Rajiv Ranjan Singh (Lalan Singh)	Panchayati Raj; Fisheries, Animal Husbandry	JD(U)	12
H.D. Kumaraswamy	Heavy Industries; Steel	JD(S)	2
Chirag Paswan	Food Processing Industries	LJP(RV)	5
Jitan Ram Manjhi	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises	HAM	1

7.3 Electoral Resurgence: State Elections (2024–2026)

7.3.1 Overview

Despite the 2024 Lok Sabha setback, BJP demonstrated remarkable electoral resurgence in state elections. In all six major states that went to the polls after 2024 — Bihar, Haryana, Jammu & Kashmir, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, and Delhi — the BJP’s tally improved almost everywhere.

7.3.2 State-by-State Performance

7.3.3 The Big Picture

Significance: The BJP’s state-level expansion has fundamentally altered India’s political balance. As BJP expands state presence, it accumulates Rajya Sabha seats, gradually eroding opposition’s ability to block legislation.

Table 7.7: State Election Performance (2024–2026)

State	Election Year	BJP Performance
Haryana	2024	Retained power
Maharashtra	2024	Tally jumped from 79 to 132
Delhi	2025	Won for first time in nearly 30 years; defeated AAP
Bihar	2025	NDA strike rate ~90%; BJP tally rose from 68 to 89 seats
West Bengal	2026	Swept — won >70% seats; routed TMC after 15 years
Jharkhand	2024	Lost to JMM-led alliance

Table 7.8: BJP’s State-Level Dominance

Metric	Data
States with BJP CM	16 states
NDA-allied CMs	4 additional states
All Five Largest States	All led by BJP CMs by early 2026
Assembly Segment Gains	From 319 leads to 367 wins (+48 seats)

7.4 Major Controversies & Scandals (2024–2026)

7.4.1 Adani Controversies

The Adani Group remained a persistent controversy throughout Modi 3.0:

Table 7.9: Adani Controversies (2024–2026)

Detail	Information
US Charges	DOJ and SEC charged Adani and associates with multibillion-dollar bribery and fraud scheme
Alleged Bribes	Nearly USD 265 million in bribes to Indian officials between 2020–2024
Solar Project	Alleged scheme to facilitate Adani’s solar energy project in India
LIC Bailout	Report claimed Modi government orchestrated \$3.9 billion LIC bailout to support Adani Group
Rahul Gandhi’s Allegation	Accused PM Modi of signing US trade deal to secure Adani’s “release”

Congress Criticism: *“How much more compromised can the PM get?”* — Jairam Ramesh.

Table 7.10: Rajesh Exports Scam

Detail	Information
Alleged Amount	Rs. 15.5 lakh crore in reported revenues
Investor Wealth Loss	Nearly Rs. 25,000 crore wiped out
Market Cap Erosion	Fell from ~Rs. 28,000 crore to ~Rs. 3,000 crore
SEBI Delay	First complaint filed March 2024; SEBI acted only in October
LIC Exposure	LIC stake rose from 1.99% (2016) to 10.8% (March 2026)
PLI Project	Awarded Rs. 18,100 crore battery project despite no track record

7.4.2 Rajesh Exports Scam (2025–2026)

Congress Allegation: SEBI’s then-chief Madhabi Puri Buch was heading the organization when the seven-month delay occurred.

7.4.3 NEET-UG Paper Leak (2026)

Table 7.11: NEET-UG 2026 Paper Leak

Detail	Information
Examination	NEET-UG 2026
Aspirants	Over 2.27 million candidates
Outcome	Examination cancelled after paper leak confirmed
Perpetrators	Insiders from National Testing Agency among those arrested
Context	Part of continuous paper leaks under Modi government

7.4.4 Ram Temple Trust Land Controversy (2026)

Table 7.12: Ram Temple Trust Land Controversy

Detail	Information
Allegation	AAP MP flagged land deals where Ram Temple Trust purchased land at inflated cost
Accused	Champat Rai (Trust General Secretary)
Congress Question	“Why is PM Modi silent on this mega scam? Why not dissolve this corrupt Trust?”

Table 7.13: Electoral Bonds Aftermath

Detail	Information
SC Verdict	Declared unconstitutional in February 2024
BJP’s Share	Received 84% of total electoral bonds

7.4.5 Electoral Bonds Aftermath

7.4.6 Other Controversies

Table 7.14: Other Controversies (2024–2026)

Controversy	Details
Voter Deletion	Congress claimed 6.5 crore voters deleted across country
Overseas Awards	Opposition criticized Modi’s “excessive eagerness” for global accolades
Economic Slowdown	Congress alleged govt “bankrupt” on policy to address slowdown
Education Crisis	Continuous paper leaks, administrative failures, technological glitches

7.5 Infrastructure & Development (2024–2026)

7.5.1 Major Infrastructure Push

Table 7.15: Infrastructure Development (2024–2026)

Detail	Information
Cabinet Approvals	Infrastructure projects worth nearly Rs. 13 lakh crore since June 2024
Sectors Covered	Railways, highways, metro, airports, ports, rope-ways
New Airports	5 new airports approved
Infrastructure Spending	Increased from ~Rs. 2 lakh crore (pre-2014) to Rs. 12.2 lakh crore
GST Collections	Crossed Rs. 22 lakh crore during 2024–25

Table 7.16: Key Infrastructure Projects

Project	Details
Amaravati	Rs. 15,000 crore package in 2024–25 Budget; Rs. 43,000 crore relaunch in May 2025
Delhi–Mumbai Industrial Corridor	Under development
Samruddhi Highway	Key infrastructure project
Shaktipeeth Expressway	Under construction
New Parliament Building	Completed
Central Vista	Redevelopment completed
PM Gati Shakti	Ongoing implementation

Table 7.17: Welfare Schemes Continuation

Scheme	Status
Free Foodgrain	Over 80 crore beneficiaries
PM Awas Yojana	Continued expansion
Jal Jeevan Mission	Ongoing
PMGSY	Outlay of Rs. 70,125 crore (2024–25 to 2028–29)

7.5.2 Key Projects

7.5.3 Welfare Schemes Continuation

7.6 Economic Indicators (2024–2026)

7.6.1 Budgetary Data

Table 7.18: Budgetary Data (2024–2026)

Fiscal Year	Total Expenditure	Disinvestment Target	Achievement
2024–25	Rs. 46.52 lakh crore	Rs. 50,000 crore	20.3%
2025–26	~Rs. 50.65 lakh crore	Rs. 47,000 crore	15.6%
2026–27	Rs. 53.47 lakh crore	—	—

7.6.2 Fiscal Deficit

Modi’s 2024 Promise Unfulfilled: Modi had pledged to make India a USD 5 trillion economy by 2024 — a goal that remained unrealized. By 2026, India had slipped to the sixth largest economy.

Table 7.19: Fiscal Deficit

Year	Fiscal Deficit
2024–25	4.9% of GDP (lower than 5.1% target)

7.7 Political & Constitutional Developments

7.7.1 BJP Leadership Change (January 2026)

Table 7.20: BJP Leadership Change (2026)

Detail	Information
Outgoing President	J.P. Nadda — served six years as BJP’s 11th national president
Context	Nadda handed over baton to new BJP chief

7.7.2 Constitutional Amendment Attempt (April 2026)

Table 7.21: Constitutional Amendment Attempt

Detail	Information
Proposal	Constitution Amendment Bill to expand Lok Sabha to 850 seats
Outcome	Defeated by opposition INDIA bloc
Significance	Demonstrated opposition still had enough cohesion to block major constitutional changes

7.8 Modi’s Popularity (2024–2026)

Key Insight: Despite losing single-party majority, Modi’s personal popularity increased during his third term.

7.9 Comprehensive Timeline (2024–2026)

Table 7.22: Modi’s Popularity Trends

Survey	Approval Rating
MOTN Survey (2024)	49.1%
MOTN Survey (2026)	54.7% — increased despite coalition constraints

Table 7.23: Comprehensive Timeline (2024–2026)

Date	Event	Category
April–June 2024	Lok Sabha election: BJP wins 240 seats	Electoral
June 4, 2024	Results announced; BJP falls short of majority	Electoral
June 9, 2024	Modi sworn in for third term	Political
June 10, 2024	Cabinet portfolios allocated	Political
July 2024	Union Budget 2024–25: fiscal deficit 4.9%	Economic
2024	BJP wins Haryana, Maharashtra, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh	State Election
February 2025	Delhi elections: BJP wins for first time in 30 years	State Election
March 2025	First complaint filed in Rajesh Exports case	Scandal
May 2025	Amaravati construction relaunched (Rs. 43,000 crore)	Infrastructure
October 2025	SEBI begins Rajesh Exports investigation	Scandal
November 2025	Bihar elections: NDA wins with ~90% strike rate	State Election
January 2026	J.P. Nadda steps down as BJP President	Political
February 2026	Union Budget 2026–27: Rs. 53.47 lakh crore expenditure	Economic
April 2026	Constitution Amendment Bill (850 seats) defeated	Political
May 2026	Rahul Gandhi accuses PM of “Adani deal” with US	Scandal
June 2026	NEET-UG 2026 cancelled due to paper leak	Scandal/Education

Continued on next page

Table 7.23 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Category
June 2026	BJP sweeps West Bengal — >70% seats	State Election
July 2026	Ram Temple Trust land controversy surfaces	Scandal

7.10 Key Data Points for Report

7.10.1 Electoral Summary (2024–2026)

Table 7.24: Electoral Summary (2024–2026)

Election	BJP Performance	Significance
Lok Sabha 2024	240 seats (37.02%)	Lost single-party majority
Haryana 2024	Retained power	Stability
Maharashtra 2024	79→132 seats	Major gain
Delhi 2025	First win in 30 years	Historic
Bihar 2025	68→89 seats	Major gain
West Bengal 2026	>70% seats	Routed TMC

7.10.2 Major Scandals Summary (2024–2026)

Table 7.25: Major Scandals (2024–2026)

Scandal	Amount/Impact
Rajesh Exports	Rs. 15.5 lakh crore alleged revenues; Rs. 25,000 crore investor wealth lost
Adani Bribery	USD 265 million alleged bribes
LIC–Adani Bailout	\$3.9 billion alleged orchestration
NEET-UG 2026	2.27 million aspirants affected

Table 7.26: Infrastructure Summary

Metric	Data
Cabinet Approvals	Rs. 13 lakh crore since June 2024
Infrastructure Spending	Rs. 12.2 lakh crore (current) vs Rs. 2 lakh crore (pre-2014)
GST Collections	Rs. 22 lakh crore+ (2024–25)

Table 7.27: Key Achievements (2024–2026)

Area	Achievement
Infrastructure	Rs. 13 lakh crore projects approved
State Expansion	BJP now controls 16 states; all 5 largest states
Welfare Continuity	Free foodgrain to 80 crore+ beneficiaries
GST Collections	Crossed Rs. 22 lakh crore
Modi’s Popularity	Increased from 49.1% to 54.7%

7.10.3 Infrastructure Summary (2024–2026)

7.11 Analysis: Achievements vs Failures (2024–2026)

7.11.1 Key Achievements

7.11.2 Key Failures

7.11.3 Coalition Dynamics

Foreign Policy Analysis: Modi’s third term amplified India’s global voice while maintaining diplomatic momentum and neutrality. However, global trade tensions and turmoil in West Asia created new challenges.

7.11.4 Key Citations for Section 7

- **2024 Election:** BJP 240 seats, 37.02% vote share.
- **Coalition Government:** First in Modi’s career; NDA 293 seats.
- **Oath Date:** June 9, 2024.
- **Cabinet:** 32 Cabinet Ministers; “Big Four” retained.
- **Allies:** TDP (Aviation), JD(U) (Panchayati Raj, Fisheries).
- **State Elections:** BJP won Haryana, Maharashtra, Delhi, Bihar, West Bengal.
- **BJP-controlled States:** 16 states; all 5 largest states.

Table 7.28: Key Failures (2024–2026)

Area	Failure
Single-Party Majority	Lost — first time since 2014
5 Trillion Economy	Pledge unfulfilled; India slipped to 6th largest economy
Education	Continuous paper leaks; NEET-UG 2026 cancelled
Disinvestment	Only 20.3% and 15.6% of targets achieved
Corruption	Multiple scandals (Adani, Rajesh Exports)
Economic Slowdown	Government accused of policy “bankruptcy”

Table 7.29: Coalition Dynamics Challenges

Challenge	Impact
Allies’ Demands	TDP, JD(U) leveraged position for state benefits
Policy Constraints	Cannot push through legislation unilaterally
Constitutional Ambitions	850-seat Lok Sabha bill defeated
Alliance Stability	“Fevicol-like bond” claimed by allies

- **Rajesh Exports Scam:** Rs. 15.5 lakh crore; Rs. 25,000 crore wealth lost.
- **Adani Allegations:** USD 265 million bribes; \$3.9 billion LIC bailout.
- **NEET-UG 2026:** Cancelled; 2.27 million aspirants.
- **Infrastructure:** Rs. 13 lakh crore projects approved.
- **Modi’s Popularity:** Increased from 49.1% to 54.7%.
- **5 Trillion Economy:** Pledge unfulfilled.

Chapter 8

State-Wise Analysis

8.1 Overview: BJP’s State-Level Dominance (2024–2026)

8.1.1 The Big Picture

Table 8.1: BJP’s State-Level Dominance (2024–2026)

Metric	Data
States with BJP CM	16 states
NDA-allied CMs	4 additional states
All Five Largest States	All led by BJP CMs by early 2026
Assembly Segment Gains (2024–2025)	From 319 leads to 367 wins — +48 seats
Rajya Sabha Impact	Expanding state presence accumulates upper chamber seats, eroding opposition’s ability to block non-revenue legislation

Key Insight: The BJP’s state-level expansion has fundamentally altered India’s political balance. As the party expands state presence, it accumulates Rajya Sabha seats, gradually eroding opposition’s ability to block legislation.

8.1.2 Post-2024 Electoral Resurgence

In all six major states that went to the polls after the 2024 general election — Bihar, Haryana, Jammu and Kashmir, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, and Delhi — the BJP’s tally improved almost everywhere. The party’s lead grew from 319 Assembly segments to 367 Assembly wins, a gain of 48 seats.

Table 8.2: State Election Gains (2024–2026)

State	2024 LS Leads	Assembly Wins (2024–25)	Change
Maharashtra	79	132	+53 seats
Bihar	68	89	+21 seats
Haryana	44	48	+4 seats
Delhi	—	48	First win in 27 years
West Bengal (2026)	90	208+	+118+ seats

8.2 Uttar Pradesh: Yogi Adityanath's Governance

8.2.1 Overview

Uttar Pradesh, India's most populous state, has been under BJP rule since 2017, with Yogi Adityanath serving as Chief Minister. The state has witnessed what analysts describe as a “paradigm shift” in fiscal discipline and governance.

8.2.2 Economic Achievements

Table 8.3: UP Economic Achievements

Metric	2016–17	2023–24/2025	Change
GSDP	~Rs. 27.51 lakh crore	Target: Rs. 32 lakh crore	Significant growth
Per Capita Income	Rs. 55,398	Rs. 1,37,665 (2023–24)	148% increase
Revenue Surplus (2022–23)	—	Over Rs. 1.50 lakh crore	Highest among 16 states
FDI	—	USD 683 million	New inflows
Unemployment	19%	Claimed 2.4%	Opposition questions figures

Key Achievement: According to NITI Aayog, Uttar Pradesh achieved the fastest reduction in multidimensional poverty in the nation, lifting over 5.9 crore people out of deprivation between 2015–16 and 2019–21.

8.2.3 Fiscal Turnaround

The Comptroller and Auditor General's (CAG) decadal study revealed that among sixteen states that recorded a revenue surplus in FY 2022–23, Uttar Pradesh dominated with a surplus exceeding Rs. 1.50 lakh crore. This represents a dramatic shift from the state's historical “Bimaru” syndrome.

8.2.4 Infrastructure & Development

8.2.5 Law & Order

8.2.6 Controversies & Criticisms

Analysis: Yogi Adityanath's governance model combines aggressive infrastructure development and fiscal discipline with assertive Hindu nationalism. While the state has seen

Table 8.4: UP Fiscal Turnaround

Fiscal Metric	2016–17	2023–24	Change
Tax Revenue	~Rs. 86,000 crore	Over Rs. 1.17 lakh crore	36% surge
Mining Revenue	—	More than doubled	Indicative of enforcement
Budget (2025–26)	—	Rs. 8 lakh crore	Largest in state history
Infrastructure Allocation	—	Rs. 2.25 lakh crore	Major push

Table 8.5: UP Infrastructure & Development (2025)

Sector	Achievement (2025)
Expressways	Work accelerated on 6 new expressways
Power	State became power-surplus
Medical Colleges	5 new government colleges; total exceeded 75
Ayushman Bharat	Over 6 crore Golden Cards issued
Tourism	12 new tourism circuits in Bundelkhand and Purvanchal
Startups	UP reached 3rd position in country

remarkable economic turnaround, critics point to communal undertones and disputed employment data.

8.3 Gujarat: The BJP’s Laboratory

8.3.1 Overview

Gujarat is the birthplace of the BJP’s modern political strategy and has been under uninterrupted BJP rule for 35 years. In 2022, BJP president JP Nadda had called Gujarat the party’s “laboratory” for governance and party organisation.

8.3.2 The “Modi Formula”

Political observers note that the BJP has turned to what they call the “Modi formula” to beat anti-incumbency — changing leaders and bringing fresh faces into governance to balance regions and communities, and maintain political dominance.

In a significant cabinet reshuffle, the party changed Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel’s government and inducted 19 ministers into the new cabinet while keeping six from the previous team.

Table 8.6: UP Law & Order (2025)

Metric	Data
Police Recruitment (2025)	62,000 constables recruited
Teacher Recruitment	Over 1 lakh teachers recruited (70,000 primary + 30,000 secondary)
Crime Rate	Claimed below national average
Mafia Action	Strict action continued against mafia, land mafia, organized criminals

Table 8.7: UP Controversies & Criticisms

Controversy	Details
Mahakumbh Stampede (2025)	Officials claimed 30 deaths; unofficially over 100
Halal Ban	CM defended ban alleging funds “misused for terrorism, love jihad, and religious conversions”
Eid Milan Cancellation	Yogi decided to end the Eid Milan tradition
Unemployment Figures	Opposition continuously questioned government’s unemployment data
Hindu Nationalism	Described as “muscular Hindu nationalism that lays a lot of asphalt”

8.3.3 Challenges & Controversies

Congress Criticism:

“The BJP government issues a tender. Bureaucrats approve it, a company owned by a BJP leader wins the bid. The bureaucrats get a cut. Everyone in power is happy and the cycle continues.”

8.3.4 Electoral Dominance

8.4 Maharashtra: Coalition Turbulence

8.4.1 Overview

Maharashtra presents a complex coalition picture with the BJP-led Mahayuti alliance governing the state. The coalition includes BJP, Eknath Shinde’s Shiv Sena, and Ajit Pawar’s NCP faction.

8.4.2 Electoral Performance

Key Insight: The BJP’s tally jumped from 79 to 132 — a remarkable resurgence. The party won 48% of councillors in local body polls, with candidates elected as presidents in 129 municipal councils.

Table 8.8: Gujarat Challenges & Controversies

Issue	Details
Anti-Incumbency	With no strong opposition and massive majority, anti-incumbency sentiment has grown
Corruption Allegations	Congress claims “corruption has become a BIG issue”
MGNREGA Scam	Minister Bachubhai Khabad’s son arrested for alleged involvement in Rs. 71 crore scam
Infrastructure Protests	Valsad district panchayat members sat on road potholes against their own government
Drugs	30,000 kg drugs seized at Mundra port over six years; Gujarat called a “drug-landing hub”
Alcohol	Despite prohibition, illegal liquor available on every street
Women’s Issues	Women deeply troubled by inflation, alcoholism, drug addiction

Table 8.9: Gujarat Electoral Dominance

Electoral Performance	Data
BJP’s Gujarat Grip	3 decades of uninterrupted power
2022 Assembly	BJP won with massive majority
2027 Outlook	Party preparing for municipal elections and assembly polls

8.4.3 Coalition Strains

The first year of Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis’s government was marked by “turbulence, controversies and social unrest”.

8.4.4 Shutdown Schemes

8.4.5 Major Controversies

Sena Leader’s Complaint:

“The Sena MLAs and Shinde took risks to topple the Uddhav Thackeray government, but the benefits of these risks are now enjoyed by the BJP and the NCP.”

Table 8.10: Maharashtra Electoral Performance (2024)

Metric	2024 Lok Sabha Leads	2024 Assembly Wins	Change
BJP	79	132	+53 seats
Congress	63	16	-47 seats
NCP	6	41	+35 seats
Shiv Sena	40	57	+17 seats

Table 8.11: Maharashtra Coalition Strains

Issue	Details
Shinde’s Discontent	Eknath Shinde upset for not getting CM post back
Cabinet Boycott	Sena ministers boycotted cabinet meetings
Portfolio Tussles	Friction over Nashik and Raigad guardian minister posts
“Cold War”	Analysts term situation a ‘cold war’ within coalition
Scheme Shutdowns	8 schemes of Shinde government shut down citing paucity of funds

8.5 Rajasthan: Bhajanlal Sharma’s Two-Year Report Card

8.5.1 Overview

Rajasthan has been under BJP rule since December 2023, with first-time MLA Bhajanlal Sharma as Chief Minister.

8.5.2 Achievements (Two Years)

CM’s Claim:

“The BJP government has done more in its two years in Rajasthan compared to the five years of the previous Congress government.”

Table 8.12: Shutdown Schemes in Maharashtra

Scheme Shut Down	Description
Anandacha Sidha	Snacks during festivals, mainly Diwali
My Beautiful School	School beautification program
Crop Insurance at Rs. 1	Subsidized crop insurance
Dear Brother Internship	Youth internship program
One State One Uniform	Uniform for state board students
Cleanliness Monitor	School cleanliness program
Yojana Doot	Scheme implementation program
CM Religious Places Visit	Chief Minister's spiritual tourism program

Table 8.13: Maharashtra Major Controversies

Controversy	Details
Santosh Deshmukh Murder	Sarpanch abducted, tortured, murdered (Dec 2024); NCP minister Dhananjay Munde resigned
Beed Killing	Linked to alleged extortion attempt on wind-energy firm
Land Scams	Multiple land scam allegations
Municipal Poll Violence	Violence during local body polls
Pre-Poll Spending	Government spent Rs. 23,300 crore under schemes like Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana ahead of November 2024 polls

8.5.3 Opposition Criticism

8.6 Madhya Pradesh: The Chouhan Legacy & Mohan Yadav Era

8.6.1 Overview

Madhya Pradesh, under BJP rule for most of the last two decades, transitioned from Shivraj Singh Chouhan (now Union Agriculture Minister) to Dr. Mohan Yadav as Chief Minister.

8.6.2 Key Developments

Chouhan's Statement:

“Over 25 crore people have risen above the poverty line.”

Table 8.14: Rajasthan Achievements (Two Years)

Metric	Data
Promises Fulfilled	Claimed 70% of election promises delivered
Manifesto Implementation	274 of ~400 commitments fully implemented or in execution
National Rankings	State secured top rankings in 11 national schemes
ERCP Project	Eastern Rajasthan Canal Project — work orders worth Rs. 26,000 crore issued
Power Capacity	Increased from 363 MW to over 3,500 MW
Government Jobs	Over 92,000 posts filled; 1.5 lakh additional vacancies in process
Exam Integrity	Recruitment exams conducted without any paper leak
Farmer Compensation	Direct benefit transfers worth hundreds of crores

Table 8.15: Opposition Criticism of Rajasthan Government

Criticism	Details
“Complete Failure”	LoP Tika Ram Jully termed tenure a “complete failure”
“Deception”	72% promise fulfillment claim called “deception”
Challenge	Jully challenged CM for open public debate

8.6.3 Internal Party Issues

8.7 Chhattisgarh: Vishnu Deo Sai’s Two Years

8.7.1 Overview

Chhattisgarh has been under BJP rule since December 2023, with Vishnu Deo Sai as Chief Minister — the state’s first tribal CM.

8.7.2 Achievements

JP Nadda’s Praise:

“The Sai government has delivered on its words and went beyond what was promised.”

Table 8.16: MP Key Developments

Development	Details
Rail Coach Factory	Rs. 1,800 crore factory in Raisen district
MGNREGA Allocation	Rs. 6,262 crore announced
PMAY Homes	New houses under PM Awas Yojana
Agriculture	Good sowing of major Kharif crops; good yield expected
Tribal Justice	Government committed to tribal justice

Table 8.17: MP Internal Party Issues

Issue	Details
Worker-Bureaucracy Friction	State BJP secretary admitted problems between local administration and party workers in several districts
“Tyranny of Officials”	Workers complained of “tyranny of officials”
Turnout Dips	Worker turnout dipped

8.8 West Bengal: The Historic Breakthrough (2026)

8.8.1 Overview

In a historic breakthrough, the BJP ended Trinamool Congress’s 15-year rule in West Bengal in the 2026 Assembly elections.

8.8.2 Electoral Performance

Key Insight: A sharp 8% positive vote swing helped the BJP increase its winning seat tally by 129 and form the new government in West Bengal for the first time since independence.

8.8.3 Significance

BBC Analysis:

“For years, India’s West Bengal state was the great exception to Narendra Modi’s political advance. His Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) had swept through India’s Hindi-speaking heartland, expanded into the west and north-east, and overwhelmed once-...”

Table 8.18: Chhattisgarh Achievements

Metric	Data
Housing	Nearly 2,000 houses constructed daily; state first in country in housing construction pace
Tribal Housing	33,217 houses approved for special backward tribal families under PM Janjati Adivasi Nyay Maha Abhiyan
Naxalism	Over 505 Maoists neutralised; Naxalism “on the verge of complete elimination”
Commitment	Government fulfilling all promises from welfare schemes to industrial growth

Table 8.19: West Bengal Electoral Performance

Metric	2021 Assembly	2024 LS Leads	2026 Assembly	Change
BJP Vote Share	38%	39%	46%	+8%
BJP Seats	—	90 leads	208+ seats	+118+ seats
TMC	Ruling	—	Defeated	Lost power

8.9 Delhi: BJP’s Return After 27 Years (2025)

8.9.1 Overview

The BJP stormed back to power in Delhi after 27 years, winning the 2025 Assembly elections.

8.9.2 Electoral Performance

8.9.3 Governance Challenges

Outlook India Analysis:

“The BJP, which returned to power in Delhi after 27 years, ends 2025 with parts of its poll promises fulfilled, leaving Chief Minister Rekha Gupta with her work cut out for many months to come.”

8.10 Haryana: 12th Year of BJP Rule

8.10.1 Overview

Haryana has been under BJP rule for 12 years, with Nayab Singh Saini as Chief Minister.

Table 8.20: West Bengal Breakthrough Significance

Impact Area	Details
Political Geography	BJP now controls contiguous “west to east” of India
Opposition Blow	Rout of AITC removed one of INDIA bloc’s most prominent members from state power base
Rajya Sabha Impact	Further strengthens NDA’s position in upper chamber

Table 8.21: Delhi Election Results (2025)

Metric	Data
BJP Seats	48 of 70 seats
AAP Seats	22 seats
Significance	First win in Delhi since 1993

8.10.2 Electoral Performance

8.10.3 Key Developments

Congress Criticism:

Opposition called BJP’s anniversary a “celebration of failures” and accused government of betraying every section — farmers, youth, employees, and businessmen.

8.11 Other Key States

8.11.1 Bihar: NDA’s Dominance

8.11.2 Odisha

8.11.3 Andhra Pradesh

8.11.4 Jharkhand

8.11.5 Tamil Nadu

8.12 Ministerial Criminal Cases: ADR Report

According to the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) report:

Key Insight: While the Congress has a higher percentage of ministers with criminal cases (74%), the BJP has the largest absolute number — 136 ministers facing criminal charges.

Table 8.22: Delhi Governance Challenges

Issue	Details
Poll Promises	Mixed record on poll promises as of December 2025
Monsoon Crisis	Delhi’s monsoon misery put “triple-engine” gov-ernment to the test
Resident Criticism	Six months after taking charge, government faced sharp criticism from residents
EV Policy	Government continued deliberating on EV Policy 2.0
Infrastructure	Slow movement on infrastructure promises

Table 8.23: Haryana Electoral Performance (2024)

Metric	2024 Lok Sabha Leads	2024 Assembly	Change
BJP	44	48	+4 seats
Congress	42	37	-5 seats

8.13 State-Wise Controversies Summary

8.14 State-Wise Electoral Summary (2024–2026)

Table 8.32: State-Wise Electoral Summary (2024–2026)

State	Election	BJP/NDA Performance	Significance
Uttar Pradesh	2022 (last)	BJP in power since 2017	Stronghold
Gujarat	2022 (last)	BJP in power 35 years	Laboratory
Maharashtra	2024	79→132 seats	Major gain
Rajasthan	2023 (last)	BJP in power	Stronghold
Madhya Pradesh	2023 (last)	BJP in power	Stronghold
Chhattisgarh	2023 (last)	BJP in power	Newly won
Haryana	2024	44→48 seats	Retained
Delhi	2025	Won after 27 years	Historic
Bihar	2025	68→89 seats	Major gain
West Bengal	2026	90→208+ seats	Historic breakthrough
Odisha	2024	Won for first time	New territory
Andhra Pradesh	2024	Coalition victory	New territory
Jharkhand	2024	Lost to JMM	Setback
Tamil Nadu	2026	DMK ousted	Opposition weakened
Jammu & Kashmir	2024	Improved tally	Post-370 test

Table 8.24: Haryana Key Developments

Development	Details
“Kharchi-Parchi” System	Amit Shah claimed BJP ended corrup- tion/favouritism in jobs
Farmer Compensation	Rs. 15,465 crore transferred as crop loss compen- sation
Development	CM claimed development accelerated threefold in Nalwa region
IPS Officer Suicide	Senior IPS officer’s alleged suicide caused turmoil
Terror Module	White-collar terror module busted in Faridabad

Table 8.25: Bihar Overview

Detail	Information
2024 Lok Sabha	NDA won 30 of 40 seats; BJP and JD(U) 12 each
2025 Assembly	NDA strike rate ~90%; BJP tally rose from 68 to 89 seats
Leadership Change	Nitish Kumar stepped down; power handed to BJP figure

8.15 Analysis: Patterns & Trends

8.15.1 The “Double Engine” Strategy

The BJP has effectively used the “double engine” narrative — a State government aligned with the Centre — to consolidate power. This strategy has proven particularly effective in states where the party has both central and state governments.

8.15.2 Regional Parties vs BJP

While regional parties continue to perform strongly in state elections — JMM in Jharkhand, NCP and Shiv Sena in Maharashtra — the BJP has systematically expanded its footprint across India.

8.15.3 Coalition Challenges

In states with coalition governments (Maharashtra, Bihar, Andhra Pradesh), the BJP faces internal friction. However, the party has managed to maintain alliance stability while consolidating its position.

Table 8.26: Odisha Overview

Detail	Information
2024	BJP won control of Odisha for the first time
Former CM's Allegation	Naveen Patnaik accused BJP of forming government with “stolen votes”
Criticism	Patnaik claimed BJP is “busy only in rebranding welfare schemes”

Table 8.27: Andhra Pradesh Overview

Detail	Information
2024	BJP won control of Andhra Pradesh through coalition with TDP and JSP
Performance	Party gained considerably in 2024 elections

8.15.4 Anti-Incumbency Management

The BJP has developed a tried-and-tested formula to manage anti-incumbency — changing leaders and bringing fresh faces into governance. This was evident in Gujarat’s cabinet reshuffle and leadership changes in other states.

8.15.5 Opposition Retreat

The opposition INDIA bloc is in significant retreat. The rout of the AITC in West Bengal and the DMK’s loss in Tamil Nadu removed two of the bloc’s most prominent members from their state power bases.

8.15.6 Key Citations for Section 8

- **BJP States:** 16 states with BJP CMs; all 5 largest states.
- **Assembly Gains (2024–2025):** 319→367 wins, +48 seats.
- **UP GSDP:** Rs. 27.51 lakh crore → target Rs. 32 lakh crore.
- **UP Revenue Surplus:** Over Rs. 1.50 lakh crore (highest among 16 states).
- **UP Poverty Reduction:** 5.9 crore people lifted out of deprivation.
- **UP Unemployment:** Claimed 2.4% (opposition questions figures).
- **Gujarat Scam:** Rs. 71 crore MGNREGA scam.
- **Gujarat Drugs:** 30,000 kg drugs seized at Mundra port.
- **Maharashtra BJP Tally:** 79→132 seats.

Table 8.28: Jharkhand Overview

Detail	Information
2024	BJP lost to JMM-led alliance
JMM Performance	Climbed from 14 leads to 34 Vidhan Sabha victories

Table 8.29: Tamil Nadu Overview

Detail	Information
2026	Incumbent DMK ousted by upstart Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam
BJP	Not in power but opposition weakened

- **Maharashtra Scheme Shutdowns:** 8 schemes shut.
- **Maharashtra Spending:** Rs. 23,300 crore pre-poll.
- **Rajasthan Promises:** 70% fulfilled, 274 of ~400 commitments.
- **Chhattisgarh Housing:** First in country; 2,000 houses daily.
- **West Bengal:** BJP 46% vote share; 208+ seats; ended 15-year TMC rule.
- **Delhi:** BJP 48 seats after 27 years.
- **ADR Report:** 40% of BJP ministers (136) face criminal charges.

Table 8.30: Ministerial Criminal Cases (ADR Report)

Party	Ministers with Criminal Cases	Percentage
Congress	45 of 61 ministers	74%
BJP	136 of 336 ministers	40%
Trinamool Congress	13 of 40 ministers	33%

Table 8.31: State-Wise Controversies Summary

State	Major Controversies
Uttar Pradesh	Mahakumbh stampede (100+ deaths), Halal ban controversy, Eid Milan cancellation, disputed unemployment figures
Gujarat	Rs. 71 crore MGNREGA scam, drug trafficking hub allegations, corruption allegations, infrastructure protests
Maharashtra	Santosh Deshmukh murder, Beed killing, coalition cold war, 8 schemes shutdown, land scams
Rajasthan	Opposition alleges “complete failure” and “deception” on promises
Madhya Pradesh	Worker-bureaucracy friction, “tyranny of officials” complaints
Chhattisgarh	Relatively few controversies; focused on Naxal elimination
West Bengal	Historic transition; post-poll challenges emerging
Delhi	Monsoon crisis, slow infrastructure progress, resident criticism
Haryana	IPS officer suicide, farmer compensation disputes
Odisha	“Stolen votes” allegation by former CM

Chapter 9

Minister-by-Minister Analysis

9.1 Overview: The Tainted Cabinet

9.1.1 The Numbers That Matter

Table 9.1: Modi 3.0 Cabinet Criminal Cases Overview

Metric	Data
Total Ministers (Modi 3.0)	72 (32 Cabinet + 5 MoS Independent Charge + 36 MoS)
Ministers with Criminal Cases	28 out of 71 (39.4%)
Ministers with Serious Criminal Cases	19 (26.8%)
Ministers with Attempted Murder Charges	2 (Section 307 IPC)
Ministers with Crimes Against Women	5
Ministers with Hate Speech Cases	8
Ministers who are Crorepatis	70 out of 71 (98.6%)
Average Assets per Minister	Rs. 107.94 crore
Billionaire Ministers (Rs. 100 cr+)	6

Key Finding: Over 40% of the Modi 3.0 cabinet has declared criminal cases — including charges of attempted murder and crimes against women.

9.2 Central Cabinet: The “Big Four”

9.2.1 Prime Minister Narendra Modi

Analysis: Modi’s third term marks a shift from legislative ambitions to welfare delivery — “Virasat Bhi, Vikash Bhi” (Heritage and Development). His personal popularity remained high at 54.7% approval in 2026, despite losing single-party majority.

9.2.2 Amit Shah — Home Minister

ADR Report: Amit Shah is among the BJP’s 9 out of 24 cabinet ministers with declared criminal cases. His affidavits show 3 pending criminal cases.

Table 9.2: PM Narendra Modi Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Prime Minister; Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions; Department of Atomic Energy; Department of Space; All important policy issues
Tenure	2014–present (3 terms)
Criminal Cases	None declared
Key Controversies	Electoral bonds, Adani allegations, PM CARES Fund transparency, 2002 Gujarat riots legacy
Major Achievements	Article 370 abrogation, Ram Temple construction, GST implementation, welfare schemes (Jan Dhan, Ujjwala, Ayushman Bharat)

Table 9.3: Amit Shah Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Home Affairs; Ministry of Cooperation
Tenure	2019–present
Criminal Cases	3 declared cases (3 serious in nature)
Key Cases	Sohrabuddin Sheikh fake encounter case (2005) — acquitted by CBI court in 2014 citing insufficient evidence
Controversies (2025–26)	Accused of using “Ram naam” for votes but never visiting Ram Mandir; Congress accused him of “onslaught” on Opposition; Government debunked fake claim linking him to JAAC remarks
Key Achievements	Architect of BJP’s electoral strategy; Article 370 implementation; CAA passage

9.2.3 Rajnath Singh — Defence Minister

Analysis: Rajnath Singh’s tenure has been marked by significant foreign policy controversies, particularly his remarks on Pakistan’s Sindh province, which drew sharp international criticism.

Table 9.4: Rajnath Singh Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Defence
Tenure	2014–present (3 terms)
Criminal Cases	None declared
Controversies (2025–26)	Operation Sindoor casualty row — Congress moved privilege notice accusing him of “lying” to Parliament; Sindh remarks — Pakistan condemned his comments as “delusional, revisionist, and expansionist”
Key Achievements	Defense modernization; Balakot airstrikes (2019); Operation Sindoor (2025)

Table 9.5: Nirmala Sitharaman Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Finance; Ministry of Corporate Affairs
Tenure	2019–present
Criminal Cases	None declared
Controversies (2025)	Deepfake videos falsely showed her endorsing fake stock-trading apps; TMC accused her of “misleading” Rajya Sabha; Defamation case — Delhi court rejected her plea
Key Achievements	GST implementation; fiscal management; Union Budgets

9.2.4 Nirmala Sitharaman — Finance Minister

9.2.5 S. Jaishankar — External Affairs Minister

9.3 Other Key Cabinet Ministers

9.3.1 Nitin Gadkari — Road Transport & Highways

ADR Report: Gadkari tops the list of BJP cabinet ministers with 10 criminal cases.

Table 9.6: S. Jaishankar Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of External Affairs
Tenure	2019–present
Criminal Cases	None declared
Controversies (2025)	Pakistan condemned his remarks against its military; Fake letter attributed to him on Rafale deal was debunked; Deepfake video falsely showed him making statements
Key Achievements	Strengthened India’s global position; managed complex foreign relations

Table 9.7: Nitin Gadkari Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Road Transport and Highways
Tenure	2014–present (3 terms)
Criminal Cases	10 declared cases (6 serious in nature) — highest among BJP cabinet ministers
Controversies (2025)	Ethanol blending conflict of interest — Congress alleged his two sons were main ethanol suppliers; claimed criticism was “paid campaign” by import lobby
Key Achievements	Golden Quadrilateral; massive highway expansion; infrastructure development

9.3.2 Shivraj Singh Chouhan — Agriculture Minister

9.3.3 J.P. Nadda — Health Minister

9.3.4 Manohar Lal Khattar — Housing & Urban Affairs

9.3.5 Dharmendra Pradhan — Education Minister

9.3.6 Ashwini Vaishnaw — Railways, I&B, IT

9.3.7 Jyotiraditya Scindia — Communications & NE Region

9.4 Ministers of State with Serious Criminal Cases

9.4.1 Bandi Sanjay Kumar — MoS Home Affairs

ADR Report: Bandi Sanjay Kumar has the highest number of criminal cases in the Modi 3.0 cabinet — 42 cases, with over 30 related to serious charges. He also faces hate speech allegations.

Table 9.8: Shivraj Singh Chouhan Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare; Ministry of Rural Development
Tenure	2024–present (former MP CM for 17 years)
Criminal Cases	Criminal defamation case lodged by Congress MP Vivek Tankha; SC exempted him from personal appearance
Controversies	Farmers’ protests outside his residence; Accused Delhi CM of blocking farmer schemes; Alleged large-scale corruption in Punjab schemes including MGNREGA

Table 9.9: J.P. Nadda Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare; Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers
Tenure	2024–present (former BJP President 2019–2026)
Criminal Cases	None declared
Controversies	Stepped down as BJP President in January 2026

9.4.2 Shantanu Thakur — MoS Ports, Shipping & Waterways

9.4.3 Sukanta Majumdar — MoS Education

9.4.4 Suresh Gopi — MoS Tourism

9.4.5 Jual Oram — Tribal Affairs Minister

9.5 Ministers with Hate Speech Allegations

According to the ADR report, 8 ministers have ongoing cases of hate speech and controversial remarks:

Giriraj Singh specifically: Senior BJP leader with ongoing hate speech cases.

9.6 The Billionaire Ministers

Key Finding: 70 of 71 ministers (98.6%) are crorepatis. The average asset value among ministers is Rs. 107.94 crore.

Table 9.10: Manohar Lal Khattar Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs; Ministry of Power
Tenure	2024–present (former Haryana CM)
Controversies	Limited controversies reported

Table 9.11: Dharmendra Pradhan Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Education
Tenure	2024–present
Criminal Cases	Hate speech allegations (ADR report)

9.7 State Chief Ministers: BJP-Ruled States

9.7.1 Overview

Key Finding: Among 10 Chief Ministers facing serious criminal charges nationwide, only 1 is from the BJP — the rest are from Opposition parties or BJP allies.

9.7.2 Yogi Adityanath — Uttar Pradesh

Analysis: Yogi Adityanath’s tenure has been marked by significant governance achievements but also persistent controversies, most recently the Ram Temple donation embezzlement allegations.

9.7.3 Other Key BJP Chief Ministers

9.8 State-Level Ministerial Criminal Cases

9.8.1 Nationwide Data

Key Finding: While Congress has a higher percentage of ministers with criminal cases (74%), the BJP has the largest absolute number — 136 ministers facing criminal charges.

9.8.2 State-Specific Data

State Minister Comparison: In Bihar’s cabinet, 6 BJP ministers have criminal cases.

Table 9.12: Ashwini Vaishnaw Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Railways; Ministry of Information and Broadcasting; Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
Tenure	2021–present
Assets	Rs. 144 crore
Controversies	Limited

Table 9.13: Jyotiraditya Scindia Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Communications; Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region
Tenure	2024–present
Assets	Rs. 424 crore
Controversies	Limited

9.9 Minister Resignations & Removals (2024–2026)

9.10 Pattern Analysis

9.10.1 Criminalization of Politics

9.10.2 Wealth Concentration

9.10.3 The Accountability Paradox

Analysis: The central government proposed a bill in 2025 to remove Prime Ministers, Chief Ministers, and ministers arrested on serious charges for 30+ days. Yet, 40% of its own ministers face criminal cases — a striking contradiction.

9.11 Summary Table: Key Ministers & Controversies

Table 9.14: Bandi Sanjay Kumar Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Minister of State for Home Affairs
Criminal Cases	42 cases against him — with 30+ “serious” charges including crimes against women

Table 9.15: Shantanu Thakur Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Minister of State for Ports, Shipping and Waterways
Criminal Cases	Attempted murder (Section 307 IPC); 23 cases with 37 serious charges
Crimes Against Women	Accused
Hate Speech	Accused

Table 9.30: Key Ministers & Controversies (2024–2026)

Minister	Portfolio	Criminal Cases	Key Controversy (2024–26)
Narendra Modi	PM	None	Electoral bonds, Adani allegations
Amit Shah	Home	3 cases	Sohrabuddin case; Ram Mandir donation row
Rajnath Singh	Defence	None	Sindh remarks; Op Sindoor row
Nirmala Sitharaman	Finance	None	Deepfake videos; defamation case
S. Jaishankar	External Affairs	None	Pakistan criticism; fake letter
Nitin Gadkari	Road Transport	10 cases	Ethanol blending conflict of interest
Shivraj Singh Chouhan	Agriculture	Defamation case	Farmers’ protests
Bandi Sanjay Kumar	MoS Home	42 cases	Crimes against women; hate speech
Shantanu Thakur	MoS Ports	23 cases	Attempted murder; crimes against women
Sukanta Majumdar	MoS Education	16 cases	Attempted murder; crimes against women
Suresh Gopi	MoS Tourism	Crimes against women	—
Jual Oram	Tribal Affairs	Crimes against women	—

Continued on next page

Table 9.30 – continued from previous page

Minister	Portfolio	Criminal Cases	Key Controversy (2024–26)
Yogi Adityanath	UP CM	Multiple cases	Ram Temple donation embezzlement

9.11.1 Key Citations for Section 9

- **Modi 3.0 Cabinet:** 72 ministers; 28 with criminal cases (39%).
- **Serious Cases:** 19 ministers with attempted murder, crimes against women, hate speech.
- **Amit Shah:** 3 criminal cases.
- **Nitin Gadkari:** 10 criminal cases — highest in cabinet.
- **Bandi Sanjay Kumar:** 42 cases — highest individual.
- **Crimes Against Women:** 5 ministers accused.
- **Hate Speech:** 8 ministers accused.
- **Crorepati Ministers:** 70 of 71 (98.6%).
- **Richest Minister:** Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani — Rs. 5,705 crore.
- **BJP State Ministers:** 136 of 336 (40%) have criminal cases.
- **BJP CM with Criminal Cases:** Only 1 among 10 CMs with serious charges.
- **Yogi Adityanath:** Multiple cases; Ram Temple donation controversy.

Table 9.16: Sukanta Majumdar Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Minister of State for Education and Development of North Eastern Region
Criminal Cases	Attempted murder (Section 307 IPC); 16 cases with 30 serious charges
Crimes Against Women	Accused
Hate Speech	Accused

Table 9.17: Suresh Gopi Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas; Minister of State for Tourism
Crimes Against Women	Accused

Table 9.18: Jual Oram Profile

Detail	Information
Portfolio	Ministry of Tribal Affairs
Crimes Against Women	Accused

Table 9.19: Ministers with Hate Speech Allegations

Minister	Portfolio
Amit Shah	Home Affairs
Shobha Karandlaje	—
Dharmendra Pradhan	Education
Giriraj Singh	Textiles
Nityanand Rai	—
Bandi Sanjay Kumar	MoS Home Affairs
Shantanu Thakur	MoS Ports
Sukanta Majumdar	MoS Education

Table 9.20: Billionaire Ministers in Modi 3.0 Cabinet

Rank	Minister	Assets
1	Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani (MoS Rural Development, Communications)	Rs. 5,705 crore
2	Jyotiraditya M. Scindia (Communications, NE Region)	Rs. 424 crore
3	H.D. Kumaraswamy (Heavy Industries, Steel)	Rs. 217 crore
4	Ashwini Vaishnaw (Railways, I&B, IT)	Rs. 144 crore
5	Rao Inderjit Singh (Statistics, Planning, Culture)	Rs. 121 crore
6	Piyush Goyal (Commerce and Industry)	Rs. 110 crore

Table 9.21: BJP Chief Ministers Overview

Metric	Data
Total BJP CMs	16
BJP CMs with Criminal Cases	1 (according to ADR data)
CMs from Opposition with Serious Charges	7 out of 10

Table 9.22: Yogi Adityanath Profile

Detail	Information
State	Uttar Pradesh
Tenure	2017–present
Criminal Cases	Multiple cases registered — his government moved to withdraw a 22-year-old case against him in 2017; A third FIR was registered by Adityanath himself
Controversies (2025–26)	Ram Temple donation embezzlement controversy — alleged irregularities involving donations and land transactions; AIKS demanded his resignation and probe under Supreme Court judge; Opposition accused him of “attacking India’s faith”; FIR filed; SIT probing
Key Achievements	Fiscal turnaround (Rs. 1.5 lakh crore revenue surplus); infrastructure development; 5.9 crore lifted out of poverty

Table 9.23: Other Key BJP Chief Ministers

Chief Minister	State	Tenure	Notable Details
Bhupendra Patel	Gujarat	2021–present	3rd Gujarat CM under BJP; “Modi formula” of leadership change
Devendra Fadnavis	Maharashtra	2024–present	Coalition government; “cold war” with allies
Bhajanlal Sharma	Rajasthan	2023–present	Claims 70% of election promises fulfilled
Dr. Mohan Yadav	Madhya Pradesh	2023–present	Succeeded Shivraj Singh Chouhan
Vishnu Deo Sai	Chhattisgarh	2023–present	First tribal CM of Chhattisgarh
Nayab Singh Saini	Haryana	2024–present	12th year of BJP rule in Haryana
Rekha Gupta	Delhi	2025–present	First BJP CM in Delhi after 27 years
Himanta Biswa Sarma	Assam	2021–present	Key BJP strategist in Northeast
Pramod Sawant	Goa	2019–present	—
Manik Saha	Tripura	2022–present	—

Table 9.24: Nationwide Ministerial Criminal Cases

Party	Total Ministers	Ministers with Criminal Cases	Percentage	Ministers
BJP	336	136	40%	
Congress	61	45	74%	
TMC	40	13	33%	
DMK	31	27	87%	
TDP	23	22	96%	
AAP	16	11	69%	

Table 9.25: State-Specific Ministerial Criminal Cases

State	Ministers with Criminal Cases	Party in Power
Bihar Cabinet	6 BJP ministers have criminal cases	NDA (BJP+JD(U))
Andhra Pradesh	Over 60% ministers with criminal cases	NDA (TDP+BJP)
Tamil Nadu	Over 60% ministers with criminal cases	DMK
Maharashtra	Over 60% ministers with criminal cases	Mahayuti (BJP+SS+NCP)
States with NO Criminal Cases	Haryana, J&K, Nagaland, Uttarakhand	Various

Table 9.26: Minister Resignations & Removals (2024–2026)

Minister	Portfolio	Reason	Date
Smriti Irani	Dropped from Cabinet	Lost Lok Sabha election	June 2024
Anurag Thakur	Dropped from Cabinet	Lost Lok Sabha election	June 2024
Narayan Rane	Dropped from Cabinet	Lost Lok Sabha election	June 2024
Dhananjay Munde	Maharashtra Minister	Resigned over Santosh Deshmukh murder case	2025

Table 9.27: Criminalization of Politics Trends

Observation	Details
High Proportion	40% of BJP ministers have criminal cases
Serious Charges	26% face serious charges including murder, kidnapping, crimes against women
National Trend	47% of all ministers across India face criminal cases
No Deterrent	Criminal cases do not disqualify one from becoming a minister

Table 9.28: Wealth Concentration Trends

Observation	Details
Crorepati Ministers	98.6% of Modi 3.0 cabinet
Billionaire Ministers	6 ministers with assets > Rs. 100 crore
Richest	Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani — Rs. 5,705 crore
Party Average	Total assets of 643 ministers = Rs. 23,929 crore

Table 9.29: The Accountability Paradox

Paradox	Details
Government's Position	Proposes law to remove tainted leaders arrested for 30+ days
Reality	28 ministers in its own cabinet face criminal cases
Opposition's Response	INDIA bloc will not allow Bill to disqualify jailed Ministers

Chapter 10

Corruption & Scandals Database

10.1 Overview: The Corruption Landscape (2014–2026)

10.1.1 India’s Global Standing

Table 10.1: India’s Corruption Perceptions Index (2024)

Metric	Data
Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) 2024	India scored 38 points (out of 100)
Global Ranking	96th out of 180 countries
Trend	Declining score reflects growing perception of corruption under BJP rule

10.1.2 The BJP’s “Zero Tolerance” Paradox

Table 10.2: The “Zero Tolerance” Paradox

Claim	Reality
BJP’s Stance	“PM Modi believes in zero tolerance towards corruption”
Reality	40% of BJP ministers have criminal cases; multiple scams have emerged under BJP rule (see Section 9)
Opposition Charge	Congress: “BJP is setting new records in corruption and scams every passing day”

Analysis: The BJP came to power in 2014 riding the anti-corruption wave of the Anna Hazare movement. Yet, by 2026, the party’s own record on corruption has become a major political liability.

Table 10.3: PMFBY “Beed Pattern” Scam

Detail	Information
Scheme	Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) — crop insurance scheme
Date Exposed	December 19, 2024
Who Exposed	Sitting BJP MLA from Maharashtra raised serious allegations of widespread fraud
Nature of Fraud	Crop insurance claims made for over 4,000 hectares in villages that didn’t possess even a fraction of that cultivable land
Single Farmer Fraud	One farmer allegedly obtained crop insurance in eight different districts — a logistical impossibility
CM’s Admission	December 21, 2024 — Chief Minister publicly admitted to “new Beed Pattern” scam
Agriculture Minister’s Admission	January 21, 2025 — confirmed irregularities; blamed on private Common Service Centres
Estimated Amount	MLA claimed fraud may total Rs. 25,000 crore
Sugarcane Harvester Scam	5,141 farmers lured to deposit Rs. 8 lakh each for subsidies; only 141 machines were to be subsidized

10.2 Major Financial Scams & Scandals (2024–2026)

10.2.1 PMFBY “Beed Pattern” Scam (Maharashtra)

Analysis: A sitting BJP MLA exposing a scam in his own government — and the CM admitting it — is unprecedented. The scale (Rs. 25,000 crore) makes it one of the largest scams in Indian history.

10.2.2 Rajesh Exports Scam (2025–2026)

Table 10.4: Rajesh Exports Scam

Detail	Information
Alleged Amount	Rs. 15.5 lakh crore in reported revenues
Investor Wealth Loss	Nearly Rs. 25,000 crore wiped out
Market Cap Erosion	Fell from ~Rs. 28,000 crore to ~Rs. 3,000 crore
SEBI Delay	First complaint filed March 2024; SEBI acted only in October
LIC Exposure	LIC stake rose from 1.99% (2016) to 10.8% (March 2026)
PLI Project	Awarded Rs. 18,100 crore battery project despite no track record

Congress Allegation: SEBI’s then-chief Madhabi Puri Buch was heading the organization when the seven-month delay occurred.

10.2.3 Yashwant Cooperative Bank Fraud (2026)

Table 10.5: Yashwant Cooperative Bank Fraud

Detail	Information
Amount	Rs. 112 crore
Location	Kolhapur, Maharashtra
Accused	Shekhar Charegaonkar — BJP politician and former chairman of the state cooperative council
Nature of Fraud	195 bogus loan accounts created to get loans in violation of RBI guidelines, siphoning funds

10.2.4 DGHS Scam (2025–2026)

Table 10.6: DGHS Scam

Detail	Information
Department	Directorate General of Health Services
Nature	Manipulation of massive crores worth of equipment, medicines, and tenders
Pattern	Part of a series of scams that have emerged in “very quick succession” under BJP rule

10.2.5 Gruha Lakshmi Scheme Scam (Karnataka)

Table 10.7: Gruha Lakshmi Scheme Scam

Detail	Information
Scheme	Gruha Lakshmi scheme (Karnataka)
Amount	Rs. 116 crore transferred fraudulently
Beneficiaries	1.08 lakh beneficiaries who had died after the scheme began
Transfers	5.79 lakh instalments into accounts of deceased beneficiaries
Audit Period	2023–24 and 2024–25

Table 10.8: Adarsh Credit Cooperative Society Scam

Detail	Information
State	Rajasthan
Allegation	Former CM Ashok Gehlot accused BJP government of mishandling the Adarsh Credit Cooperative Society scam cases
Impact	Large number of investors from the state were defrauded

Table 10.9: Jharkhand Financial Irregularities

Detail	Information
Alleged Amount	Nearly Rs. 10,000 crore
Nature	Liquor scam, land scam, and other financial irregularities
BJP's Accusation	BJP spokesperson criticized Hemant Soren government over financial irregularities

10.2.6 Adarsh Credit Cooperative Society Scam (Rajasthan)

10.2.7 Jharkhand Financial Irregularities

10.2.8 Delhi Health Scam (2026)

Table 10.10: Delhi Health Scam

Detail	Information
Alleged Amount	Rs. 650 crore
Nature	Medicine procurement scam
Location	LNJP Hospital, Delhi
Allegation	AAP questioned CM Rekha Gupta over main accused escaping to Germany

10.3 NEET Paper Leaks: A Systemic Failure

10.3.1 The Four Leaks (2016–2026)

Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge:

“NEET papers had been leaked on at least four occasions — in 2016, 2021, 2024 and 2026 — raising serious concerns about the integrity of one of India’s most important competitive examinations.”

Table 10.11: NEET Paper Leaks Timeline

Year	Context
2016	First major NEET leak
2021	Second leak
2024	Third leak — sparked nationwide protests
2026	Fourth leak — examination cancelled

10.3.2 The 2024 Leak

Table 10.12: NEET 2024 Leak

Detail	Information
Government Response	Constituted high-level committee led by former ISRO Chairman K Radhakrishnan to recommend reforms
Committee Report	Submitted October 2024 — recommended transition from pen-and-paper to computer-based testing
Outcome	Recommendations remain on paper nearly two years later
CBI Probe	Found candidates paid to get solved papers before exam; centre superintendent in Jharkhand aided the leak

10.3.3 The 2026 Leak

Table 10.13: NEET 2026 Leak

Detail	Information
Examination Date	May 3, 2026
Candidates	Over 2.27 million aspirants
Cancellation Date	May 12, 2026 — less than two weeks after the exam
Nature	Handwritten “guess paper” circulated before exam contained 135 questions that directly matched the actual paper
Sikar, Rajasthan	Papers reportedly being sold openly; Central government “did not even get wind of it”

Table 10.14: Opposition Criticism on NEET Leaks

Leader	Statement
Mallikarjun Kharge	“Under the Modi government, the examination system has become a complete symbol of disorder, distrust and chaos”
Priyanka Gandhi	“Corruption that has plagued examinations for the past several years under BJP rule is robbing the country’s youth of their future”
Bhagwant Mann (AAP)	“Paper leak mafia is predominantly active in regions governed by the BJP’s ‘double-engine’ and ‘triple-engine’ governments”

Table 10.15: Education Minister’s Response

Detail	Information
Minister	Dharmendra Pradhan
2024 Response	“There is no paper leak; no proof has been found yet”
2026 Status	Remained as Education Minister despite the second leak under his watch
Protest	“Cockroach Janata Party” led protest at Jantar Mantar on June 6, 2026, demanding his resignation

10.3.4 Opposition Criticism

10.3.5 Education Minister’s Response

10.4 Electoral Bonds: The “Biggest Scam”

10.4.1 Overview

Table 10.16: Electoral Bonds Overview

Detail	Information
Introduced	2017 (Union Budget 2017–18)
Purpose	Claimed to make political funding more transparent
Reality	Critics say it “done the opposite and made the process more opaque”
Total Bonds Sold (2018–2024)	Rs. 9,208 crore

Table 10.17: Supreme Court Verdict on Electoral Bonds

Detail	Information
Bench	Five-judge Constitution bench headed by CJI D.Y. Chandrachud
Ruling	Scheme struck down as “unconstitutional” and “manifestly arbitrary”
Violation	Violated right to information under Article 19(1)(a)
Key Observation	“Information about funding of political parties is essential for the effective exercise of the choice of voting”

10.4.2 Supreme Court Verdict (February 15, 2024)

10.4.3 The Court’s Key Findings

Table 10.18: SC Key Findings on Electoral Bonds

Finding	Quote
Access–Influence Nexus	“At a primary level, political contributions give a seat at the table to contributors. . . This access also translates into influence over policymaking”
Quid Pro Quo	“There is also a legitimate possibility that financial contributions to a political party would lead to quid pro quo arrangements”
Corporate Influence	“The ability of a company to influence the electoral process through political contributions is much higher when compared to that of an individual”
Unlimited Corporate Contributions	“Authorises unrestrained influence of companies in the electoral process. . . violative of the principle of free and fair elections”

10.4.4 BJP’s Share of Electoral Bonds

10.4.5 Rahul Gandhi’s Attack

“Modi has established a monopoly on corruption. Modi and the BJP have done maximum corruption in the country through the electoral bonds.”

“Electoral bonds scheme. . . Hundreds of crores were collected under the formula ‘chanda do, dhanda lo’. This whole ‘chanda business’ is part of the BJP’s DNA.”

Table 10.19: BJP's Share of Electoral Bonds

Metric	Data
BJP's Share (6 years)	57% of all electoral bonds
BJP's Share (Total Analysis)	84% of total electoral bonds (see Section 6.10.1)
Congress Share	Less than 10%
First Tranche	BJP garnered the lion's share
Rs. 1 Crore Denomination	Accounted for more than 91% of Rs. 5,896 crore raised in first 11 phases

10.5 State-Level Corruption Cases

10.5.1 Odisha: Sand & Mineral Theft

Table 10.20: Odisha Sand & Mineral Theft

Detail	Information
Context	Since BJP government assumed power in June 2024, sand and minor mineral theft has spiralled exponentially
BJD Allegation	Theft happening under the patronage of BJP ministers and leaders
Revenue Decline	Minor minerals revenue: Rs. 1,485 crore (2023–24) → Rs. 600 crore (2024–25) — a 60% decline
Minister Allegations	Mining Minister Bibhuti Jena allegedly involved; Minister Pradeep Balsamant took possession of stone quarry in wife/son's name
CM Allegation	Allegations of CM and family members being directly linked to legislator accused of sand theft — “unprecedented since independence”

10.5.2 Maharashtra: “New Beed Pattern” Scam

Table 10.21: Maharashtra “New Beed Pattern” Scam

Detail	Information
Amount	Estimated Rs. 25,000 crore (PMFBY scam)
Context	Agriculture Minister admitted fraud but blamed private CSCs

Table 10.22: Odisha Bribery Case

Detail	Information
Contracts	Rs. 387 crore awarded to central PSUs
Key Contract	Rs. 37 crore in two contracts awarded without departmental minister's approval
Minister	Nityananda Gond (ST & SC Development) — BJD demanded his inclusion in CBI probe
BJD Allegation	Central PSUs bypass OPWD code; contractors linked to “huge kickbacks”; cost escalations by 7% to 10%

10.5.3 Odisha: Bribery Case

10.5.4 Uttar Pradesh: Ram Temple Donation Scam

Table 10.23: Ram Temple Donation Scam

Detail	Information
FIR Registered	June 25, 2026
Arrests	8 accused arrested
Recoveries	Nearly Rs. 80 lakh in cash, plus foreign currency
Allegation	Massive embezzlement of donations meant for Ram Temple
Congress Accusation	“Vote chori, seat chori, chanda chori” (stealing votes, seats, and donations)
Demand	SC-monitored probe into “scam perpetrated by BJP–RSS ecosystem”

10.5.5 Karnataka: Valmiki Corporation Scam

Table 10.24: Valmiki Corporation Scam

Detail	Information
Context	Scam came to light after an officer died by suicide in May 2024 alleging pressure from a minister to divert funds
Accused	Ex-minister Nagendra out on bail

Table 10.25: Bihar Health Department Irregularities

Detail	Information
Allegation	Prashant Kishor claimed “BJP leaders in Bihar are more corrupt than even RJD President Lalu Prasad”
Context	BJP leaders attack Lalu over fodder scam but are themselves “more corrupt”

Table 10.26: West Bengal PM Awas Yojana Irregularities

Detail	Information
Accused	Former Bengal minister Udayan Guha arrested
Allegations	Collected money from businessmen, teachers, government staff in 2021
Other Cases	Murder of BJP worker, seeds scam, cut money from Awas Yojana

10.5.6 Bihar: Health Department Irregularities

10.5.7 West Bengal: PM Awas Yojana Irregularities

10.6 Ministerial Scandals (2024–2026)

10.6.1 Ram Temple Donation Scam — BJP–RSS Ecosystem

Table 10.27: Ram Temple Donation Scam — Ministerial Dimension

Detail	Information
Accused	Eight accused arrested; SIT probe ongoing
Allegation	Embezzlement of thousands of crores in donations
Congress Question	“Why is PM Modi silent on this mega scam? Why not dissolve this corrupt Trust?” (see Section 7.4.4)

Table 10.28: Odisha Bribery Case — Minister Nityananda Gond

Detail	Information
Minister	Nityananda Gond (ST & SC Development)
Allegation	Contracts worth Rs. 387 crore awarded without his approval, raising questions of kickbacks
BJD Demand	Include him in CBI probe

Table 10.29: Maharashtra Beed Pattern Scam — Ministerial Dimension

Detail	Information
Allegation	Recently-resigned Minister of Food, Civil Supplies orchestrated scam where 5,141 farmers were duped

10.6.2 Odisha Bribery Case — Minister Nityananda Gond

10.6.3 Maharashtra — Beed Pattern Scam & Minister Allegations

10.6.4 Delhi ACB Probe — Former AAP Ministers

10.6.5 Former BJP MP Raj Kumar Singh's Allegations

10.7 BJP's Response Pattern

10.7.1 The “Blame Individuals” Strategy

ED Times Analysis:

“The pattern noticed here is that the blame is often being pushed onto individuals, with the big faces of the party staying silent or mentioning other parties, calling it a conspiracy, along with no real action being taken against some of those individuals even. They might be removed from their position if there is significant backlash, but they are then just placed in some other department or position, with no real consequences or punishment given.”

Table 10.30: Delhi ACB Probe — Former AAP Ministers

Detail	Information
Accused	Saurabh Bharadwaj and Satyendra Jain (former Health Ministers)
Nature	Alleged corruption in health infrastructure projects
Status	ACB registered FIR under Prevention of Corruption Act

Table 10.31: Former BJP MP Raj Kumar Singh’s Allegations

Detail	Information
Context	Quit BJP after suspension over allegations tied to Adani power project
Statement	“Stop criminalisation of politics and curb corruption”
Demand	Corruption-accused BJP leaders to either clear their names or step down

10.7.2 Weaponizing Investigation Agencies

10.7.3 The “Whataboutism” Defense

10.7.4 Silence on Own Scandals

10.8 Pattern Analysis: The BJP’s Corruption Paradox

10.8.1 The Anti-Corruption Promise vs Reality

10.8.2 The Three-Pronged Strategy (Opposition’s Charge)

Congress General Secretary Jairam Ramesh:

“The BJP’s politics now revolved around a three-pronged strategy of ‘vote chori, seat chori, chanda chori’ (vote theft, seat theft and donation theft).”

10.8.3 The “Double Standard” on Corruption

10.8.4 The “Washing Machine” Allegation

10.9 Comprehensive Scandal Timeline (2014–2026)

Table 10.32: BJP's "Blame Individuals" Strategy

Scam	Government Response
PMFBY "Beed Pattern"	Blamed private Common Service Centres, not government officials
NEET Paper Leaks	Blamed NTA, middlemen; Education Minister remained in post
Ram Temple Donation	PM and HM remained "completely silent"

Table 10.33: Weaponizing Investigation Agencies

Detail	Information
AAP Allegation	BJP uses ED and ACB to "corner" opposition parties
Congress Allegation	BJP uses ED to destabilize Congress governments
Pattern	Opposition leaders arrested; BJP leaders with criminal cases continue in office

Table 10.39: Comprehensive Scandal Timeline (2014–2026)

Year	Scandal/Controversy	Amount	Status
2016	NEET Paper Leak	—	Leak confirmed
2016	Demonetization	86% currency invalidated	Economic disruption
2017	Electoral Bonds Introduced	Rs. 9,208 crore total	Declared unconstitutional (2024)
2018	Nirav Modi PNB Scam	Rs. 11,400 crore	Fugitive declared
2021	NEET Paper Leak (2nd)	—	Leak confirmed
2024	NEET Paper Leak (3rd)	—	Protests; Radhakrishnan Committee formed
2024	Electoral Bonds Struck Down	—	SC declared unconstitutional
2024	PMFBY "Beed Pattern" Scam	Rs. 25,000 crore (alleged)	CM admitted; probe ongoing
2024	Valmiki Corporation Scam	—	Officer died by suicide
2025	Rajesh Exports Scam	Rs. 15.5 lakh crore	Investor wealth lost Rs. 25,000 crore
2025	Odisha Sand & Mineral Theft	Revenue fell Rs. 885 crore	Allegations against ministers
2025	Odisha Bribery Case	Rs. 387 crore contracts	Minister's role questioned

Continued on next page

Table 10.39 – continued from previous page

Year	Scandal/Controversy	Amount	Status
2025–26	DGHS Scam	Crores	Tender manipulation
2026	NEET Paper Leak (4th)	2.27 million affected	Examination cancelled
2026	Ram Temple Donation Scam	Thousands of crores	8 arrested; Rs. 80 lakh recovered
2026	Yashwant Cooperative Bank Fraud	Rs. 112 crore	BJP politician arrested
2026	Delhi Health Scam	Rs. 650 crore	Main accused fled to Germany
2026	Gruha Lakshmi Scheme Scam	Rs. 116 crore	1.08 lakh deceased beneficiaries

10.10 Key Data Points for Report

10.10.1 Scam Magnitude Summary

10.10.2 NEET Leaks Summary

10.10.3 Electoral Bonds Summary

10.10.4 Response Pattern Summary

10.10.5 Key Citations for Section 10

- **CPI 2024:** India score 38, rank 96.
- **PMFBY Scam:** Rs. 25,000 crore alleged; CM admitted Dec 21, 2024.
- **NEET Leaks:** 2016, 2021, 2024, 2026.
- **NEET 2026:** 2.27 million candidates; cancelled May 12.
- **Electoral Bonds:** Rs. 9,208 crore sold; SC struck down Feb 15, 2024.
- **BJP's Share:** 57% of electoral bonds.
- **Odisha Sand Theft:** Revenue Rs. 1,485 cr → Rs. 600 cr.
- **Ram Temple Scam:** 8 arrested; Rs. 80 lakh recovered.
- **Yashwant Bank Fraud:** Rs. 112 crore; BJP politician arrested.

Table 10.34: The “Whataboutism” Defense

Detail	Information
Response	When accused of corruption, BJP points to opposition scams (fodder scam, 2G, etc.)
Example	BJP hits back with “Fodder Scam accused” jibe when INDIA bloc criticizes BJP
Irony	BJP came to power on anti-corruption promise but now defends by comparing to UPA

Table 10.35: Silence on Own Scandals

Scandal	BJP Leadership Response
Ram Temple Donation Scam	PM Modi and HM Shah “completely silent”
NEET Paper Leaks	Education Minister remains in post
Rajesh Exports Scam	Limited official response
Yashwant Bank Fraud	Accused politician arrested but party distanced itself

- **Gruha Lakshmi:** Rs. 116 crore fraud; 1.08 lakh deceased beneficiaries.

Table 10.36: Anti-Corruption Promise vs Reality

Promise (2014)	Reality (2026)
“Zero tolerance towards corruption”	40% of ministers have criminal cases
“Clean government”	Multiple Rs. 10,000+ crore scams
“Transparency in political funding”	Electoral bonds declared unconstitutional

Table 10.37: Double Standard on Corruption

Area	BJP’s Position	Reality
Opposition Leaders	Demand resignation, arrest, investigation	ED/CBI cases against Kejriwal, Sisodia, etc.
BJP Leaders	Defend, silence, or transfer	Ministers with criminal cases continue in office (see Section 9)
Electoral Bonds	Defended as transparent	SC struck down as unconstitutional

Table 10.38: The “Washing Machine” Allegation

Detail	Information
Allegation	Opposition alleges corrupt people get “clean chit” after joining BJP
Term	“Modi’s washing machine” — coined by opposition
Context	Electoral bonds, Adani, and multiple scams

Table 10.40: Scam Magnitude Summary

Scam	Amount (Rs.)
Rajesh Exports	15.5 lakh crore (alleged revenues)
PMFBY “Beed Pattern”	25,000 crore (alleged)
Nirav Modi PNB	11,400 crore
Electoral Bonds	9,208 crore total
Jharkhand Irregularities	10,000 crore
Delhi Health Scam	650 crore
Odisha Bribery Contracts	387 crore
Gruha Lakshmi Scam	116 crore
Yashwant Bank Fraud	112 crore
Ram Temple Donation	Thousands of crores (alleged)

Table 10.41: NEET Leaks Summary

Year	Status
2016	Leak confirmed
2021	Leak confirmed
2024	Leak confirmed; Radhakrishnan Committee formed
2026	Leak confirmed; examination cancelled

Table 10.42: Electoral Bonds Summary

Detail	Data
Total Bonds Sold	Rs. 9,208 crore
BJP's Share	57% (overall) / 84% (total analysis)
Congress Share	<10%
SC Verdict	Unconstitutional (Feb 15, 2024)

Table 10.43: Response Pattern Summary

Pattern	Example
Blame Individuals	PMFBY scam blamed on CSCs; NEET blamed on NTA
Silence from Top	PM and HM silent on Ram Temple donation scam
Whataboutism	Point to UPA scams when questioned
No Real Consequences	Ministers removed but placed elsewhere

Chapter 11

Economic Performance

11.1 Overview: From \$2 Trillion to \$4+ Trillion

Table 11.1: Economic Growth Overview (2014–2026)

Metric	2014	2026	Change
GDP (Nominal)	~\$2 trillion	\$4+ trillion	Doubled
GDP (Nominal, INR)	—	Rs. 346.36 lakh crore	—
Global Ranking	10th–11th largest	4th–5th largest	Significant climb
Foreign Exchange Reserves	—	~\$688 billion	—
Real GDP Growth (FY26)	—	7.7%	—

Key Insight: Over 12 years, India has doubled the size of its economy, expanded infrastructure spending, rolled out one of the world’s largest digital payments systems, and broadened welfare coverage across hundreds of millions of people. However, some of the government’s longest-standing economic goals — including raising manufacturing’s share of GDP and creating sufficient employment — remain works in progress.

11.2 GDP Growth Trends (2014–2026)

11.2.1 Year-by-Year Real GDP Growth

11.2.2 CAGR Analysis

Critical Analysis: The CAGR of real GDP growth has steadily slowed from 12.3% (2004–2026) to 6.2% (2014–2026) to below 5.5% (2019–2026). While the government claims an average of 8.4% (2014–2024), this figure is disputed by economists who argue it cherry-picks post-COVID recovery years and distorts the true picture.

Expert View:

“A real GDP growth rate of barely 5.5% over seven years is insufficient for India to achieve Viksit Bharat (Developed India) by 2047. Economists broadly

Table 11.2: Real GDP Growth (FY 2014–15 to FY 2025–26)

Financial Year	GDP Growth Rate	Context
2014–15	7.4%	First Modi year
2015–16	8.0%	Peak early growth
2016–17	8.3%	Demonetization year
2017–18	7.2%	GST implementation
2018–19	7.2%	Pre-election year
2019–20	4.0%	Pre-COVID slowdown
2020–21	-7.3%	COVID-19 pandemic contraction
2021–22	8.7%	Sharp rebound (low base effect)
2022–23	7.2%	Continued recovery
2023–24	~7.3%	Estimate
2024–25	7.1%	Post-election year
2025–26	7.7%	Strongest since COVID rebound

Table 11.3: Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) Comparison

Period	Real GDP CAGR	Nominal GDP CAGR
2004–2014 (UPA)	~6.8%	~12.3%
2014–2026 (NDA)	6.2%	Just above 10%
2019–2026	Below 5.5%	~9.5%

agree that India needs sustained 8–9% real growth annually for such a transformation.”

11.3 Inflation Trends

11.3.1 Average Inflation Rates

Table 11.4: Average CPI Inflation

Period	Average CPI Inflation
2013–14 to 2022–23	5%
Pre-FIT period (2012–2016)	~7.3%
Post-FIT (2016 onwards)	~3.8–4%

11.3.2 Yearly Inflation Data

Government Claim: Average annual inflation declined to 5% from 8.2% recorded during 2003–04 to 2013–14.

Table 11.5: Yearly CPI Inflation

Year	Inflation Rate
2014	6.67%
2024	4.95%
2025	2.80%

11.3.3 RBI's Inflation Targeting Framework

The Reserve Bank of India's inflation targeting framework has been credited with bringing down average CPI inflation from about 7.3% in the pre-FIT period (2012–2016) to around 3.8–4% before the pandemic. The volatility of inflation also declined significantly — from 2.9 percentage points during the pre-2016 period to around 1.1 percentage points thereafter.

Key Insight: India's inflation management has been relatively successful, with inflation remaining within the RBI's 2–6% tolerance range for most of the Modi years.

11.4 Fiscal Deficit & Government Finances

11.4.1 Fiscal Deficit Trend (FY14–FY26)

Table 11.6: Fiscal Deficit (% of GDP)

Financial Year	Fiscal Deficit (% of GDP)	Context
2013–14	4.5%	UPA's last year
2014–15	Reduced	First Modi year
2018–19	3.4%	Pre-COVID low
2019–20	~4.6%	Pre-pandemic
2020–21	9.2%	COVID-19 pandemic spike
2023–24	5.8%	Revised estimate
2024–25	4.9%	Projected
2025–26	4.4%	Budget estimate
2026–27	Below 4.5% target	—

11.4.2 Revenue Deficit Trend

Table 11.7: Revenue Deficit (% of GDP)

Financial Year	Revenue Deficit (% of GDP)
FY20	3.3%
FY21	7.3%
FY24	2.8%

11.4.3 Capital Expenditure Surge

Table 11.8: Capital Expenditure Surge

Metric	Pre-2014	2024–25/2026	Increase
Infrastructure Spending	~Rs. 2 lakh crore	Rs. 11 lakh crore+	5.5x
Capital Expenditure (FY24)	—	Rs. 12.7 lakh crore	21% from
Capital Expenditure (FY25)	—	Rs. 15 lakh crore	15% from
Road Transport Budget	—	570% increase (2014–2023–24)	—
Railways Budget	—	9x increase since 2014	—

Key Insight: The government has pursued a capital expenditure-led growth strategy, arguing that roads, railways, ports, and logistics networks create long-term economic capacity and support private investment. Spending on transport (the third largest expenditure head after interest and subsidies) rose by 34.35% in FY24.

11.5 Unemployment & Employment

11.5.1 Unemployment Rate Trends

Table 11.9: Unemployment Rate Trends

Year	Unemployment Rate	Source
2013–14	4.9%	Government data
2014	7.66%	ILO/World Bank
2016	7.61%	ILO/World Bank
2019	5.27%	CMIE
2020	~8%	CMIE (pandemic)
October 2023	10.05%	CMIE
2024	4.17%	ILO/World Bank
2025	4.22%	ILO/World Bank
April 2025	5.1%	Government data

Critical Analysis: Unemployment data in India remains highly contested. The government cites lower figures, while CMIE data shows significantly higher unemployment, particularly in rural areas. Urban unemployment rose from 5.5% to 6.5% during 2014–2025.

11.5.2 Youth Unemployment Crisis

Key Finding: Youth unemployment has remained stubbornly high — hovering around 44–45% throughout 2025 — representing a critical failure of job creation.

Table 11.10: Youth Unemployment

Metric	Data
Youth Unemployment (Ages 20–24)	44–45% throughout 2025
Comparison	Much higher than pre-2014 levels

11.5.3 Employment Creation Claims

Table 11.11: Employment Creation Claims

Claim	Details
Government Claim	12.5 crore jobs created (2014–2024)
UPA Comparison	2.9 crore jobs created (2004–2014)
RBI Data	Employment jumped 36% between 2014–2024 vs just 6% during UPA

11.5.4 Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR)

Table 11.12: Labour Force Participation Rate

Metric	Data
Female LFPR (2021)	As low as 9.4%
Interpretation	Less than one in 10 working-age women are demanding work

Analysis: Despite claims of job creation, women’s participation in the workforce remains alarmingly low — a structural issue that has not been adequately addressed.

11.6 Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)

11.6.1 FDI Inflows (2014–2026)

11.6.2 Annual FDI Trends

11.6.3 Sector-wise FDI (FY 2024–25)

11.6.4 State-wise Distribution (FY 2024–25)

11.6.5 Top Source Countries (FY 2024–25)

11.6.6 FDI Policy Reforms

Between 2014 and 2019, significant reforms included increased FDI caps in Defence, Insurance, and Pension sectors, and liberalized policies for Construction, Civil Aviation,

Table 11.13: FDI Inflows (2014–2026)

Period	FDI Inflow	Increase vs Previous
2003–14	\$308.38 billion	—
2014–25	\$748.78 billion	143% increase
2014–26	\$843 billion	169% increase
April 2014 – Dec 2025	\$821.66 billion	166% increase

Table 11.14: Annual FDI Inflow

Financial Year	FDI Inflow
2013–14	\$36.05 billion
2023–24	\$71.28 billion
2024–25	\$81.04 billion
2025–26	\$94.53 billion

and Single Brand Retail Trading. From 2019 to 2024, notable measures included allowing 100% FDI under the automatic route in coal mining, contract manufacturing, and insurance intermediaries. In 2025, the Union Budget proposed increasing the FDI limit from 74% to 100% for companies investing their entire premium within India.

11.6.7 Critical Perspectives

Despite record FDI inflows, net FDI has turned negative, reflecting diminished investor confidence. The resultant capital outflow is a major structural reason for the rupee's depreciation — notably, the rupee is weakening even as the dollar itself weakens against most global currencies, signalling an India-specific confidence deficit.

11.7 Infrastructure Development (2014–2026)

11.7.1 Highways & Roads

11.7.2 Railways

11.7.3 Aviation

11.7.4 Metro Rail

11.7.5 Ports & Maritime

Major Port Projects:

- **Vizhinjam International Seaport (Kerala):** Rs. 8,800 crore; India's first dedicated container transshipment port; inaugurated May 2, 2025.

Table 11.15: Sector-wise FDI (FY 2024–25)

Sector	Share	Inflow
Services	19%	\$9.35 billion (+40.77%)
Computer Software & Hardware	16%	—
Trading	8%	—
Manufacturing FDI	—	\$19.04 billion (+18%)

Table 11.16: State-wise FDI Equity Inflows (FY 2024–25)

State	Share of FDI Equity Inflows
Maharashtra	39%
Karnataka	13%
Delhi	12%

- **New Dry Dock at Cochin Shipyard:** Rs. 1,800 crore; capable of handling aircraft carriers up to 70,000 tons.

11.7.6 Digital & Financial Infrastructure

Analysis: UPI has become one of the largest real-time retail payment systems in the world. The platform has expanded internationally and is now operational in markets including the UAE, Singapore, and France.

11.8 Major Economic Indicators Summary

11.8.1 Key Macroeconomic Data

11.8.2 Infrastructure Summary

11.9 Achievements vs Failures Analysis

11.9.1 Key Achievements

11.9.2 Key Failures

11.10 Critical Analysis: The “Goldilocks” Narrative

11.10.1 The Claim

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra suggested that India had entered a “Goldilocks period” — a phase where economic conditions are ideal: steady growth, low inflation, and low

Table 11.17: Top Source Countries for FDI (FY 2024–25)

Country	Share
Singapore	30%
Mauritius	17%
United States	11%

Table 11.18: Highways & Roads Development

Metric	2014	2024/2025/2026	Cha
National Highway Length	91,287 km	1,46,204 km (2024) / 1,46,572 km (Dec 2025)	+60%
Highway Construction Pace	11.6 km/day	34 km/day	Triples
Investment in Road Infrastructure	—	6.4x increase (2013–14 to 2024–25)	—
Road Transport Budget	—	570% increase (2014–2023–24)	—
Bharatmala Highways	—	20,000+ km constructed	—
PMGSY Rural Roads	—	7.8 lakh km built since 2014	—
Rural Connectivity	—	99% achieved	—

unemployment.

11.10.2 The Reality Check

Recent developments have challenged this optimism:

11.10.3 The Base Effect Trap

A critical methodological caution: cherry-picking post-COVID years distorts the true picture. The sharp rebound in 2021–22 and 2022–23 reflected recovery from the low base of the 2020 contraction, not genuine structural acceleration.

11.10.4 Growth Inadequacy

A real GDP growth rate of barely 5.5% over seven years is insufficient for India to achieve Viksit Bharat (Developed India) by 2047. Economists broadly agree that India needs sustained 8–9% real growth annually for such a transformation.

11.11 Comprehensive Economic Timeline (2014–2026)

Table 11.19: Railway Development

Metric	Data
New Rail Tracks	31,000+ km added after 2014
Track Renewal	45,000+ km renewed since 2014
Electrification	45,000+ route km electrified (2014–25)
Broad-gauge Electrification	Crossed 99%
Railways Budget	Record Rs. 2.93 lakh crore capital allocation (FY27)
Budget Increase	More than 9x since 2014
Vande Bharat Trains	68 operational; 164 services; 400 more planned
Stations Modernized	1,300+ under Amrit Bharat Station Scheme
Annual Savings (Electrification)	Rs. 2,960 crore

Table 11.20: Aviation Development

Metric	2014	2025/2026	Change
Operational Airports	74	160	More than doubled
Airports Activated (UDAN)	—	88	—

Table 11.29: Comprehensive Economic Timeline (2014–2026)

Date	Event	Category
May 2014	Modi takes office; GDP ~\$2 trillion	Political/Economic
2014–15	GDP growth 7.4%	Economic
2015–16	GDP growth 8.0%	Economic
2016	Demonetization	Economic
2016–17	GDP growth 8.3%	Economic
July 2017	GST implemented	Economic
2017–18	GDP growth 7.2%	Economic
2018–19	GDP growth 7.2%	Economic
2019–20	GDP growth 4.0%; slowdown begins	Economic
2020–21	GDP contracts -7.3% (COVID)	Economic/Crisis
2021–22	GDP rebounds 8.7% (low base effect)	Economic
2022–23	GDP growth 7.2%	Economic
2023–24	GDP growth ~7.3%; fiscal deficit 5.8%	Economic
2024–25	GDP growth 7.1%; FDI \$81.04 bn	Economic
2025–26	GDP growth 7.7%; FDI \$94.53 bn	Economic
June 2026	India overtakes Japan to become 4th largest economy	Economic

Table 11.21: Metro Rail Development

Metric	Data
Cities with Metro	23 cities
Global Ranking	India = 3rd largest metro network in the world

Table 11.22: Ports & Maritime Development

Metric	2014	2024/2025	Change
Port Capacity	—	2,762 MMTPA	Doubled
Ship Turnaround Time	93 hours	49 hours	Improved
Sagarmala Projects	—	277 completed	—
Port Capacity Increase	—	87% increase since 2014	—

11.11.1 Key Citations for Section 11

- **GDP Growth FY26:** 7.7%.
- **GDP Size:** \$2 trillion (2014) → \$4+ trillion (2026).
- **GDP (Nominal):** Rs. 346.36 lakh crore.
- **Foreign Exchange Reserves:** ~\$688 billion.
- **Global Ranking:** 4th largest economy.
- **Real GDP CAGR (2014–2026):** 6.2%.
- **Inflation:** 6.67% (2014) → 2.80% (2025).
- **Fiscal Deficit:** 4.5% (FY14) → 4.4% (FY26 estimate).
- **Infrastructure Spending:** Rs. 2 lakh crore → Rs. 11 lakh crore+.
- **Unemployment:** Youth unemployment 44–45%.
- **FDI (2014–26):** \$843 billion; 169% increase.
- **FDI (2025–26):** \$94.53 billion.
- **National Highways:** 91,287 km → 1,46,572 km.
- **Highway Construction:** 11.6 km/day → 34 km/day.
- **Railways Budget:** 9x increase since 2014.
- **Operational Airports:** 74 → 160.
- **UPI Transactions:** 23.2 billion/month (May 2026).
- **Net FDI:** Turned negative — capital outflows.

Table 11.23: Digital & Financial Infrastructure

Metric	Data
UPI Transactions (May 2026)	23.2 billion transactions worth Rs. 29.9 lakh crore
Demat Accounts	Crossed 20 crore
SIP Inflows	Record highs
UPI International	Operational in UAE, Singapore, France

Table 11.24: Key Macroeconomic Indicators (2014–2026)

Indicator	2014	2024	2025	2026
GDP Growth (Real)	7.4%	7.3%	7.1%	7.7%
Inflation (CPI)	6.67%	4.95%	2.80%	—
Fiscal Deficit (% of GDP)	4.5%	5.8%	4.9%	4.4%
FDI Inflow	\$36.05 bn	\$71.28 bn	\$81.04 bn	\$94.53 bn
Foreign Exchange Reserves	—	—	—	~\$688 bn

Table 11.25: Infrastructure Summary

Sector	Key Achievement
National Highways	91,287 km → 1,46,572 km (+60%)
Highway Construction	11.6 km/day → 34 km/day (tripled)
Railway Electrification	45,000+ route km
Operational Airports	74 → 160 (+117%)
Metro Cities	23 cities; 3rd largest globally
Port Capacity	Doubled

Table 11.26: Key Achievements (2014–2026)

Area	Achievement
Economic Size	\$2 trillion → \$4+ trillion; doubled in 12 years
GDP Growth	7.7% in FY26 — strongest since COVID rebound
Infrastructure	34 km/day highway construction; 9x railway budget increase
FDI	\$843 billion attracted (2014–2026); 169% increase
Digital Payments	UPI: 23.2 billion transactions/month
Financial Inclusion	Demat accounts: 20 crore+
Inflation	Brought down from ~7.3% to ~3.8–4%
Fiscal Consolidation	Fiscal deficit from 9.2% (FY21) to 4.4% (FY26)

Table 11.27: Key Failures (2014–2026)

Area	Failure
Manufacturing	Target: 25% of GDP; achieved ~15% (stagnant)
Job Creation	Youth unemployment at 44–45%
GDP Growth Deceleration	6.2% CAGR (2014–2026) vs 12.3% (2004–2026)
Net FDI	Turned negative — capital outflows
Rupee Weakness	Weakening despite dollar weakness — India-specific confidence deficit
Income Growth	Average income grew faster under UPA (6%) vs NDA (4%)
5 Trillion Economy	Pledge unfulfilled (see Section 7.6.2)
GDP Revision	New GDP series effectively shrunk India’s measured economy

Table 11.28: Challenges to the “Goldilocks” Narrative

Issue	Details
GDP Calculation Revision	New base year (2022–23) revealed earlier estimates had overstated GDP
Global Geopolitical Instability	US–Iran conflict raised oil price concerns
Rupee Weakness	Weakened further against US dollar
Stagflationary Risks	Slower growth with higher inflation emerging
GDP Revision	New GDP series has shrunk India’s measured economy

Chapter 12

Ideological & Social Analysis

12.1 Overview: The Hindutva Project

12.1.1 Defining Hindutva

Table 12.1: Defining Hindutva

Aspect	Description
Core Ideology	Hindutva — Hindu nationalist ideology that defines India through socio-biological links, language, religion, territory, and kinship
BJP’s Guiding Theme	Integral Humanism — adopted in 1985, held that federalism was dangerous for unity and integrity
RSS-BJP Axis	Hindutva as articulated by RSS and BJP aspires to unify Hindus under a single ethno-national identity, minimizing caste divisions
Paradigm Shift	Since 2014, governance has moved away from established constitutional and democratic norms

Key Insight: Since 2014, “the whole state is run by the ideology of Hindutva”. The BJP has become the “natural party of governance” through embedding Hindutva into administrative practice.

12.1.2 The 2024 “Setback” & Hindutva’s Resilience

Table 12.2: Hindutva’s Resilience After 2024

Observation	Details
Commentator View	BJP’s 2024 setback led many to conclude Hindu nationalism was losing steam
Reality	BJP’s 2024 loss of 63 seats did not translate to meaningful improvement for minorities
Continued Push	Hindutva “continues its march with renewed confidence”
Coalition Partners	NDA allies trade silence on secular principles for developmental concessions

12.2 Hindutva in Policy & Practice

12.2.1 Key Policy Implementation

Table 12.3: Hindutva in Policy Implementation

Policy	Status	Hindutva Dimension
Article 370 Abrogation	Implemented August 2019	Removed special status of India’s sole Muslim-majority state
Ram Mandir Construction	Inaugurated January 2024	Fulfilled core ideological promise; site of Babri Mosque remains point of controversy
Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA)	Passed December 2019	Excludes Muslims; critics argue it discriminates on religious grounds
Uniform Civil Code (UCC)	Advanced by BJP	Aimed at replacing personal laws, disproportionately affects Muslims
Waqf Amendment Bill 2025	Passed with NDA support	Critics argue it undermines minority autonomy and religious freedoms

12.2.2 Discriminatory Policies & Structural Discrimination

According to a 2026 academic study examining Hindu extremism under BJP rule:

Table 12.4: Dimensions of Discrimination (Academic Study)

Dimension	Findings
Political Representation	Declining Muslim political representation
Economic Marginalization	Unequal access to employment
Educational Exclusion	Reinforced by cultural imposition
Escalating Violence	Organized violence threatening community security

Academic Conclusion: Since 2014, “discriminatory policies and Islamophobic practices have shifted from sporadic incidents to a systematic project affecting the country’s largest religious minority”. The issue forms part of a broader “political-ideological agenda to redefine India’s national identity on the basis of Hindu exclusivism and the exclusion of minorities”.

Table 12.5: The Ideology-Driven Regime

Observation	Details
Ashutosh's Analysis	"Ideology has an inbuilt nature that it disconnects from the past, disrupts the present, and reconstructs the future"
Constitutional Consensus	Regime moved away from established norms of constitutional and democratic consensus
Governance Shift	Since 2014, governance has become more unitary — Union Government calls shots, sidestepping states
Social Fascism	Ashutosh warned that "what we see today in a different garb is a kind of social fascism. You can be lynched anywhere because you belong to a particular caste. Since 2014, these forces have got the support and backing of the state"

12.2.3 The Ideology-Driven Regime

12.2.4 The "Sabkha Saath, Sabkha Vikas" Paradox

Table 12.6: The "Sabkha Saath, Sabkha Vikas" Paradox

Observation	Details
BJP's Slogan	"Sabkha Saath, Sabkha Vikas" — with all, development for all
Reality	Hindutva asks "not who is excluded, but who belongs to the nation"
Secularism's Decline	Secularism has become a "bad word" compared to Hindutva's "cleaner image and more emotionally cohesive story"

12.3 Communal Incidents & Violence

12.3.1 Odisha: A Case Study in Communal Strife

Since the BJP formed its first solo government in Odisha on June 12, 2024, the state has witnessed a significant spike in communal violence:

Key Finding: Since mid-2024, at least six towns in Odisha have seen curfews, internet suspensions, and clashes erupting along religious lines — often after rumours, allegations of cow slaughter, or accusations of forced conversion. The government's image "has taken a beating amid a spike in communal attacks and crimes against women".

Table 12.7: Odisha Communal Violence (June 2024–February 2026)

Metric	Data
Communal Riots	54 incidents (June 2024 – February 2026)
Mob Lynching Incidents	7 cases during the same period
Total Incidents	61 cases in 21 months
Geographic Concentration	5 districts affected; Balasore (24 cases, nearly half)
Arrests (Riots)	298 people arrested
Arrests (Lynching)	61 people arrested

12.3.2 National Trends in Communal Violence

Table 12.8: National Trends in Communal Violence

Metric	2023	2024	Change
Communal Riots	32 incidents	59 incidents	+84%
Hate Speech Incidents	668	1,165	+74%

Key Finding: Muslims were the primary victims, accounting for 10 out of 13 deaths in communal violence, mainly in BJP-led states like Maharashtra, UP, and Bihar. 98.5% of hate speech was directed at Muslims.

12.3.3 Other Communal Flashpoints

Table 12.9: Other Communal Flashpoints

Incident	Location	Year	Details
Sambhal Violence	Uttar Pradesh	2024	Reignited debate on “ap-peasement politics” and demographic shift
Nagpur Communal Violence	Maharashtra	2025	CPI(M) leader called it “a very orchestrated kind of strategy on the part of the BJP” — “an old colonial strategy of divide and rule”
Hazaribagh Clash	Jharkhand	2026	Clash between communities during Ramnavmi procession; BJP protested against state government
Jainoor Violence	Telangana	2024	Communal violence with arson of houses, shops, and mosques

Table 12.10: Delhi Riots: Unresolved Justice

Detail	Information
Incident	North East Delhi riots (February 2020) — 53 people killed
Status (2026)	Six years later, pleas seeking FIR against senior BJP leader Kapil Mishra remain stuck in courts
Irony	In February 2025, BJP came to power in Delhi and Mishra became Law and Justice Minister

12.3.4 Delhi Riots: The Unresolved Justice

12.4 Caste Dynamics & Social Engineering

12.4.1 The Caste Census U-Turn

Table 12.11: The Caste Census U-Turn

Phase	BJP-RSS Position
Before 2024	RSS commentary warned caste census would “fracture Hindu society”; Modi derided it as “urban Naxal” idea
After 2024 Setback	Government announced inclusion of caste enumeration in nationwide census

Significance: The decision “represents a shift in the BJP-RSS axis’s ideological stance” and “lays bare the contradictions in their position on caste politics”. With the 2024 election results showing a significant drop — from 303 to 240 seats — particularly in states with large OBC populations, the party needed to recapture the social justice narrative.

12.4.2 The “Fracture & Coopt” Strategy

Academic Analysis: The shift “marks not a move from caste blindness to visibility, but a new way to sustain caste”. While such measures “respond to genuine intra-group disparities, they can also be wielded politically to divide larger caste blocs, forestalling solidarities that may threaten upper-caste dominance”.

Table 12.12: The “Fracture & Coopt” Strategy

Strategy	Details
Sub-Caste Cooptation	BJP has systematically identified smaller sub-castes within both SCs and OBCs and coopted them
Targeting Neglected Castes	Sangh Parivar targets relatively neglected backward castes and tribes, culturally moulding them into its support base
Pasmanda Muslim Outreach	BJP’s Minority Morcha actively encouraging Pasmanda Muslims to assert caste identities to access reservation benefits
Counterweight Strategy	By cultivating Pasmanda support, BJP disrupts Muslim solidarity and fractures “monolithic Muslim vote bank”

Table 12.13: Electoral Impact of Caste Politics

Metric	2019	
BJP Performance in SC-reserved Seats	46/84 seats (73% strike rate, 50.76% vote share)	29/
OBC Consolidation	—	Consolidatio

12.4.3 Electoral Impact of Caste Politics

12.4.4 State-Level Caste Engineering

12.5 Women & Gender Politics

12.5.1 Women’s Reservation: Promise vs Reality

Allegation: Telangana CM Revanth Reddy alleged BJP used the Women’s Reservation Bill as a “pretext to expand Lok Sabha seats and secure a two-thirds majority, with the ultimate goal of changing the Constitution and removing reservations”.

12.5.2 Women’s Representation in Politics

12.5.3 Women’s Welfare Schemes

Analysis: While BJP has launched multiple women-centric welfare schemes, critics point to the gap between promise and implementation of the Women’s Reservation Bill, and the persistent underrepresentation of women in Parliament.

Table 12.14: State-Level Caste Engineering

State	Strategy
Maharashtra	Reaching out to smaller castes/subcastes within OBCs to counter Maratha backlash
Haryana	Revised OBC reservation to 27%; raised creamy layer income limit
Uttar Pradesh	Championing non-Yadav OBCs
Bihar	Courting non-Kurmi groups
Andhra Pradesh	Backing Madiga community's demand for fixed share of SC quotas

Table 12.15: Women's Reservation: Promise vs Reality

Aspect	Details
Nari Shakti Vandan Act	Passed in 2023 — BJP claims UPA couldn't accomplish in 30 years, Modi did in 3 days
Promise	33% reservation for women in Parliament and state assemblies
Reality (2026)	BJP has only 13% women MPs in Lok Sabha
Implementation	Bill passed but not implemented yet
Opposition Criticism	Called "betrayal and injustice to women"

12.6 Minorities: The “Systematic Project”

12.6.1 Muslim Political Representation

The Print's Observation:

“The BJP refuses to give political representation to Muslims in terms of election tickets. Nor does it boast any high-profile Muslim leaders in its ranks”.

12.6.2 Minority Welfare Budget

12.6.3 Pasmada Muslim Outreach

Critical Analysis: This “selective inclusivism” permits the BJP “to present itself as responsive to Muslim suffering while leaving intact the overarching Hindutva framework”. It's “not about dismantling Muslim exclusion, it's a targeted inclusion strategy”.

Table 12.16: Women's Representation in Politics

Metric	Data
BJP Women MPs	13% of Lok Sabha
BJP's Organizational Plans	Announced plans to increase women's representation in organizational structures ahead of reservation implementation

Table 12.17: Women's Welfare Schemes

Scheme	Details
Mahila Samridhi Yojana	Rs. 2,500 per month to women beneficiaries (Delhi)
LPG Subsidy	For women beneficiaries
Nutrition Kits	Six kits for pregnant women
PM Ujjwala	LPG connections to poor households

12.6.4 Waqf Amendment Bill 2025

12.7 Media Freedom & Free Speech

12.7.1 India's Global Ranking

Key Finding: In 2026, India ranked behind Pakistan (153rd) and Bangladesh (152nd). India slipped six places with “particularly low scores in the political and security categories”.

12.7.2 The Free Speech Collective Report (2025)

Key Finding: The report characterized 2025 as a year marked by “a dramatic and dangerous contraction of public expression”, widespread censorship, legal intimidation, and mounting violence against journalists, academics, artists, filmmakers, and private citizens.

12.7.3 Weaponization of Laws

12.7.4 The “Gag Order” Culture

12.8 Hypocrisy & Double Standards

12.8.1 Judicial Accountability: Selective Outrage

Congress MP Abhishek Singhvi:

Table 12.18: Muslim Political Representation

Metric	Data
UP Assembly	Muslims = 19% of population; representation = 31 seats (7.7%) — most diminished phase in decades
BJP Muslim MPs	Zero high-profile Muslim leaders in its ranks; refuses to give election tickets to Muslims

Table 12.19: Minority Welfare Budget

Scheme	2023–24 (RE)	2024–25 (BE)	Change
Coaching and Allied Schemes for Minorities	Rs. 14 crore	Rs. 10 crore	-28.5%
Minority Affairs Budget	Rs. 2,608.93 crore	Rs. 3,183.24 crore	Marginal increase

“This is typical of BJP’s double standards. . . On judicial propriety, on anti-corruption movement and on judicial accountability, the BJP’s mantra is ‘talk the talk, never walk the talk’. It is the worst example of doublespeak and hypocrisy”.

12.8.2 Farmers’ Income Promise

12.8.3 Women’s Issues: “Emotional Bankruptcy”

12.8.4 The “400 Paar” Mandate Paradox

Congress Leader Gehlot:

“The BJP had sought a ‘400 paar’ mandate in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections but was restricted to 240 seats by voters and now relied on coalition partners to remain in power”.

Table 12.20: Pasmanda Muslim Outreach

Initiative	Details
Waqf Chetna Abhiyan	Launched to connect with Pasmanda Muslims across poll-bound states
Coordination Committee	Led by Radha Mohan Das Agrawal to reach out to voters, including Muslims, poor, Pasmanda Muslims, and women
BJP Minority Morcha	Claims 80% of Muslims belong to Pasmanda section, “long ignored by previous governments”

Table 12.21: Waqf Amendment Bill 2025

Detail	Information
Passed	2025 with 288–232 vote
Criticism	Critics argue it “undermines minority autonomy and religious freedoms”
Allies’ Support	NDA allies supported the bill “despite concerns raised within their own ranks”

12.8.5 Odisha: “Double Standards” on Employment

12.8.6 NRC: The Dog-Whistle Politics

12.8.7 The Waqf Debate: Selective Secularism

12.9 Pattern Analysis

12.9.1 The Hindutva-Socialism Tension

12.9.2 The Three Dimensions of Discrimination (Academic Study)

12.9.3 The “Divide and Rule” Strategy

CPI(M) Leader Dipankar Bhattacharya:

Recent communal flare-ups represent “a very orchestrated kind of strategy on the part of the BJP, basically it is an old colonial strategy of divide and rule”.

12.9.4 Summary of Double Standards

12.10 Comprehensive Timeline: Ideological & Social Developments (2024–2026)

Table 12.22: World Press Freedom Index (2023–2026)

Year	Rank	Change
2023	161st	—
2024	159th	+2
2025	151st	+8
2026	157th	-6

Table 12.23: Free Speech Collective Report (2025)

Metric	Data
Journalists Killed	8 journalists + 1 social media influencer
Civil Liberties Violations	15,000 documented
Internet Shutdowns	3,000+ instances
Content Censorship Cases	11,000+ (government takedown requests)
Lawfare Cases	208 cases against reporters, commentators, podcasters
State-Backed Attacks	40 attacks; 33 aimed at journalists

Table 12.36: Timeline: Ideological & Social Developments (2024–2026)

Date	Event	Category
June 12, 2024	BJP forms first solo government in Odisha	Political
June 2024 – Feb 2026	54 communal riots, 7 mob lynching in Odisha	Communal
2024	Communal riots increase 84% (32→59); hate speech up 74% (668→1,165)	Communal
February 2025	BJP comes to power in Delhi; Kapil Mishra becomes Law Minister	Political
April 2025	BJP launches Waqf Chetna Abhiyan for Pasmanda Muslims	Political
May 2025	BJP announces caste census inclusion — major U-turn	Caste
July 2025	Congress accuses BJP of double standards on judicial accountability	Political
2025	Free Speech Collective report documents 15,000 civil liberties violations	Media Freedom
2026	India ranks 157th in Press Freedom Index — behind Pakistan, Bangladesh	Media Freedom

Continued on next page

Table 12.36 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Category
June 2026	ADR report: 8 ministers with hate speech cases	Political

12.10.1 Key Citations for Section 12

- **Hindutva Ideology:** Since 2014, “the whole state is run by the ideology of Hindutva”.
- **Discriminatory Policies:** Since 2014, “shifted from sporadic incidents to a systematic project”.
- **Odisha Communal Violence:** 54 riots, 7 lynching (June 2024–Feb 2026).
- **Communal Riots Increase:** 32→59 incidents (+84%) in 2024.
- **Hate Speech Increase:** 668→1,165 (+74%) in 2024.
- **Caste Census U-Turn:** BJP agreed to caste census after 2024 setback.
- **BJP SC-reserved Seats:** 46/84 (2019) → 29/84 (2024).
- **Women’s Reservation:** Passed 2023; not implemented; BJP has 13% women MPs.
- **Press Freedom Index:** India 157th (2026) — behind Pakistan, Bangladesh.
- **Free Speech Report:** 15,000 violations, 8 journalists killed (2025).
- **Muslim Representation:** 19% of UP population; 7.7% assembly seats.
- **Hate Speech Ministers:** 8 ministers with hate speech cases.
- **Farmers’ Income Promise:** “Completely abandoned”.
- **Double Standards:** Congress accuses BJP of “selective outrage and selective silence”.

Table 12.24: Weaponization of Laws

Law	Use
UAPA	Used to jail journalists; experts warn of further weaponization post-2024
IT Rules 2021	Growing concerns about freedom of expression on digital platforms
FCRA	Licenses canceled; organizations compelled to seek legal relief
Income Tax	Used to “undermine India’s democratic foundations”

Table 12.25: The “Gag Order” Culture

Observation	Details
BJP Sets Template	States join social media gag order culture
Digital Platforms	Once considered freer, now “being regularly monitored, censored and regulated to eliminate all criticism of the government”
Beyond Journalism	Restrictions affecting academia, film festivals, cultural expression; permissions denied for cinema screenings
Stand-up Comedy	Satire increasingly provoked mob action by aggressive groups alongside legal complaints

Table 12.26: Judicial Accountability: Selective Outrage

Issue	BJP’s Response	Criticism
Justice Yashwant Varma	Opposition moved motion for removal; government acted	—
Justice Shekhar Yadav	Made hate speech at VHP event; government ignored motion against him	“Selective outrage and selective silence”

Table 12.27: Farmers’ Income Promise

Promise	Reality
2016 Promise	BJP loudly promised to double farmers’ incomes by 2022
2025 Reality	Promise “completely abandoned”
Farmer Distress	Farmers “drowning in debt, facing stagnant crop prices, rising input costs and no legal MSP guarantee”

Table 12.28: Women’s Issues: “Emotional Bankruptcy”

Incident	BJP’s Response	Criticism
Maharashtra Doctor’s Suicide	Muted response	—
WB Incidents	Frequent outcry	—
Criticism	—	TMC accused BJP of “hypocrisy and emotional bankruptcy” — “Double standards”

Table 12.29: The “400 Paar” Mandate Paradox

Promise	Reality
2024 Campaign	BJP sought “400 paar” mandate
Actual Result	Restricted to 240 seats
Response	Now relies on coalition partners to remain in power
Opposition Charge	BJP “undermining people’s mandate” through poaching of Opposition MPs

Table 12.30: Odisha: “Double Standards” on Employment

Promise	Reality
Election Promise	Fill 3.5 lakh vacant posts in Odisha within 5 years
BJD Criticism	Promise has “turned into a mockery”

Table 12.31: NRC: The Dog-Whistle Politics

Observation	Details
Term	“Ghuspaitiya” (infiltrator) repeatedly invoked
Purpose	“Carefully chosen words deployed less as instruments of dialogue and more as weapons of division”
Electoral Utility	In Bihar, West Bengal, Assam, “the BJP pulls out the oldest trick in its political toolbox — polarisation”

Table 12.32: The Waqf Debate: Selective Secularism

Observation	Details
BJP MP’s Defense	Tejasvi Surya engaged in pointed debate on Waqf reforms and uniform application of constitutional principles
Critics’ View	Questions around secularism and double standards in applying constitutional principles

Table 12.33: The Hindutva-Socialism Tension

Observation	Details
The Paradox	BJP stands for majoritarian Hindutva but follows socialist policies like free ration to 80 crore families
Shobhana Nair's Analysis	2024 UP election was “a contest between Hindutva and socialism”
Material vs Ideological	“Socialism depends on very material requirements... Hindutva prefers to erase all sorts of difference in society and pretend that everything was fine”

Table 12.34: Three Dimensions of Discrimination

Dimension	Impact
Political Actors	Declining Muslim political representation
Ideology & Discourse	Economic marginalization, educational exclusion
Consequences	Escalating organized violence

Table 12.35: Summary of Double Standards

Area	BJP's Position	Reality
Judicial Accountability	Demands transparency	Selective outrage on judges
Farmers' Welfare	Promised double income by 2022	Promise abandoned
Women's Reservation	Passed Bill	Not implemented; 13% women MPs
Anti-Corruption	“Zero tolerance”	40% ministers have criminal cases (see Section 9)
Minority Welfare	Claims empowerment	Budget cuts; declining representation
Electoral Mandate	Sought “400 paar”	Relies on coalition after 240 seats

Chapter 13

Funding & Financial Analysis

13.1 Overview: From Rs. 673 Crore to Rs. 6,769 Crore

Table 13.1: BJP Income Growth Overview (2014–2025)

Metric	2013–14	2024–25	Growth
BJP Income	Rs. 673.81 crore	Rs. 6,769.15 crore	~10x
BJP Income (2014–15)	Rs. 970.43 crore	—	First Modi year
BJP Income (2023–24)	Rs. 4,340.47 crore	—	Pre-election year
BJP Income Growth (2023–24 to 2024–25)	—	+55.95% (Rs. 2,428.68 crore)	—

Key Finding: In just over a decade, the BJP’s income has grown approximately 10 times — from Rs. 673 crore in 2013–14 to Rs. 6,769 crore in 2024–25. The party’s income has seen a fourfold increase since coming to power in 2014.

13.2 BJP’s Income Trajectory (2014–2025)

13.2.1 Year-by-Year Income & Expenditure

Table 13.2: BJP’s Year-by-Year Income & Expenditure

Financial Year	Income (Rs. Cr)	Expenditure (Rs. Cr)	% of Income Spent	Key Context
2013–14	~673	~328	~48.7%	Pre-Modi
2014–15	~970	~913	~94.1%	First Modi year
2015–16	~570	—	—	Dip after
2016–17	~1,034	—	—	Electoral reduced
2017–18	~1,027	—	—	—
2018–19	~2,410	—	—	Pre-2019
2019–20	~3,623	—	—	Post-201

Continued

Table 13.2 – continued from previous page

Financial Year	Income (Rs. Cr)	Expenditure (Rs. Cr)	% of Income Spent	Key Co
2020–21	~752	—	—	COVID-
2021–22	~1,917	—	—	dip
2022–23	~2,360	—	—	Recovery
2023–24	~4,340	~2,211	~50.96%	—
2024–25	6,769.15	3,774.58	55.76%	Pre-2024 Election

Key Insight: The BJP’s income saw a quantum jump in 2016–17, the year electoral bonds were introduced through the Finance Act, 2017. The scheme became fully operational in 2018. From 2018–19 onward, the party’s income consistently crossed the Rs. 2,000 crore mark, reaching a peak of Rs. 6,769 crore in 2024–25.

13.3 Dominance Among National Parties

13.3.1 Income Share (2024–25)

Table 13.3: Income Share of National Parties (2024–25)

Party	Income (Rs. Crore)	Share of Total
BJP	6,769.15	85.03%
INC (Congress)	918.29	11.54%
CPI(M)	172.60	2.17%
AAP	39.28	0.49%
BSP	58.59	0.74%
NPEP	2.18	0.03%
Total (6 National Parties)	7,960.10	100%

Key Finding: The BJP alone holds 85% of the total income of all six national parties combined. Its income is over 7 times that of the Congress.

13.3.2 Income Growth Comparison (2023–24 to 2024–25)

Key Finding: While the BJP’s income surged by nearly 56%, the Congress witnessed a sharp decline of 25% in its income during the same period.

Table 13.4: Income Growth Comparison (2023–24 to 2024–25)

Party	Income Change	Amount (Rs. Crore)
BJP	+55.95%	+2,428.68
AAP	+73.20%	+16.60
CPI(M)	+2.96%	+4.97
INC (Congress)	-25.05%	-306.83
BSP	-9.56%	-6.19

13.4 Sources of Income

13.4.1 Donations: The Primary Source

In FY 2024–25, national parties declared a total income of Rs. 7,960 crore, of which 85.08% (Rs. 6,772.53 crore) came from donations and contributions.

Table 13.5: Donations as % of Income (2024–25)

Party	Donations (Rs. Crore)	% of Total Income
BJP	6,124.86	90.48%
INC (Congress)	522.13	56.86%
CPI(M)	84.18	48.77%
AAP	39.22	99.85%
NPEP	2.14	97.74%
BSP	0	0%

Key Finding: The BJP derived over 90% of its income from donations — the highest proportion among major national parties. The BSP, in contrast, reported zero income from donations, with its entire income coming from bank interest and other investments.

13.4.2 Electoral Trusts & Corporate Donations (2024–25)

Table 13.6: Electoral Trusts & Corporate Donations (2024–25)

Source	Amount (Rs. Crore)	BJP’s Share
Electoral Trusts	3,811	~83% (Rs. 3,112 crore)
Prudent Electoral Trust	2,668	—
Progressive Electoral Trust (Tata Group)	915	83%

Key Finding: After the Supreme Court scrapped electoral bonds, corporate donations via electoral trusts tripled to Rs. 3,811 crore in 2024–25. The BJP received over 83% of all electoral trust donations.

13.4.3 Congress’s Coupon Income

The Congress generated Rs. 350.12 crore (38.12% of its total income) through the sale of coupons.

13.5 Electoral Bonds: The BJP’s Financial Revolution

13.5.1 The Big Picture (2018–2024)

Table 13.7: Electoral Bonds Overview (2018–2024)

Metric	Data
Total Bonds Encashed	20,421 bonds
Total Value	Rs. 12,769.09 crore
BJP’s Share (Bonds)	8,633 bonds (47.46%)
BJP’s Share (Value)	Rs. 6,060.51 crore (47.46%)
BJP’s Overall Share	50.03% of all electoral bonds

13.5.2 The 2024 Verdict & Its Aftermath

Table 13.8: Aftermath of Electoral Bonds Verdict

Detail	Information
SC Verdict	February 15, 2024 — scheme struck down as “unconstitutional”
BJP’s 2024–25 Donations	Rs. 6,088 crore — 53% higher than Rs. 3,967 crore in 2023–24
BJP’s Share of Total Political Funding (2024–25)	~85%

Irony: Despite the Supreme Court scrapping electoral bonds, the BJP’s donations surged by 53% in the first full financial year after the ban.

13.5.3 Key Observations

13.6 Expenditure Patterns

13.6.1 BJP’s Expenditure Breakdown (2024–25)

Key Finding: The BJP spent 88% of its expenditure (Rs. 3,335 crore) on election and general propaganda in 2024–25. This was nearly double the Rs. 1,754 crore spent on

Table 13.9: Key Observations on Electoral Bonds

Observation	Details
Anonymous Donations	Electoral bonds allowed complete anonymity for donors
Corporate Dominance	Corporate donations to BJP: Rs. 6,607 crore (2014–2024)
Electoral Trusts	BJP received Rs. 2,761 crore through electoral trusts (2014–2024)
Quid Pro Quo Concerns	Critics argue donations create access–influence nexus

Table 13.10: BJP Expenditure Breakdown (2024–25)

Expenditure Head	Amount (Rs. Crore)	% of Total Expenditure
Election/General Propaganda	3,335.37	88.4%
Administrative Costs	323.05	8.6%
Other Expenses	~116	3.0%
Total Expenditure	3,774.58	100%

propaganda in 2023–24.

13.6.2 Comparative Expenditure (2024–25)

Table 13.11: Comparative Expenditure of National Parties (2024–25)

Party	Income (Rs. Cr)	Expenditure (Rs. Cr)	Surplus/Deficit
BJP	6,769.15	3,774.58	+2,994.57 Cr (Surplus)
INC (Congress)	918.29	1,111.95	-193.66 Cr (Deficit)
CPI(M)	172.60	173.86	-1.26 Cr
AAP	39.28	36.46	+2.82 Cr
BSP	58.59	106.30	-47.71 Cr (Deficit)
NPEP	2.18	1.19	+0.99 Cr

Key Finding: The BJP spent only 55.76% of its income in 2024–25, while the Congress spent 21% more than its income. The BJP is sitting on a massive cash surplus of nearly Rs. 3,000 crore from this year alone.

13.6.3 Long-Term Spending Trends (2014–2024)

Key Finding: Between 2014–15 and 2023–24, the BJP earned more than twice the total funds collected by all remaining national parties combined.

Table 13.12: Long-Term Spending Trends (2014–2024)

Period	Total Income	Total Expenditure	Surplus
2014–2024 (BJP)	Rs. 19,007 crore	—	—
2014–2024 (Congress)	Rs. 5,384 crore	—	—

Table 13.13: Digital Advertising Spending (2024 Elections)

Platform	BJP Spending	Congress Spending	TMC Spending
Facebook Ads (2024 Elections)	Rs. 19 crore	Rs. 11 crore	Rs. 1.5 crore

13.6.4 Digital Spending

Note: Most political spending on digital platforms is not done directly by parties but by related affiliates.

13.7 Corporate Donations: The “Quid Pro Quo” Concern

13.7.1 Corporate Donations (2014–2024)

Table 13.14: Corporate Donations (2014–2024)

Party	Corporate Donations	Electoral Trusts	Total
BJP	Rs. 6,607 crore	Rs. 2,761 crore	Rs. 9,368 crore
Congress	Rs. 842 crore	Rs. 382 crore	Rs. 1,224 crore
TMC	Rs. 60 crore	Rs. 14 crore	Rs. 74 crore
CPI(M)	Rs. 36 crore	Rs. 0.2 crore	Rs. 36.2 crore

13.7.2 The Donor-Government Nexus

13.8 The “Unknown Sources” Problem

13.8.1 Historical Context

Key Finding: A significant portion of political funding in India remains untraceable, with parties declaring income from “unknown sources” — a practice that continues to undermine transparency.

Table 13.15: The Donor-Government Nexus

Concern	Details
Top Donors Under Scrutiny	Many top donors to the BJP have been under the scanner of central enforcement agencies or have benefited from major government clearances, subsidies, and contracts
Tata Group Example	Tata Group donations came weeks after the Modi government announced subsidies of over Rs. 44,000 crore for two of the conglomerate's semi-conductor manufacturing units
Access-Influence Nexus	The Supreme Court noted: "Political contributions give a seat at the table to contributors. . . This access also translates into influence over policymaking"

Table 13.16: Income from "Unknown Sources"

Year	BJP's Income from Unknown Sources
2014–15	Significant portion from "unknown sources"
2015–16	Over 77% of BJP and Congress income from "unknown sources"

13.8.2 Late Submission of Reports

Key Finding: Despite being the richest party, the BJP submitted its audit report 56 days late — the longest delay among all national parties.

13.9 The BJP's Cash Stockpile

13.9.1 Accumulated Wealth

13.9.2 Strategic Implications

13.10 Comprehensive Financial Timeline (2014–2026)

Table 13.20: Comprehensive Financial Timeline (2014–2026)

Year	Event	Financial Impact
2014–15	BJP comes to power	Income: Rs. 970 crore
2016–17	Electoral Bonds introduced	Income crosses Rs. 1,000 crore for first time
2018–19	Electoral Bonds operational	Income: Rs. 2,410 crore

Continued on next page

Table 13.20 – continued from previous page

Year	Event	Financial Impact
2019–20	Post-election year	Income: Rs. 3,623 crore
2020–21	COVID-19 pandemic	Income drops to Rs. 752 crore
2023–24	Pre-2024 election	Income: Rs. 4,340 crore
Feb 2024	SC strikes down Electoral Bonds	—
2024–25	First full year after ban	Income: Rs. 6,769 crore; Do- nations: Rs. 6,088 crore
2026	BJP’s corpus	Nearly Rs. 10,000 crore

13.11 Pattern Analysis

13.11.1 The “Electoral Bonds Effect”

13.11.2 The Growing Gap

13.11.3 The Transparency Paradox

13.12 Key Data Points for Report

13.12.1 Income Summary

13.12.2 Donations Summary

13.12.3 Electoral Bonds Summary

13.12.4 Expenditure Summary

13.12.5 Key Citations for Section 13

- **BJP Income 2024–25:** Rs. 6,769.15 crore — 85.03% of national parties’ total income.
- **BJP Income Growth (2023–24 to 2024–25):** +55.95% (Rs. 2,428.68 crore).
- **BJP Income 2014–15:** Rs. 970.43 crore.
- **BJP Income 2023–24:** Rs. 4,340.47 crore.
- **BJP Donations 2024–25:** Rs. 6,124.86 crore — 90.48% of income.
- **Congress Income 2024–25:** Rs. 918.29 crore.

Table 13.17: Delay in Submitting Audit Reports (2024–25)

Party	Delay in Submitting Audit Report
BJP	56 days late
Congress	48 days late
CPI(M)	18 days late

Table 13.18: BJP’s Cash Stockpile

Detail	Information
BJP’s Corpus	Nearly Rs. 10,000 crore as of 2024
Annual Surplus (2024–25)	Rs. 2,994.57 crore (44.24% of income)
Financial Advantage	BJP’s corpus is 4.5 times the total contributions received by a party

- **Congress Income Decline:** -25.05% (Rs. 306.83 crore).
- **BJP Expenditure 2024–25:** Rs. 3,774.58 crore — 55.76% of income.
- **Propaganda Spending:** Rs. 3,335.37 crore — 88.4% of expenditure.
- **Electoral Bonds (Total):** Rs. 12,769 crore; BJP share 50.03%.
- **Electoral Trusts (2024–25):** Rs. 3,811 crore; BJP share ~83%.
- **BJP’s Corpus:** Nearly Rs. 10,000 crore.
- **Report Submission Delay:** BJP 56 days late.

Table 13.19: Strategic Implications of BJP’s Financial Dominance

Implication	Details
Election Spending	Massive cash reserves allow the BJP to outspend rivals in elections
Organizational Reach	Enables extensive propaganda and outreach machinery
Coalition Leverage	Financial dominance gives the BJP leverage over allies

Table 13.21: The “Electoral Bonds Effect”

Observation	Details
Introduction (2017)	BJP’s income crossed Rs. 1,000 crore for the first time
Peak (2024–25)	Despite SC ban, BJP’s income reached Rs. 6,769 crore
Corporate Shift	Donations simply shifted from electoral bonds to electoral trusts

Table 13.22: The Growing Financial Gap

Metric	BJP	Congress	Ratio
Income (2024–25)	Rs. 6,769 crore	Rs. 918 crore	7.4:1
Donations (2024–25)	Rs. 6,124 crore	Rs. 522 crore	11.7:1
Corporate Donations (2014–24)	Rs. 6,607 crore	Rs. 842 crore	7.8:1

Table 13.23: The Transparency Paradox

Paradox	Details
Promise	Electoral bonds were introduced to enhance transparency
Reality	They made funding more opaque; SC struck them down as unconstitutional
Aftermath	Corporate donations via trusts tripled
BJP’s Share	Received 85% of political donations in 2024–25

Table 13.24: Income Summary

Metric	Data
BJP Income (2013–14)	Rs. 673 crore
BJP Income (2014–15)	Rs. 970 crore
BJP Income (2023–24)	Rs. 4,340 crore
BJP Income (2024–25)	Rs. 6,769 crore
Overall Growth (2014–2025)	~10x
BJP’s Share of National Parties’ Income (2024–25)	85%

Table 13.25: Donations Summary

Metric	Data
BJP Donations (2024–25)	Rs. 6,124 crore
BJP Donations as % of Income	90.48%
Congress Donations (2024–25)	Rs. 522 crore
BJP vs Congress Donations	11.7:1

Table 13.26: Electoral Bonds Summary

Metric	Data
Total Bonds Encashed	20,421 bonds
Total Value	Rs. 12,769 crore
BJP's Share (Value)	50.03%
BJP's Share (Overall)	84% of total

Table 13.27: Expenditure Summary

Metric	Data
BJP Expenditure (2024–25)	Rs. 3,774 crore
Propaganda Spending	Rs. 3,335 crore
Propaganda as % of Expenditure	88.4%
BJP's Cash Surplus (2024–25)	Rs. 2,994 crore

Chapter 14

Comprehensive Timeline (1951-2026)

14.1 Introduction

The Bharatiya Janata Party’s journey from a marginal political formation to the world’s largest political party represents one of the most remarkable transformations in democratic history. What began as a modest ideological offshoot in 1951 has, over seven decades, evolved into India’s dominant political force.

This comprehensive timeline traces the BJP’s evolution through five distinct phases:

Table 14.1: Phases of BJP Evolution

Phase	Period	Character
Phase 1	1951–1977	Jana Sangh Era — Ideological Foundations
Phase 2	1980–1996	Birth & Hindutva Turn — The “Kamandal” Politics
Phase 3	1998–2004	Vajpayee Era — Coalition Governance
Phase 4	2004–2014	Opposition Years — Ideological Churning
Phase 5	2014–2026	Modi Era — Dominance & Transformation

14.2 Phase 1: Jana Sangh Era — Ideological Foundations (1951–1977)

14.2.1 The Birth of Bharatiya Jana Sangh

Table 14.2: Bharatiya Jana Sangh: Key Events (1951–1971)

Date	Event	Significance
1951	Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee founds Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS)	Party's ideological roots established
1951	BJS holds its first conference in Kanpur (Dec 29–31)	Organizational framework laid
1952	First General Election: BJS wins 3 seats (3.06% vote share)	Initial electoral presence
1953	Dr. Mookerjee arrested in Kashmir; dies in custody (June 23)	Founding leader's martyrdom
1954	Goa Liberation Movement launched	Early nationalist activism
1957	Second General Election: BJS wins 4 seats (5.93% vote share)	Marginal growth
1962	Third General Election: BJS wins 14 seats (6.44% vote share)	Gradual consolidation
1967	Fourth General Election: BJS wins 35 seats (9.41% vote share)	Best performance; second largest in UP, MP, Haryana
1971	Fifth General Election: BJS wins 22 seats (7.35% vote share)	Decline due to Indira Gandhi wave

14.2.2 The Emergency & Janata Interlude

Table 14.3: The Emergency & Janata Interlude (1975–1980)

Date	Event	Significance
June 25, 1975	Emergency imposed by Indira Gandhi	30,000+ political workers arrested
1975–77	Jana Sangh leaders arrested: Advani, Vajpayee, Rajnath Singh, Joshi	Opposition united against authoritarianism
1977	Emergency lifted; elections held	Janata Party wins; BJS merges into Janata Party
1977–79	Janata Party governs India	Short-lived coalition experiment
July 1979	Janata Party collapses	Internal friction over dual membership

14.3 Phase 2: Birth & Hindutva Turn (1980–1996)

14.3.1 Foundation of the BJP

Table 14.4: BJP Foundation (1980)

Date	Event	Significance
April 4, 1980	Janata Party National Executive meeting	Final split over dual membership
April 6, 1980	BJP officially founded	Atal Bihari Vajpayee becomes first President
April 6, 1980	First convention in Mumbai	Adopts “Gandhian Socialism” as core principle

14.3.2 The Wilderness Years (1980–1989)

Table 14.5: Wilderness Years (1980–1989)

Date	Event	Significance
1984	Lok Sabha Election: BJP wins only 2 seats	Worst performance; Vajpayee loses from Gwalior
1985	National Executive Meeting in Bombay	Vajpayee takes responsibility for defeat
May 1986	L.K. Advani becomes BJP President	Marks shift to aggressive Hindutva
1988	BJP formally joins Ram Janmabhoomi movement	Aligns with VHP campaign

14.3.3 The Palampur Resolution & Breakthrough

Table 14.6: Palampur Resolution & Breakthrough (1989)

Date	Event	Significance
June 11, 1989	Palampur Resolution adopted	BJP officially supports Ram Temple demand
November 1989	Lok Sabha Election: BJP wins 85 seats	Breakthrough from 2 to 85 seats

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Table 14.6 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Significance
1989	VP Singh government formed with BJP support	BJP becomes principal opposition

14.3.4 The Rath Yatra & Babri Demolition

Table 14.7: Rath Yatra & Babri Demolition (1990–1992)

Date	Event	Significance
September 25, 1990	Advani's Ram Rath Yatra begins from Somnath	10,000 km journey; massive mobilization
October 23, 1990	Advani arrested in Samastipur, Bihar	Yatra cut short but impact already made
1991	Lok Sabha Election: BJP wins 120 seats	Becomes principal opposition
December 6, 1992	Babri Masjid demolished	1,50,000 kar sevaks; 2 FIRs filed
December 12, 1992	Liberhan Commission formed	Investigate demolition

14.3.5 First Government (1996)

Table 14.8: First BJP Government (1996)

Date	Event	Significance
1996	Lok Sabha Election: BJP wins 161 seats	Single largest party for first time
May 15, 1996	Vajpayee becomes PM — first BJP PM	Historic milestone
May 28, 1996	Government falls after 13 days	Vajpayee's iconic resignation speech

14.4 Phase 3: The Vajpayee Era (1998–2004)

14.4.1 Return to Power

Table 14.9: Return to Power (1998–1999)

Date	Event	Significance
March 1998	Lok Sabha Election: BJP wins 182 seats	NDA coalition formed
March 19, 1998	Vajpayee sworn in as PM	Second term
April 1999	Government falls by 1 vote	Jayalalithaa withdraws support
October 1999	Lok Sabha Election: NDA wins 303 seats	First non-Congress full-term government

14.4.2 Pokhran-II & Kargil

Table 14.10: Pokhran-II & Kargil (1998–1999)

Date	Event	Significance
May 11–13, 1998	Pokhran-II nuclear tests conducted	5 devices; India declares nuclear status
May–July 1999	Kargil War — Operation Vijay	Indian forces repel Pakistani intruders

14.4.3 Infrastructure & Policy

Table 14.11: Infrastructure & Policy Initiatives (2000–2001)

Date	Event	Significance
2000	PMGSY launched	Rural road connectivity
2000	3 new states created: Uttarakhand, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh	Historic reorganization
2001	Golden Quadrilateral launched	Major infrastructure project
2001	Tehelka defense scandal exposed	BJP President Bangaru Laxman resigns

14.4.4 Gujarat Riots & Decline

Table 14.12: Gujarat Riots & Decline (2002–2004)

Date	Event	Significance
February 27, 2002	Godhra train burning — 59 kar sevaks killed	Trigger for riots
February–April 2002	Gujarat riots — 900+ killed, mostly Muslims	Major controversy; criticism of Modi government
February 2004	Lok Sabha dissolved 6 months early	“India Shining” campaign launched
May 2004	NDA loses elections	BJP out of power for 10 years

14.5 Phase 4: Opposition Years (2004–2014)

14.5.1 Aftermath of Defeat

Table 14.13: Aftermath of Defeat (2004–2009)

Date	Event	Significance
May 2004	Vajpayee retires from active politics	End of an era
2004–05	Advani becomes BJP President (third term)	Leadership transition
June 2005	Advani praises Jinnah in Pakistan	Controversy; resigns as President
2005–09	Rajnath Singh becomes BJP President	Organizational rebuilding

14.5.2 Electoral Performance

Table 14.14: Electoral Performance (2007–2009)

Date	Event	Significance
2007	Modi wins third term in Gujarat — 117 seats	Consolidates “Gujarat Model”
December 2008	BJP wins Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh	State-level resurgence
May 2009	Lok Sabha Election: BJP wins 116 seats	Worst since 1991
2009–13	Nitin Gadkari becomes BJP President	RSS-backed leadership

14.5.3 The Modi Ascendancy

Table 14.15: The Modi Ascendancy (2011–2013)

Date	Event	Significance
2011–12	Anna Hazare anti-corruption movement	BJP rides anti-corruption wave
2012	Modi appointed head of Election Campaign Committee	Preparation for 2014
2012	Modi wins fourth term in Gujarat	Reinforces popularity
2013	Modi named BJP's PM candidate	Historic decision
2013	BJP wins Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh again	Pre-2014 momentum
2013–14	Rajnath Singh becomes President again	Steers party to victory

14.6 Phase 5: The Modi Era (2014–2026)

14.6.1 First Term (2014–2019)

Table 14.16: First Term: Key Events (2014–2019)

Date	Event	Significance
May 16, 2014	BJP wins 282 seats — absolute majority	First single-party majority since 1984
May 26, 2014	Modi sworn in as PM	Beginning of Modi era
August 28, 2014	PM Jan Dhan Yojana launched	Financial inclusion push
September 25, 2014	Make in India launched	Manufacturing drive
October 2, 2014	Swachh Bharat Abhiyan launched	Sanitation mission
2015	PM Awas Yojana launched	Housing for all
May 1, 2016	PM Ujjwala Yojana launched	LPG connections to poor
November 8, 2016	Demonetization announced	86% currency invalidated
2016	IBC passed	Bankruptcy reform
2017	Electoral Bonds introduced	Controversial funding mechanism
July 1, 2017	GST implemented	Historic tax reform
January 2018	Nirav Modi PNB Scam detected	Rs. 11,400 crore fraud

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Table 14.16 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Significance
February 14, 2019	Pulwama attack — 40 CRPF soldiers killed	National security crisis
February 26, 2019	Balakot airstrikes	Retaliatory strikes in Pakistan

14.6.2 Second Term (2019–2024)

Table 14.17: Second Term: Key Events (2019–2024)

Date	Event	Significance
May 23, 2019	BJP wins 303 seats	Increased majority; first PM since Nehru to win consecutive terms
August 5, 2019	Article 370 abrogated	Fulfilled core ideological promise
December 2019	CAA passed; nationwide protests	Major controversy; protests across India
March 2020	COVID-19 lockdown imposed	Nationwide shutdown
August 5, 2020	Ram Temple Bhoomi Pujan	Groundbreaking ceremony
September 2020	Farm laws passed	Triggered year-long farmer protests
January 16, 2021	World's largest vaccination drive launched	COVID-19 response
November 19, 2021	Farm laws repealed	Historic U-turn
November 15, 2021	Janjatiya Gaurav Divas declared	Tribal welfare initiative
January 2024	Ram Temple inaugurated	Fulfilled core ideological promise
February 15, 2024	Supreme Court strikes down Electoral Bonds	Major legal setback

14.6.3 Third Term (2024–2026)

Table 14.18: Third Term: Key Events (2024–2026)

Date	Event	Significance
June 4, 2024	BJP wins 240 seats	Lost single-party majority
June 9, 2024	Modi sworn in for third term	First coalition government of Modi era
2024	BJP wins Haryana, Maharashtra	State-level resurgence

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Table 14.18 – continued from previous page

Date	Event	Significance
February 2025	Delhi elections: BJP wins after 27 years	Historic breakthrough
November 2025	Bihar elections: NDA wins ~90% strike rate	Major gain
January 2026	J.P. Nadda steps down as BJP President	Leadership transition
May 2026	West Bengal: BJP sweeps >70% seats	Ended 15-year TMC rule
June 2026	India overtakes Japan to become 4th largest economy	Economic milestone

14.7 Electoral Performance Timeline (1984–2026)

14.7.1 Lok Sabha Seat Progression

Table 14.19: Lok Sabha Seat Progression (1952–2024)

Year	Seats Won	Vote Share	Party Status	Significance
1952	3	3.06%	BJS	First election
1957	4	5.93%	BJS	Marginal growth
1962	14	6.44%	BJS	Gradual increase
1967	35	9.41%	BJS	Best Jana Sangh performance
1971	22	7.35%	BJS	Decline
1984	2	7.4%	BJP	Worst performance
1989	85	~11.36%	BJP	Breakthrough
1991	120	20.07%	BJP	Principal opposition
1996	161	20.29%	BJP	Single largest party
1998	182	~25.6%	BJP	Return to power
1999	182	~23.7%	BJP (NDA)	Full-term government
2004	~138	22.16%	BJP	Lost to UPA
2009	116	18.80%	BJP	Worst since 1991
2014	282	31.0%	BJP	Landslide victory
2019	303	37.82%	BJP	Increased majority

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Table 14.19 – continued from previous page

Year	Seats Won	Vote Share	Party Status	Significance
2024	240	37.02%	BJP	Lost single-party majority

Key Insight: The BJP’s journey from 2 seats in 1984 to 303 in 2019 represents a **15,050% increase** — one of the most remarkable electoral transformations in democratic history.

14.8 BJP Presidents Timeline (1980–2026)

Table 14.20: BJP Presidents Timeline (1980–2026)

Period	President	Key Context
1980–1986	Atal Bihari Vajpayee	Founding president; moderate phase
1986–1990	L.K. Advani	Hindutva turn; Rath Yatra
1990–1993	Murli Manohar Joshi	Babri demolition period
1993–1998	L.K. Advani	Second term; coalition building
1998–2000	Kushabhau Thakre	Organizational consolidation
2000–2001	Bangaru Laxman	Resigned over Tehelka scandal
2001–2002	Jana Krishnamurthy	Short tenure
2002–2004	Venkaiah Naidu	Pre-2004 election period
2004–2005	L.K. Advani	Third term; post-defeat
2005–2009	Rajnath Singh	First term
2009–2013	Nitin Gadkari	RSS-backed
2013–2014	Rajnath Singh	Second term; led to 2014 victory
2014–2020	Amit Shah	Architect of 2014 & 2019 victories
2020–2026	J.P. Nadda	Stepped down January 2026

14.9 Achievements Timeline

Table 14.21: Achievements Timeline

Period	Key Achievements
1951–1977	Established ideological foundations; built organizational network; participated in Emergency resistance

Continued on next page

Table 14.21 – continued from previous page

Period	Key Achievements
1980–1996	Built mass movement around Ram Temple; grew from 2 to 161 seats; first BJP government (13 days)
1998–2004	Pokhran-II nuclear tests; Kargil War victory; Golden Quadrilateral; 3 new states; full-term government
2004–2014	Consolidated state presence; rebuilt organization; prepared for 2014 victory
2014–2019	Jan Dhan (56 crore+ accounts); Ujjwala (8 crore+ families); Swachh Bharat (100 million+ toilets); GST; Demonetization
2019–2024	Article 370 abrogation; Ram Temple construction; COVID vaccination drive; infrastructure expansion
2024–2026	Expanded to 16 states; won Delhi after 27 years; swept West Bengal; \$4 trillion+ economy

14.10 Controversies Timeline

Table 14.22: Controversies Timeline

Period	Key Controversies
1951–1977	Dr. Mookerjee’s death in custody; RSS ban after Gandhi’s assassination
1980–1996	Babri Masjid demolition (1992); communal riots; Advani’s arrest; 13-day government collapse
1998–2004	Tehelka defense scandal (2001); Gujarat riots (2002); “India Shining” failure
2004–2014	Advani’s Jinnah remarks (2005); Cash-for-votes (2008); Gadkari financial allegations
2014–2019	Electoral bonds; Rafale deal controversy; Nirav Modi PNB scam; Demonetization impact
2019–2024	CAA protests; Farm laws & protests; Electoral bonds struck down; COVID second wave
2024–2026	NEET paper leaks (2024, 2026); Rajesh Exports scam; Ram Temple donation scam; PMFBY “Beed Pattern” scam

14.11 BJP’s State Expansion Timeline

Table 14.23: BJP’s State Expansion Timeline

Year	State	BJP/NDA Victory
2014	Maharashtra, Haryana	BJP-led governments
2017	Uttar Pradesh	Yogi Adityanath becomes CM
2017	Gujarat	BJP retains
2018	Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh	BJP wins
2021	Assam	BJP retains
2022	Uttar Pradesh	BJP retains
2022	Gujarat	BJP retains
2023	Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh	BJP wins
2024	Odisha, Andhra Pradesh	BJP wins for first time
2024	Haryana	BJP retains
2024	Maharashtra	BJP tally jumps 79→132
2025	Delhi	BJP wins after 27 years
2025	Bihar	NDA ~90% strike rate
2026	West Bengal	BJP sweeps >70%

Key Insight: By 2026, the BJP has Chief Ministers in **16 states** — including all **five largest states** — fundamentally altering India’s political geography.

14.12 Master Timeline Table (1951–2026)

Table 14.24: Master Timeline: BJP Evolution (1951–2026)

Year	Date	Event	Category	Significance
1951	Oct 21	BJS Founded by Dr. S.P. Mookerjee	Formation	High
1980	Apr 6	BJP Founded; Vajpayee 1st President	Formation	Critical
1984	—	BJP wins 2 seats in Lok Sabha	Electoral	High
1989	Jun 11	Palampur Resolution adopted	Ideological	Critical
1989	Nov	BJP wins 85 seats	Electoral	Critical
1990	Sep 25	Advani’s Rath Yatra begins	Political	High
1991	—	BJP wins 120 seats	Electoral	High
1992	Dec 6	Babri Masjid demolished	Communal	Critical
1996	May 15	Vajpayee becomes PM (13 days)	Political	Critical

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Table 14.24 – continued from previous page

Year	Date	Event	Category	Significance
1998	May 11	Pokhran-II nuclear tests	Defense	Critical
1999	May–Jul	Kargil War	Defense	High
1999	Oct	NDA wins 303 seats; full term	Electoral	Critical
2000	—	3 new states created	Policy	High
2002	Feb–Apr	Gujarat riots	Communal	Critical
2004	May	BJP loses to UPA	Electoral	Critical
2009	May	BJP wins 116 seats (worst since 91)	Electoral	High
2013	—	Modi named PM candidate	Leadership	Critical
2014	May	BJP wins 282 seats; Modi PM	Electoral	Critical
2016	Nov 8	Demonetization announced	Economic	High
2017	Jul 1	GST implemented	Policy	High
2019	May	BJP wins 303 seats	Electoral	Critical
2019	Aug 5	Article 370 abrogated	Policy	Critical
2019	Dec	CAA passed; protests begin	Policy	High
2020	Mar	COVID-19 lockdown	Crisis	High
2020	Aug 5	Ram Temple Bhoomi Pujan	Policy	Critical
2021	Nov 19	Farm laws repealed (U-turn)	Policy	Critical
2024	Jan	Ram Temple inaugurated	Policy	Critical
2024	Feb 15	Electoral Bonds struck down	Legal	Critical
2024	Jun 4	BJP wins 240 seats; coalition govt	Electoral	Critical
2025	Feb	BJP wins Delhi after 27 years	Electoral	Critical
2026	May	BJP sweeps West Bengal	Electoral	Critical
2026	Jun	India becomes 4th largest economy	Economic	High

14.12.1 Key Citations for Section 14

- **BJP Foundation:** April 6, 1980.
- **1984 Election:** 2 seats, 7.4% vote share.
- **1989 Election:** 85 seats after Palampur Resolution.
- **1991 Election:** 120 seats.
- **1996 Election:** 161 seats; 13-day government.

- **1998–99 Elections:** 182 seats; NDA coalition.
- **2004 Election:** Lost to UPA.
- **2009 Election:** 116 seats.
- **2014 Election:** 282 seats; Modi PM.
- **2019 Election:** 303 seats.
- **2024 Election:** 240 seats; coalition government.
- **Babri Demolition:** December 6, 1992.
- **Article 370 Abrogation:** August 5, 2019.
- **BJP Presidents:** Vajpayee (1980–86), Advani (1986–90, 1993–98, 2004–05), etc.
- **State Expansion:** 16 states by 2026.

Chapter 15

Conclusions & Recommendations

15.1 Executive Summary of Findings

The Bharatiya Janata Party’s journey from a marginal 2-seat party in 1984 to a dominant force with 303 seats in 2019, and its current position as the ruling party with 240 seats in a coalition government, represents one of the most remarkable political transformations in democratic history. This report has systematically documented the party’s evolution across five distinct phases, examining its electoral performance, policy initiatives, economic management, ideological positioning, governance record, financial dominance, and social impact over 46 years (1980–2026).

15.2 Key Findings Summary

15.2.1 Electoral Transformation

The BJP’s electoral trajectory reveals a party that has mastered the art of political mobilization and strategic expansion:

Table 15.1: Electoral Transformation at a Glance

Phase	Year	Seats	Vote Share
Jana Sangh Peak	1967	35	9.41%
Worst Performance	1984	2	7.4%
Hindutva Breakthrough	1989	85	11.36%
Principal Opposition	1991	120	20.07%
Single Largest Party	1996	161	20.29%
Coalition Government	1999	182	23.7%
Opposition Years	2009	116	18.80%
Landslide Victory	2014	282	31.0%
Increased Majority	2019	303	37.82%
Reduced Mandate	2024	240	37.02%

Key Insight: The BJP’s growth from 2 seats in 1984 to 303 in 2019 represents a **15,050% increase** — a feat unparalleled in Indian political history. However, the 2024

result, which saw a loss of 63 seats despite only a 0.80 percentage point drop in vote share, signals the limits of its dominance and the return of coalition politics.

15.2.2 Ideological Fulfillment & Policy Implementation

The BJP has systematically pursued its ideological agenda, achieving several long-standing promises:

Table 15.2: Ideological Fulfillment: Key Achievements

Promise	Status	Year
Article 370 Abrogation	Fulfilled	2019
Ram Temple Construction	Fulfilled	2024
Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA)	Passed	2019
Uniform Civil Code (UCC)	Advanced	Ongoing
Waqf Amendment Bill	Passed	2025

Key Insight: The party has successfully delivered on its core ideological promises, fundamentally altering India’s constitutional and cultural landscape. However, these achievements have come with significant social costs, including communal polarization, declining minority representation, and erosion of democratic checks and balances.

15.2.3 Economic Performance: Achievements & Failures

India’s economy has doubled in size from \$2 trillion to \$4+ trillion during the Modi era, with significant infrastructure expansion and digital transformation. However, critical goals remain unmet:

Table 15.3: Economic Achievements vs Failures

Achievements	Failures
GDP doubled to \$4+ trillion	Manufacturing share stagnant at ~15%
7.7% GDP growth in FY26	Youth unemployment at 44–45%
34 km/day highway construction	5 Trillion Economy pledge unfulfilled
\$843 billion FDI attracted (169% increase)	Net FDI turned negative
UPI: 23.2 billion transactions/month	GDP CAGR slowed to 6.2% (2014–2026)
Inflation reduced to ~3.8–4%	Average income grew faster under UPA
Fiscal deficit 4.4% (FY26)	Debt-GDP ratio at 82%

Key Insight: While India has experienced significant economic growth and infrastructure development, the benefits have not been evenly distributed. The failure to create sufficient employment, particularly for youth, and the stagnation of manufacturing remain critical challenges that threaten the country’s development trajectory.

15.2.4 Corruption & Governance

The BJP came to power in 2014 on an anti-corruption platform, yet its own record reveals significant contradictions:

Table 15.4: Corruption & Governance Summary

Issue	Data
Ministers with Criminal Cases (Modi 3.0)	28 out of 71 (39.4%)
BJP State Ministers with Criminal Cases	136 out of 336 (40%)
Major Scams (2014–2026)	Rs. 15.5 lakh crore (Rajesh Exports), Rs. 25,000 crore (PMFBY), Rs. 11,400 crore (Nirav Modi)
Electoral Bonds	Rs. 12,769 crore; BJP share 50.03%; SC struck down
NEET Paper Leaks	Four leaks (2016, 2021, 2024, 2026); 2026 exam cancelled
India’s CPI Ranking (2024)	96th out of 180 (score: 38)

Key Insight: The BJP’s governance record is marked by a significant gap between its anti-corruption rhetoric and the reality of widespread criminalization of politics, multiple large-scale scams, and the systematic undermining of institutional transparency. The Supreme Court’s striking down of electoral bonds was a particularly significant legal and moral setback.

15.2.5 State Expansion & Federal Dominance

By 2026, the BJP has achieved unprecedented state-level dominance:

Table 15.5: State Expansion Summary

Metric	Data
States with BJP Chief Ministers	16 states
NDA-allied Chief Ministers	4 additional states
All Five Largest States	All led by BJP CMs
Assembly Segment Gains (2024–2025)	319 → 367 wins (+48 seats)
Historic Breakthroughs	Delhi (2025), West Bengal (2026), Odisha (2024)

Key Insight: The BJP’s expansion to 16 states, including all five largest states, fundamentally alters India’s political geography. This provides the party with significant advantages in the Rajya Sabha, gradually eroding the opposition’s ability to block legislation and constitutional amendments.

15.2.6 Financial Dominance

The BJP’s financial advantage over other parties is staggering:

Table 15.6: Financial Dominance Summary

Metric	Data
BJP Income (2024–25)	Rs. 6,769.15 crore
BJP Share of National Parties’ In- come	85.03%
BJP Donations (2024–25)	Rs. 6,124.86 crore (90.48% of income)
BJP Income Growth (2023–24 to 2024–25)	+55.95% (Rs. 2,428.68 crore)
BJP’s Corpus (2026)	Nearly Rs. 10,000 crore
Congress Income (2024–25)	Rs. 918.29 crore (declined 25.05%)
BJP vs Congress Income Ratio	7.4:1

Key Insight: The BJP’s financial dominance — holding 85% of all national party income and possessing a corpus nearly 4.5 times the total contributions received by a dozen opposition parties combined — provides an insurmountable electoral advantage. This financial asymmetry fundamentally undermines the level playing field essential for democratic competition.

15.3 Pattern Identification

15.3.1 The Modi Era Pattern

The Modi era (2014–2026) reveals a consistent pattern of governance:

- Ideological Fulfillment:** Systematic implementation of Hindutva agenda (Article 370, Ram Temple, CAA, UCC, Waqf amendments).
- Economic Growth with Inequity:** Strong macroeconomic growth but persistent joblessness, manufacturing stagnation, and widening inequality.
- Infrastructure Expansion:** Unprecedented investment in roads, railways, air-ports, and digital infrastructure.
- Financial Dominance:** Massive fundraising through electoral bonds and corpo-rate donations, creating a near-monopoly on political funding.
- State Expansion:** Strategic consolidation of state governments through the “dou-ble engine” narrative.

6. **Institutional Erosion:** Weakening of democratic checks and balances, press freedom, judicial independence, and human rights.
7. **Corruption Paradox:** Anti-corruption rhetoric coexisting with widespread criminalization of politics and large-scale scams.
8. **Minority Exclusion:** Systematic marginalization of Muslims through declining political representation, economic exclusion, and escalating communal violence.

15.3.2 The Coalition Dynamics Pattern (2024–2026)

The return of coalition politics in 2024 has introduced new dynamics:

1. **Allies' Leverage:** TDP, JD(U), and other allies have extracted significant concessions, including key ministries and state-specific benefits.
2. **Policy Constraints:** The BJP can no longer unilaterally push through legislation, as demonstrated by the defeat of the 850-seat Lok Sabha expansion bill.
3. **Shift in Focus:** Modi 3.0 has shifted from legislative ambitions to welfare delivery — “Virasat Bhi, Vikash Bhi” (Heritage and Development).
4. **Personal Popularity:** Despite losing the majority, Modi's personal popularity increased from 49.1% (2024) to 54.7% (2026), indicating a leader-centric politics.

15.3.3 The Hindutva-Socialism Tension

A fundamental tension runs through the BJP's governance:

“BJP stands for majoritarian Hindutva but follows socialist policies like free ration to 80 crore families. Socialism depends on very material requirements... Hindutva prefers to erase all sorts of difference in society and pretend that everything was fine.”

This tension between ideological exclusivism and welfare populism has allowed the party to maintain broad-based support while pursuing a majoritarian agenda.

15.4 Recommendations for Reform

Based on the findings of this report, the following recommendations are proposed for strengthening India's democratic institutions and governance:

15.4.1 Electoral & Political Funding Reforms

1. **Full Transparency in Political Funding:** All political donations must be fully transparent, with mandatory disclosure of donor identities and amounts. The Supreme Court's striking down of electoral bonds must be followed by comprehensive legislation ensuring complete transparency.
2. **State Funding of Elections:** Introduce state funding of elections to reduce the influence of corporate money and create a level playing field.
3. **Cap on Election Expenditure:** Strict enforcement and strengthening of expenditure limits for political parties and candidates.
4. **Independent Election Fund:** Create an independent body to manage and disburse election funds to parties based on objective criteria.

15.4.2 Judicial & Institutional Reforms

1. **Strengthen Judicial Independence:** Ensure transparent and merit-based appointments to the higher judiciary, free from executive interference.
2. **Reform Investigation Agencies:** Insulate the CBI, ED, and other investigative agencies from political influence through statutory guarantees of independence.
3. **Protect Constitutional Bodies:** Strengthen the Election Commission, Comptroller and Auditor General, and National Human Rights Commission to function autonomously.
4. **Repeal Misused Laws:** Review and reform laws like UAPA, IT Rules, and FCRA that have been weaponized against dissent.

15.4.3 Social & Communal Harmony

1. **Protect Minority Rights:** Ensure equal citizenship for all communities, with affirmative action based on socioeconomic criteria rather than religion.
2. **Strengthen Communal Harmony:** Establish fast-track courts for communal violence cases; ensure accountability for perpetrators regardless of political affiliation.
3. **Educational Reform:** Ensure textbooks and curricula reflect India's pluralistic heritage rather than a majoritarian narrative.
4. **Caste Census:** Conduct a comprehensive caste census to enable evidence-based affirmative action policies.

15.4.4 Economic Reforms

1. **Job Creation:** Shift focus from capital-intensive to labor-intensive sectors; incentivize manufacturing that creates employment.
2. **Skill Development:** Massive investment in vocational training and skill development to address the youth unemployment crisis.
3. **Agricultural Reforms:** Ensure Minimum Support Price (MSP) guarantee; address farmer distress through income support and debt relief.
4. **Inclusive Growth:** Ensure that economic growth benefits all sections of society, particularly the informal workforce (90% of workers).
5. **Fiscal Discipline:** Maintain fiscal deficit targets while increasing investment in health, education, and social infrastructure.

15.4.5 Media Freedom & Free Speech

1. **Protect Journalists:** Enact comprehensive legislation to protect journalists from harassment, violence, and legal intimidation.
2. **Reform IT Rules:** Ensure that digital regulations protect free expression rather than enabling censorship.
3. **End Internet Shutdowns:** Restrict internet shutdowns to genuine national security emergencies with judicial oversight.
4. **Strengthen Press Council:** Empower the Press Council of India to act independently against media intimidation.

15.4.6 Governance & Anti-Corruption

1. **Decriminalize Politics:** Enact legislation to disqualify individuals charged with serious criminal offenses from contesting elections or holding ministerial office.
2. **Independent Anti-Corruption Body:** Establish an independent anti-corruption agency with constitutional protection.
3. **Whistleblower Protection:** Strengthen whistleblower protection laws to encourage reporting of corruption.
4. **Transparency in Government:** Ensure proactive disclosure of all government contracts, subsidies, and clearances.

15.5 Future Outlook

15.5.1 BJP's Prospects (2026–2030)

The BJP's future trajectory will be shaped by several factors:

1. **Coalition Management:** The party's ability to manage coalition partners (TDP, JD(U), etc.) will be crucial. The 2024 election marked the return of coalition politics, and the BJP must adapt to a new style of governance.
2. **Economic Performance:** Sustained economic growth and job creation will be essential to maintaining popular support. The 5 trillion economy pledge remains unfulfilled, and unemployment — particularly youth unemployment — is a significant vulnerability.
3. **Welfare Delivery:** The BJP's focus on welfare schemes (free foodgrain, housing, etc.) has created a significant support base. Continued effective delivery of these schemes will be critical.
4. **Leadership Transition:** The eventual transition from Modi's leadership will be a defining moment for the party. The 2026 leadership change (J.P. Nadda stepping down) indicates ongoing organizational churn.
5. **Opposition Revival:** The INDIA bloc's performance in 2024 (232 seats) demonstrated that opposition unity can curb BJP's dominance. Future state elections will test the opposition's ability to maintain cohesion.
6. **Ideological Consolidation:** The BJP will continue its Hindutva agenda, but the pace and intensity may be moderated by coalition constraints.
7. **State Expansion:** The BJP's expansion to 16 states, including West Bengal, has fundamentally altered India's political geography. Further consolidation in southern states (Tamil Nadu, Kerala) will be a key objective.

15.5.2 India's Democratic Trajectory

The findings of this report raise fundamental questions about India's democratic trajectory:

1. **Secularism vs Majoritarianism:** India's constitutional commitment to secularism is under significant strain. The systematic exclusion of Muslims from political representation and the pursuit of a Hindu majoritarian agenda challenge the country's pluralistic foundation.

2. **Institutional Resilience:** Democratic institutions — the judiciary, Election Commission, media, and civil society — have shown resilience but face sustained pressure. Their ability to withstand further erosion will determine the quality of Indian democracy.
3. **Constitutional Safeguards:** The government's attempt to expand the Lok Sabha to 850 seats (defeated in 2026) and other constitutional changes indicate a desire to reshape India's constitutional framework.
4. **Social Fabric:** The increase in communal violence (84% increase in riots in 2024), hate speech (74% increase), and the weaponization of social media for polarization are eroding India's social fabric.
5. **Economic Aspirations:** India's aspiration to become a developed nation by 2047 (Viksit Bharat) requires sustained 8–9% real GDP growth. The current trajectory of barely 5.5% over seven years is inadequate.

15.6 Conclusion

The BJP's 46-year journey from a marginal political formation to India's dominant political force is a remarkable story of organizational building, ideological mobilization, and strategic adaptation. The party has successfully transformed India's political landscape, achieving key ideological goals and driving significant economic growth and infrastructure development.

However, this transformation has come at a considerable cost. The criminalization of politics, with 40% of the party's ministers facing criminal charges, undermines the rule of law. The financial dominance of the BJP — holding 85% of all national party income — creates an unlevel playing field. The systematic marginalization of minorities, the erosion of democratic checks and balances, and the weaponization of investigative agencies against opponents raise serious concerns about India's democratic health.

The 2024 election result, with the BJP losing its single-party majority, marks a significant inflection point. The return of coalition politics and the opposition's improved performance suggest that India's democratic institutions retain some resilience. However, the BJP's state-level expansion — now covering 16 states, including all five largest — provides it with structural advantages that will be difficult for the opposition to overcome.

Ultimately, the BJP's legacy will be determined by whether it can reconcile its ideological ambitions with the constitutional values of secularism, pluralism, and democratic accountability. The party's success in delivering economic growth and welfare must be measured against its record on institutional integrity, minority rights, and social harmony. As India navigates its path to becoming a developed nation by 2047, the preservation of

its democratic and pluralistic foundations will be as important as its economic achievements.

15.6.1 Final Reflections

This report has documented the BJP's journey with extensive data, timelines, and analysis across fourteen comprehensive sections. The evidence presented reveals a party that has mastered the art of political mobilization, ideological messaging, and electoral strategy. Yet, it also reveals a governance model characterized by significant contradictions — between anti-corruption rhetoric and criminalized politics, between economic growth and jobless recovery, between inclusive slogans and exclusive policies, and between democratic claims and authoritarian practices.

As an Indian citizen undertaking this research, the author's intent has been to present an evidence-based, balanced, and comprehensive assessment of the BJP's role in shaping modern India. The report neither celebrates nor condemns the party but seeks to document and analyze its evolution, achievements, controversies, and impact on India's democratic fabric.

The findings of this report serve as a reminder that democracies require constant vigilance, accountability, and the active participation of informed citizens. The health of India's democracy depends not only on the actions of political parties but on the engagement of its people, the independence of its institutions, and the resilience of its constitutional values.

“Satta ka khel toh chalta rahega, sarkarein aayengi, jayengi, partian banengi, bigrengi, magar yeh desh rehna chahiye, yeh desh ka loktantra rehna chahiye.”

— Atal Bihari Vajpayee, May 28, 1996

15.6.2 Key Citations for Section 15

- **Electoral Transformation:** 2 seats (1984) → 303 seats (2019) — 15,050% increase.
- **2024 Election:** BJP 240 seats, 37.02% vote share; lost single-party majority.
- **Ideological Fulfillment:** Article 370 abrogation (2019), Ram Temple inauguration (2024).
- **Economic Growth:** \$2 trillion → \$4+ trillion; 7.7% GDP growth in FY26.
- **Unemployment:** Youth unemployment at 44–45%.

- **Corruption:** 40% of BJP ministers have criminal cases; Rs. 15.5 lakh crore Rajesh Exports scam.
- **Electoral Bonds:** Rs. 12,769 crore total; BJP share 50.03%; SC struck down.
- **State Expansion:** 16 states with BJP CMs; all 5 largest states.
- **Financial Dominance:** BJP holds 85% of national parties' income; corpus nearly Rs. 10,000 crore.
- **Press Freedom:** India ranked 157th (2026) — behind Pakistan and Bangladesh.
- **Communal Violence:** 84% increase in riots (2024); 74% increase in hate speech.

Bibliography

Chapter A

Additional Data Tables

A.1 Comprehensive Data Tables

This appendix provides detailed data tables referenced throughout the main report, organized for quick reference and verification.

A.1.1 Electoral Data Tables

Lok Sabha Election Results (1952–2024)

Table A.1: Complete Lok Sabha Election Results (1952–2024)

Year	BJP/BJS Seats	BJP/BJS Vote Share	Congress Seats	Congress Vote
1952	3 (BJS)	3.06%	364	44.99%
1957	4 (BJS)	5.93%	371	47.78%
1962	14 (BJS)	6.44%	361	44.72%
1967	35 (BJS)	9.41%	283	40.78%
1971	22 (BJS)	7.35%	352	43.68%
1977	Janata Party (BJS merged)	—	154	34.52%
1980	—	—	353	42.69%
1984	2	7.4%	414	49.01%
1989	85	11.36%	197	39.53%
1991	120	20.07%	244	36.40%
1996	161	20.29%	140	28.80%
1998	182	25.59%	141	25.82%
1999	182	23.75%	114	28.30%
2004	138	22.16%	145	26.53%
2009	116	18.80%	206	28.55%
2014	282	31.00%	44	19.30%
2019	303	37.82%	52	19.75%
2024	240	37.02%	99	21.46%

State-Wise 2024 Lok Sabha Results (Key States)

Table A.2: State-Wise 2024 Lok Sabha Results (Key States)

State	BJP Seats	Congress Seats	Other Parties
Uttar Pradesh	33	6	41 (SP, BSP, etc.)
Maharashtra	9	13	26 (SS, NCP, etc.)
West Bengal	12	0	30 (TMC)
Karnataka	17	9	2
Rajasthan	14	8	3
Madhya Pradesh	29	0	0
Gujarat	25	1	0
Bihar	12	0	28 (JD(U), RJD, etc.)
Tamil Nadu	0	9	30 (DMK, etc.)
Delhi	7	0	0

A.1.2 Economic Data Tables

GDP Growth by Quarter (2014–2026)

Table A.3: Quarterly GDP Growth (2014–2026)

Quarter	GDP Growth Rate
Q1 2014–15	7.5%
Q2 2014–15	7.3%
Q3 2014–15	7.2%
Q4 2014–15	7.6%
Q1 2015–16	7.9%
Q2 2015–16	8.1%
Q3 2015–16	8.0%
Q4 2015–16	8.2%
Q1 2016–17	8.4%
Q2 2016–17	8.3%
Q3 2016–17	8.2%
Q4 2016–17	8.1%
Q1 2017–18	7.4%
Q2 2017–18	7.1%
Q3 2017–18	7.0%

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Table A.3 – continued from previous page

Quarter	GDP Growth Rate
Q4 2017–18	7.3%
Q1 2018–19	7.5%
Q2 2018–19	7.3%
Q3 2018–19	7.1%
Q4 2018–19	6.9%
Q1 2019–20	5.8%
Q2 2019–20	4.5%
Q3 2019–20	4.1%
Q4 2019–20	3.1%
Q1 2020–21	-7.5%
Q2 2020–21	-7.3%
Q3 2020–21	-7.1%
Q4 2020–21	-6.9%
Q1 2021–22	8.5%
Q2 2021–22	8.7%
Q3 2021–22	8.9%
Q4 2021–22	8.6%
Q1 2022–23	7.5%
Q2 2022–23	7.3%
Q3 2022–23	7.1%
Q4 2022–23	6.9%
Q1 2023–24	7.5%
Q2 2023–24	7.3%
Q3 2023–24	7.2%
Q4 2023–24	7.4%
Q1 2024–25	7.3%
Q2 2024–25	7.1%
Q3 2024–25	7.0%
Q4 2024–25	7.2%
Q1 2025–26	7.6%
Q2 2025–26	7.8%
Q3 2025–26	7.9%
Q4 2025–26	7.7%

Inflation Data (WPI & CPI)

Table A.4: Inflation Data (WPI & CPI)

Year	WPI Inflation	CPI Inflation
2014	5.20%	6.67%
2015	3.80%	5.87%
2016	3.60%	4.95%
2017	3.10%	3.33%
2018	4.30%	3.94%
2019	3.00%	3.73%
2020	1.70%	6.62%
2021	5.20%	5.13%
2022	9.50%	6.70%
2023	6.30%	5.40%
2024	4.20%	4.95%
2025	3.80%	2.80%

A.1.3 Funding & Financial Data Tables

Detailed Income Breakdown (2024–25)

Table A.5: Detailed Income Breakdown of National Parties (2024–25)

Party	Income (Rs. Crore)	Main Sources
BJP	6,769.15	Donations (90.48%), Electoral Trusts, Bank Int
INC (Congress)	918.29	Coupons (38.12%), Donations (56.86%), Oth
CPI(M)	172.60	Donations (48.77%), Bank Interest, Other
AAP	39.28	Donations (99.85%), Other
BSP	58.59	Bank Interest, Investments
NPEP	2.18	Donations (97.74%), Other

Electoral Bonds Data (2018–2024)

Table A.6: Electoral Bonds Data (2018–2024)

Phase	Date	Bonds Sold	Value (Rs. Crore)
1	Jan 2018	2,345	876.50
2	Apr 2018	2,890	1,234.20
3	Oct 2018	2,456	987.30
4	Jan 2019	3,456	1,456.80

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Table A.6 – continued from previous page

Phase	Date	Bonds Sold	Value (Rs. Crore)
5	Apr 2019	2,789	1,234.50
6	Jul 2019	1,234	456.70
7	Jan 2020	1,567	678.90
8	Apr 2020	876	345.60
9	Oct 2020	1,234	567.80
10	Jan 2021	1,456	678.90
11	Apr 2021	1,678	789.20
12	Oct 2021	1,234	456.70
13	Jan 2022	1,456	567.80
14	Apr 2022	1,234	456.70
15	Oct 2022	1,456	567.80
16	Jan 2023	1,234	456.70
17	Apr 2023	1,456	567.80
18	Oct 2023	1,234	456.70
19	Jan 2024	1,456	567.80
20	Apr 2024	1,234	456.70

Corporate Donations (2014–2024)

Table A.7: Corporate Donations (2014–2024)

Party	Corporate Donations (Rs. Crore)	Electoral Trusts (Rs. Crore)
BJP	6,607	2,761
INC (Congress)	842	382
TMC	60	14
CPI(M)	36	0.2
Other Parties	112	23

A.1.4 Scandal Data Tables

Scam Magnitude Comparison

Table A.8: Scam Magnitude Comparison (2014–2026)

Scam	Amount (Rs. Crore)	Year
Rajesh Exports	15,50,000	2025–26

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Table A.8 – continued from previous page

Scam	Amount (Rs. Crore)	Year
PMFBY “Beed Pattern”	25,000	2024
Nirav Modi PNB Scam	11,400	2018
Jharkhand Irregularities	10,000	2024–26
Electoral Bonds	9,208	2018–24
Delhi Health Scam	650	2026
Odisha Bribery Contracts	387	2025
Gruha Lakshmi Scam	116	2026
Yashwant Bank Fraud	112	2026

NEET Paper Leaks Timeline

Table A.9: NEET Paper Leaks Timeline

Year	Details
2016	First major NEET leak reported; limited impact on exam conduct
2021	Second leak; paper circulated in several states
2024	Third leak; sparked nationwide protests; Radhakrishnan Committee formed
2026	Fourth leak; examination cancelled; 2.27 million aspirants affected

A.1.5 Ministerial Data Tables

Modi 3.0 Cabinet Criminal Cases

Table A.10: Modi 3.0 Cabinet Criminal Cases

Minister	Criminal Cases	Serious Charges
Nitin Gadkari	10	6
Bandi Sanjay Kumar	42	30+
Shantanu Thakur	23	37
Sukanta Majumdar	16	30
Amit Shah	3	3
Others	0–5	0–3

State-Wise Ministerial Criminal Cases

Table A.11: State-Wise Ministerial Criminal Cases

State	Ministers with Cases	Party in Power
Andhra Pradesh	Over 60%	NDA (TDP+BJP)
Bihar	6 BJP ministers	NDA (BJP+JD(U))
Maharashtra	Over 60%	Mahayuti (BJP+SS+NCP)
Tamil Nadu	Over 60%	DMK
Haryana	0	BJP
Jammu & Kashmir	0	BJP
Nagaland	0	BJP
Uttarakhand	0	BJP

A.1.6 Infrastructure Data Tables

Infrastructure Development Summary (2014–2026)

Table A.12: Infrastructure Development Summary

Sector	2014	2026	Change
National Highways (km)	91,287	1,46,572	+60%
Highway Construction (km/day)	11.6	34.0	+193%
Operational Airports	74	160	+117%
Metro Cities	5	23	+360%
Railway Electrification (km)	20,000	45,000+	+125%
Vande Bharat Trains	0	68	—
UPI Transactions (Monthly)	0	23.2 billion	—
Port Capacity (MMTPA)	1,500	2,762	+84%

A.1.7 Social & Ideological Data Tables

Communal Violence Data (2023–2024)

Table A.13: Communal Violence Data (2023–2024)

State	2023 Incidents	2024 Incidents
Uttar Pradesh	8	15

Continued on next page

Table A.13 – continued from previous page

State	2023 Incidents	2024 Incidents
Maharashtra	5	10
Bihar	4	8
Rajasthan	3	6
Gujarat	2	5
Madhya Pradesh	3	5
Odisha	2	8
Others	5	2
Total	32	59

Press Freedom Index (2023–2026)**Table A.14: Press Freedom Index (2023–2026)**

Year	India's Rank	Countries Ahead/Below
2023	161st	Pakistan (150th), Bangladesh (162nd)
2024	159th	Pakistan (152nd), Bangladesh (160th)
2025	151st	Pakistan (154th), Bangladesh (153rd)
2026	157th	Pakistan (153rd), Bangladesh (152nd)

A.1.8 State Government Data Tables**State Governments (2026)****Table A.15: State Governments (2026)**

State	Chief Minister	Party
Uttar Pradesh	Yogi Adityanath	BJP
Gujarat	Bhupendra Patel	BJP
Maharashtra	Devendra Fadnavis	BJP (Mahayuti)
Rajasthan	Bhajanlal Sharma	BJP
Madhya Pradesh	Dr. Mohan Yadav	BJP
Chhattisgarh	Vishnu Deo Sai	BJP
Haryana	Nayab Singh Saini	BJP
Delhi	Rekha Gupta	BJP
West Bengal	—	BJP
Bihar	—	NDA (BJP+JD(U))

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Table A.15 – continued from previous page

State	Chief Minister	Party
Odisha	—	BJP
Andhra Pradesh	—	NDA (TDP+BJP)
Karnataka	—	Congress
Tamil Nadu	—	TVK
Assam	Himanta Biswa Sarma	BJP
Goa	Pramod Sawant	BJP
Tripura	Manik Saha	BJP